

QuickImageComment

Version 5.03

User Manual

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1 Introduction

QuickImageComment displays EXIF, IPTC, and XMP properties of digital images (e.g., JPEG and TIFF as well as some RAW formats) and allows to edit them. Especially editing of user comment and artist (author) is supported by using the last entered or predefined values. Metadata (XMP) in video files are displayed. If the use of ExifTool by Phil Harvey is configured, metadata in videos can be changed too.

Overview of features:

- Display of all EXIF, IPTC and XMP properties of images, as well as some other file properties such as modification date.
- Display of meta data (XMP) of video files as well as (depending on the Windows version and, if necessary, installed components) display a frame of the video.
- Images or videos can be searched via their properties and recording location on map.
- In addition to the full lists of EXIF, IPTC and XMP properties a list of properties is displayed, which is configurable.
- In addition to user comment and artist further EXIF, IPTC and XMP properties can be changed. The list of modifiable properties can be configured.
- Data templates can be defined to set several properties in one step.
- Via placeholder it is possible to copy values of properties in others.
- Changes can be carried out simultaneously for two or more files.
- EXIF, IPTC and XMP properties can be deleted from images, thereby exceptions can be defined. Single properties can be deleted selectively.
- Files can be renamed using Exif, IPTC and XMP properties.
- The EXIF, IPTC and XMP properties contained in the files can be compared.
- A special mask is used to synchronize the recording time of a set of images/videos taken with different cameras. Images/videos are grouped by properties (mostly camera model). For each group, a shift of the recording time can be entered. Then the images/videos are immediately sorted in order to check whether the images/videos are then in the correct timely order.
- Selected image properties of all images/videos in a folder (including any subfolders) can be exported to a text file.
- All image properties of selected images/videos can be exported to text files (one file per image/video).
- Display of image details with graphical and numerical representation of brightness and RGB values.
- Display recording location in a map using the GPS coordinates; change of coordinates by selecting a position on the map.
- Slideshow with configurable subtitles, composed of Exif, IPTC and XMP properties.

Further processing of the images/videos (e.g., adjusting the contrast and brightness) is not the purpose of this program.

For reading and changing the EXIF, IPTC, and XMP properties the library exiv2 is used. On www.exiv2.org a description of this library can be found as well as extensive information and links to Exif, IPTC and XMP. The formats supported by exiv2 are documented here:

https://github.com/Exiv2/exiv2/blob/main/exiv2.md#file_types

ExifTool by Phil Harvey can also be integrated. At www.exiftool.org you can find more information about this program, in particular which formats and tags are supported. Compared to exiv2, ExifTool can also write to some video formats and supports more fields. Settings must be made for the use of ExifTool: "ExifTool settings" button in [Mask "Settings"](#).

Further information on this and a brief comparison between exiv2 and ExifTool in [Settings for ExifTool](#).

For displaying RAW images, the LibRaw library is integrated. If the camera manufacturer's codec or the Microsoft Raw Image Extension (which supports various RAW formats) are installed, they are used and then display is usually faster. One can install both a specific codec and the Microsoft Extension. The specific codec is then used for the corresponding images. For all others first the Microsoft Extension is tried and as last option the integrated LibRaw library. For the display of the metadata no codec is needed.

The program runs under Microsoft Windows 7, 8, 10 and 11 and is available as 32-bit and 64-bit variant. German, English or French can be selected as the language. The translation into French was largely done by a helpful user, some additions were made with DeepL. Other languages can easily be added if a corresponding language file is created. Further information can be found here:

<https://quickimagecomment.de/en/support-for-additional-languages.html>

There is also a variant with slightly reduced functionality available, which runs on Windows XP with .Net 4.0 framework.

QuickImageComment is free software; you can use it under the terms of the GNU General Public License as published by the Free Software Foundation, for Details see chapter [Licenses](#).

2 Installation, Start, Upgrades

2.1 Installation

ZIP-files

Preconditions:

- Operating System Windows 7 or higher
- .NET 4.6.1 (or higher)

Two zip files are available:

- 32-bit
- 64-bit

An installation in the usual sense is not necessary. The zip file can be unpacked into any directory on your computer.

To uninstall the program, delete the directory and the configuration file in %AppData%.

The registry is not changed by the program.

ZIP file for Windows XP and .Net 4.0

There is also a variant with slightly limited functionality that runs on Windows XP with the .Net 4.0 framework. The limitations of this variant:

- It does not include LibRaw for display of RAW images, so for display of RAW images a manufacturer's codec or the Microsoft Raw Image Extension is needed.
- Google Maps or Bing Maps cannot be used for the map display in the program itself, only via "Map in Standard Browser".

Microsoft Store

QuickImageComment is also available in Microsoft Store:

<https://www.microsoft.com/store/apps/9PGFF2B2FBR8>

The package in Microsoft Store is certified by Microsoft.

When using an installation from Microsoft Store you have no access to config folder of program path. However reasonable changes you would like to do there can be done in a new file stored in folder %APPDATA%. For details see following chapters:

- [General configuration file](#)
- [TagLookup-file](#)
- [exiv2.ini](#)

2.2 First usage

During the first start you will be asked for the language to be used and are offered the possibility, to check the availability of a new version automatically in the future. In addition, reference is made to the possibility of optionally using ExifTool for reading and writing metadata.

After the first start the default settings in [Mask "Settings"](#) and [Mask "Field definitions"](#) should be checked and adjusted according to your own needs. These and other settings during the use of the program will be written when exiting in a configuration file in %AppData% or in the program folder (see also [User related configuration file](#)).

When the program is started via command line (see [Command line arguments](#)), a folder- or filename can be passed as argument. If a shortcut to the program is added in folder

"%Appdata%\Microsoft\Windows\SendTo", folder, images or videos can be opened via entry "Send to" in the context menu of Windows Explorer.

Folders, images or videos can be opened via drag-and-drop.

With some Browser also images from Internet can be opened via Drag-and-Drop. For this purpose, they are downloaded into the folder "Downloads". This is tested with Google Chrome, Microsoft Edge and Firefox; it does not work with Internet Explorer.

2.3 Upgrades

When you want to upgrade to a new version of QuickImageComment and have installed it from a ZIP-file, you may just overwrite the older version with the newer one. The old user settings will be used with the new version. If you install the newer version in a different folder, the old user settings are reused only if they are stored in %APPDATA% (see also [User related configuration file](#)). In some cases, user actions are recommended during upgrade as described in the following.

2.3.1 Upgrade from 4.xx to 5.00

Version 5.00 allows optionally to read and write meta data using ExifTool, which especially allows to write into videos. How to configure this is described in [Settings for ExifTool](#). That chapter also describes differences between ExifTool and exiv2.

Additionally, some options can be configured in the [General configuration file](#):

- [Tag for recording date](#)
- [Tag for keywords](#)
- [Creating field definitions: Use tag name as definition name](#)

The settings for tags for recording date and keywords are separated for images and videos. The initial settings for image tags are those tags which were used in the versions 4.xx and could not be changed there. The video tags are new:

- Recording date: QuickTime:CreateDate
- Keywords: XMP-dc:Subject

As you may now or later change the tags for recording date or keywords, it is recommended to check some field definitions, which were entered in user configuration during the first start. These are:

- "Exif.Photo.DateTimeOriginal" for recording date in
 - Display in tab "Overview" – Image
 - Display of files in view "Tiles" – Image
 - Display Image in own window – Image
 - Table view during multiple images editing
 - Search via properties

It is recommended to replace this tag in [Mask "Field definitions"](#) by "Image.RecordingDateAccordingConfig". With this tag the configuration for recording date of images is considered and display of recording date in the different locations will be consistent.

- "Image.IPTC_KeyWordsString" for IPTC keywords in
 - Display in tab "Overview" – Image
 - Search via properties
 - Table view during multiple images editing

It is recommended to replace this tag in in [Mask "Field definitions"](#) by "Image.KeyWordsAccordingConfigString". With this tag the configuration for keywords is considered and display of keywords in the different locations will be consistent.

- "Exif.Photo.DateTimeOriginal" for recording time in
 - Rename of Files

It is recommended to replace this tag in [Mask "Field definitions"](#) by "Define.RecordingTime_hhmmss". With this tag the configuration for recording date of images is considered.

In case you configure to use ExifTool, this tag allows also to rename videos using recording date, which was not possible with Exif.Photo.DateTimeOriginal, which is not filled in videos.

If you configure to use ExifTool, check also:

- "Xmp.video.DateTimeOriginal" for recording date in
 - Display in tab "Overview" – Video
 - Display of files in view "Tiles" – Video
 - Display Image in own window – Video.

It is recommended to replace this tag in [Mask "Field definitions"](#) by "Image.RecordingDateAccordingConfig". With this tag the configuration for recording date of videos is considered and display of recording date in the different locations will be consistent.

If you do not configure to use ExifTool, it is better now not to change this field, because Xmp.video.DateTimeOriginal can be read without ExifTool, whereas the tag for recording date entered in general configuration file has to be an ExifTool tag, because otherwise its value cannot be changed.

Hint: These modifications are intentionally not done automatically, because after filling the user settings initially by the program itself, they should be solely under the control of the user. An additional problem is changing the configuration for search via properties. Changing the fields there requires to reread the meta data, which can take some time. This shall be decided by user if and when this should be done. Perhaps the field for keywords is included from initial settings, but never used. So, replacing the field by another and rereading the data makes no sense.

3 Main mask

The main mask and its usage are described in the following sections:

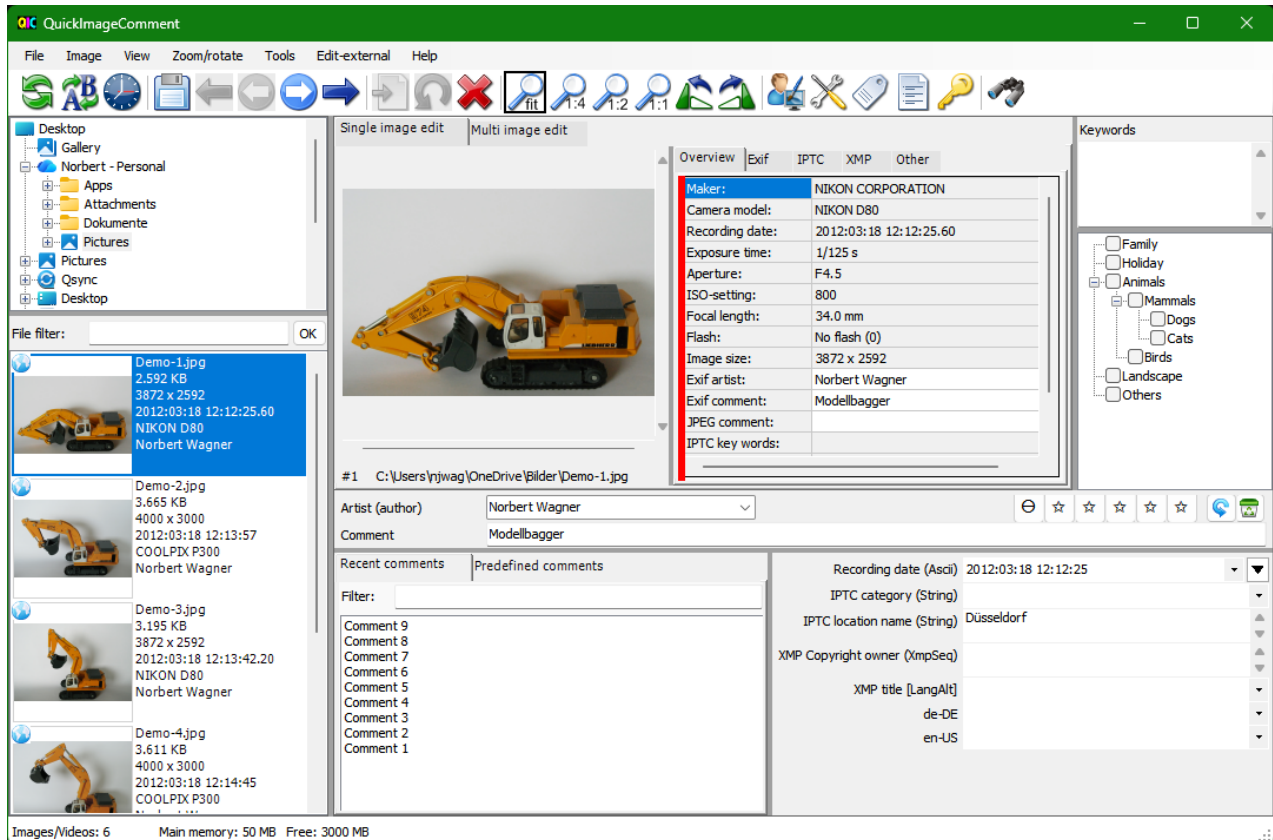
- [Layout of mask and adjustments](#)
- [Selection and display of images](#)
- [Selection and display of videos](#)
- [Display of image details](#)
- [Recording location on map](#)
- [Single image edit](#)
- [Multiple images edit](#)
- [Other features](#)
- [Tool bar](#)
- [Keyboard shortcuts](#)
- [Footer](#)

Via the menu bar of the main mask, symbols (see [Tool bar](#)) and sometimes keyboard shortcuts (see [Keyboard shortcuts](#)) following masks with additional functionalities can be opened:

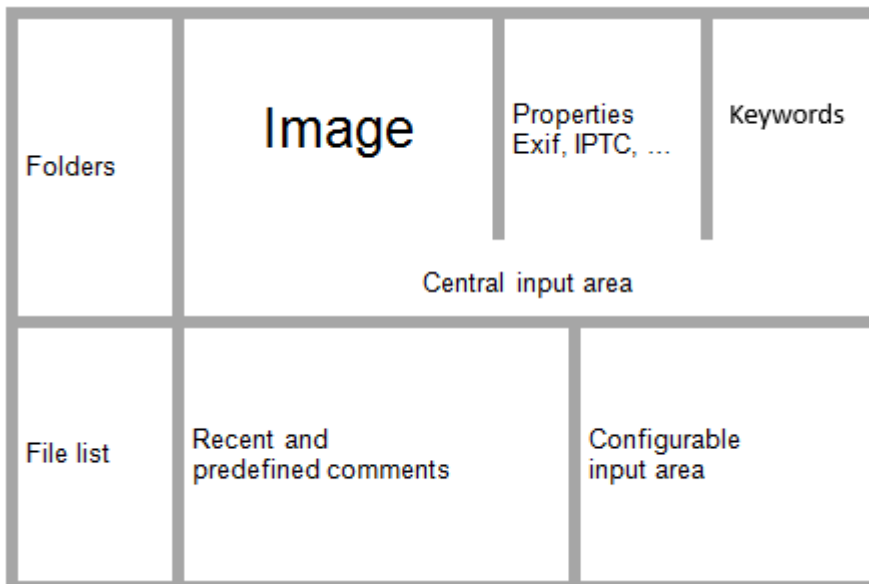
- [Mask "Search via properties"](#)
- [Mask "Adjust view"](#)
- [Mask "Settings"](#)
- [Mask "Field definitions"](#)
- [Mask "Define grid"](#)
- [Mask "Change recording date and time"](#)
- [Mask "Rename files"](#)
- [Mask "Compare files"](#)
- [Mask "Remove meta data"](#)
- [Mask "Image Details"](#)
- [Mask "Image in own window"](#)
- [Mask "Map"](#)
- [Mask "Predefined comments"](#)
- [Mask "Predefined keywords"](#)
- [Mask "Select and edit data template"](#)
- [Mask "Customize mask"](#)

3.1 Layout of mask and adjustments

The main mask is divided into several sections:



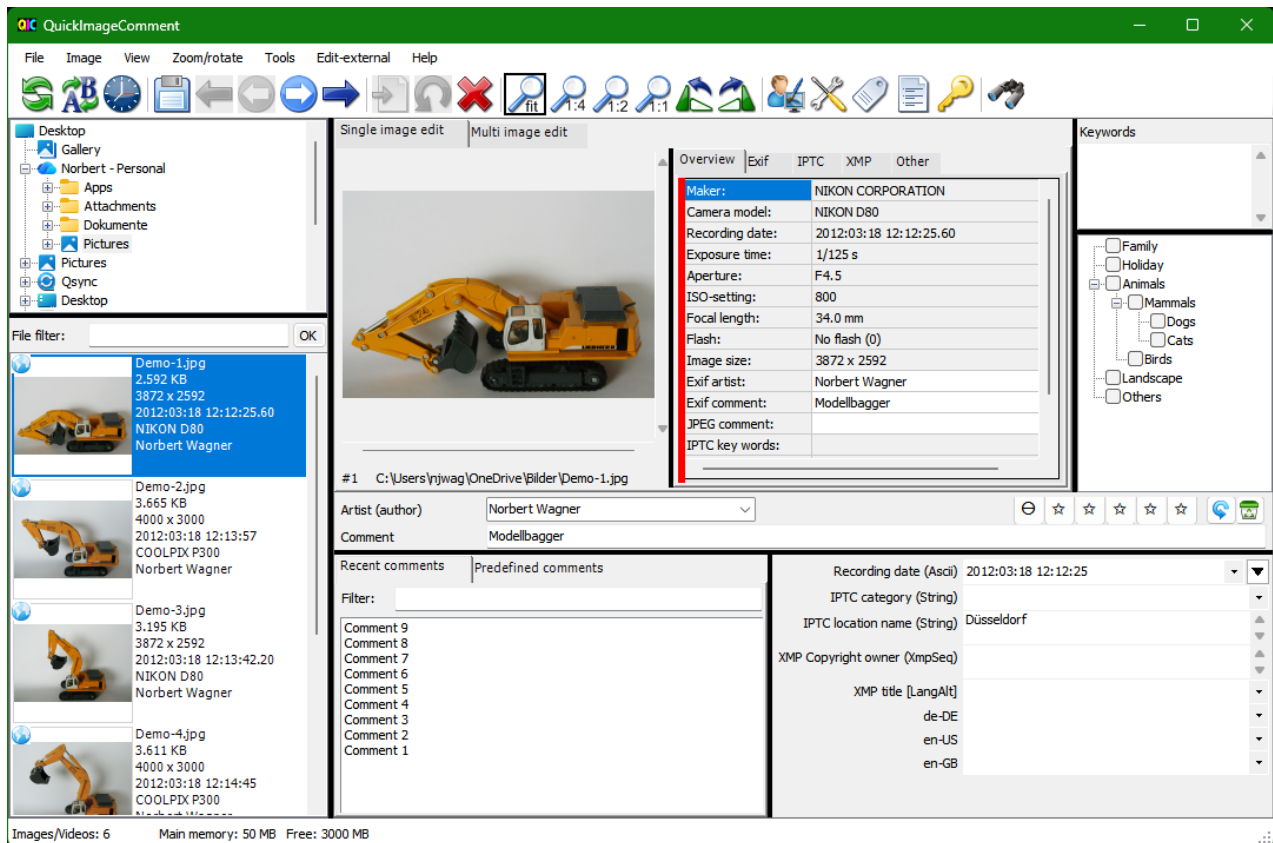
The following diagram identifies the areas:



Except for the picture all areas can be shown or hidden individually via the [Mask "Adjust view"](#) (menu entry "View - adjust"). In the central input area fields for artist and comment can be individually enabled and hidden. In one of these areas image details and map can be displayed. For more details see chapters [Display of image details](#) and [Recording location on map](#).

There is also the possibility of using the menu item "View - Only image and input fields" to hide all areas except the central input area. With selecting this menu item, a second time the previous view is restored.

The size of the different areas can be adjusted by moving the grey dividing lines, where for each area a minimum size cannot be exceeded. For clarity, the dividing lines are black in the picture below:



Via the menu entry "View - Command strip" (or [Mask "Adjust view"](#)), the toolbar can be displayed, hidden or displayed next to the menu. The last variant allows the use of symbols, but does not reduce the available height for the mask. However, then the symbols are relatively small.

Using the menu "View", the context menu (right-click in file list), or using the [Mask "Adjust view"](#) the file list can be shown in the following variants:

- Thumbnail
- Tiles
- List
- Details
- Comment
- Rating

In the "Thumbnail" and "Tile" views, the top right-hand corner of the preview image shows  if GPS data are stored in the image.

In the "Comment" view, the comment is displayed next to the file name. It is the same comment which is displayed for the selected image in the central input area and can be changed there. Since the comment is read from the meta data and the meta data is read bit by bit, "----???" is initially displayed as a comment as long as the metadata for the respective image have not yet been read.

In the "Rating" view, the rating is displayed next to the file name. Since the rating is read from the meta data and the meta data is read bit by bit, "----???" is initially displayed as a rating as long as the metadata for the respective image have not yet been read. Rating is shown with icons (stars) and as numeric value, since rating can be entered as a value with decimal places.

In view "tiles" additional to the file names up to five more freely selectable properties can be displayed in file list. The listed configurable input field properties and the properties displayed in the "Overview" tab can also be chosen free. The selection of properties is done in [Mask "Field definitions"](#), group "Display of files in view of "Tiles"", "Change of properties" and "display in tab "Overview"".

The files can be sorted by ascending or descending order using the menu "View", the context menu in file list or by clicking on the headers in view "Details".:

- Name
- Size
- Modified at
- Created at
- Comment
- Rating

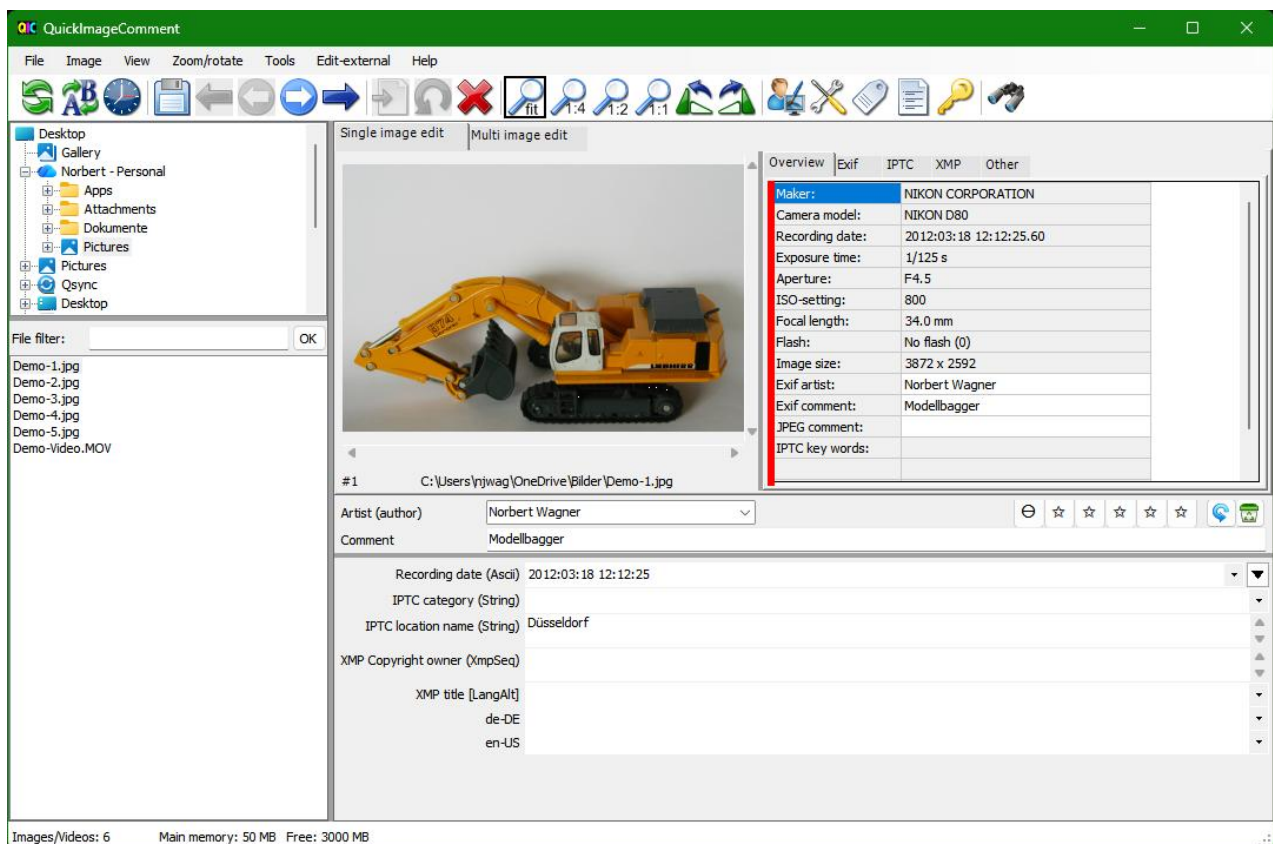
Note: As comments and rating are only read and displayed gradually, you should only sort by comment/rating once all metadata has been read (i.e. the cache is full). This can be recognized by the fact that the following symbol is no longer displayed in the footer:



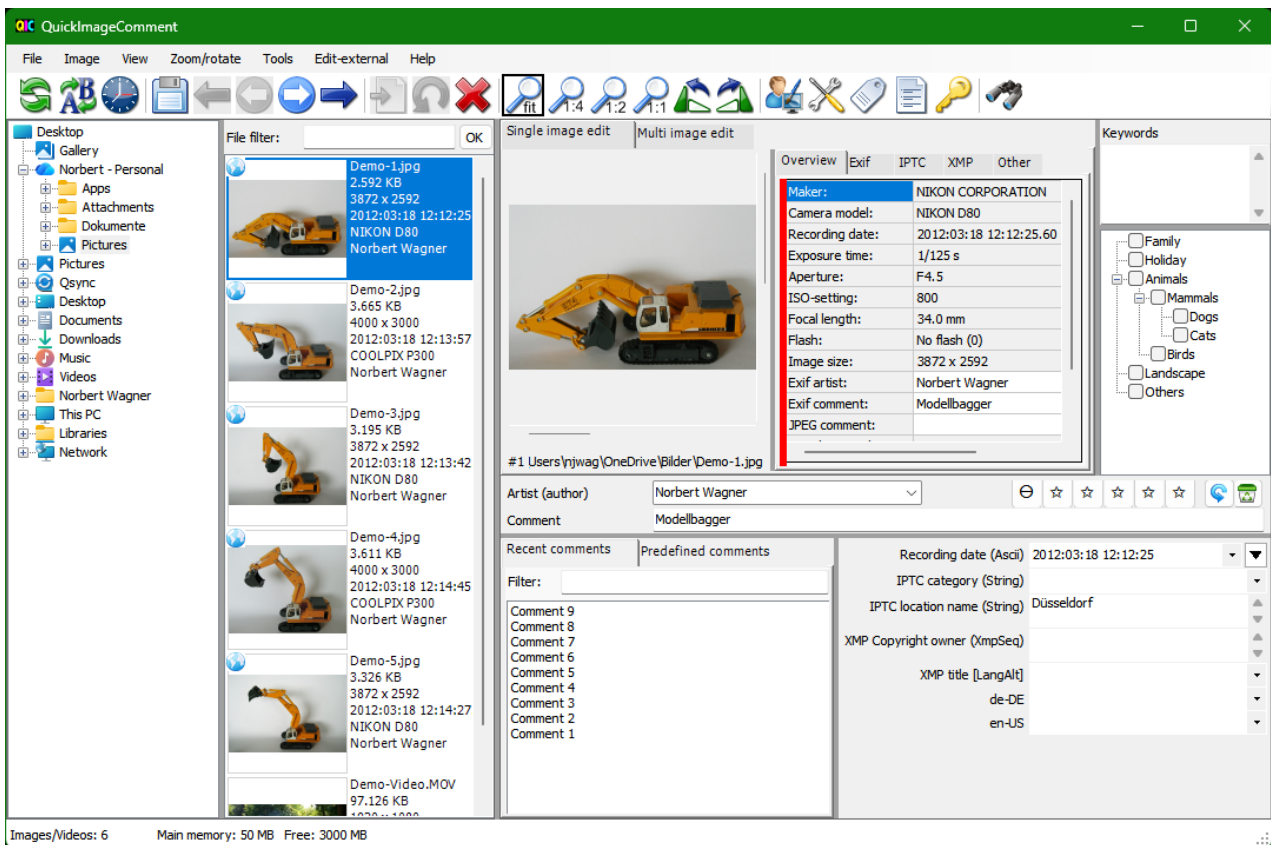
Size of thumbnails and spaces in views Thumbnail and Tiles can be adjusted via [General configuration file](#).

Using the [Mask "Adjust view"](#) the content of all areas except the one with image and central input fields can be assigned at your choice.

For example, if you do not need the lists of recent and predefined comments and Keywords, you can hide them and thus have more space for the image and / or the display of the properties in the upper region as well as for the values in the Configurable input area:



Additionally, the areas "Folder" and "File list" can be displayed side by side instead of one above the other for a better usage of wide monitors:



The same is possible for the both areas on the right-hand side, on top with image, properties and keywords, on bottom with last and predefined keywords and configurable input area.

These adjustments can be saved under a name in [Mask "Adjust view"](#). The named settings can be activated in the menu "View".

In addition, the appearance of the mask can be largely customized itself. For more detail see [Mask "Customize mask"](#). These customizations can be removed using the menu item "Tools - Remove adjustments all masks".

3.2 Selection and display of images

Note: In the following description, it is assumed that all areas are displayed (see also [Layout of mask and adjustments](#)) and the contents of the areas are not exchanged.

Via the folder list on the upper left-hand side a folder is selected. In the area below its images and videos are displayed. In general, file list is updated automatically, when a file was added, renamed or deleted by another program.

In rare cases the update may not work or is delayed. Then via menu item "File - Refresh file list" the folder is read again and the file list is updated. The list can also be updated using symbol (see [Tool bar](#)) or via a keyboard shortcut (see [Keyboard shortcuts](#)). The folder list can be refreshed using menu item "File - Refresh folder tree".

The files can be filtered. Therefore, a textbox is located above the file list. There you can enter a text that must be included in the name of the files to be displayed. Alternatively, a text with wildcard characters can be entered, to which the file name must match. Upper and lower case is not considered.

Wildcard characters:

?	corresponds to any one character at a given position
*	corresponds to any number of characters

Examples:

Filter	results in
abc	files with "abc" in the name
abc*	files starting with "abc"
*.dng	files with "dng" extension
ab?c*	files starting with "ab", followed by one character, "c" and any characters

With Return key or Ok button next to the text box the filter is activated.

Using the menu "View", the context menu (right-click in file list), or using the [Mask "Adjust view"](#) the file list can be shown in the following variants:

- Thumbnail
- Tiles
- List
- Details
- Comment
- Rating

In the "Thumbnail" and "Tile" views, the top right-hand corner of the preview image shows  if GPS data is stored in the image.

In the "Comment" view, the comment is displayed next to the file name. It is the same comment which is displayed for the selected image in the central input area and can be changed there. Since the comment is read from the meta data and the meta data is read bit by bit, "----???--" is initially displayed as a comment as long as the metadata for the respective image have not yet been read.

In the "Rating" view, the rating is displayed next to the file name. . Since the rating is read from the meta data and the meta data is read bit by bit, "----???--" is initially displayed as a rating as long as the metadata for the respective image have not yet been read. Rating is shown with icons (stars) and as numeric value, since rating can be entered as a value with decimal places.

The properties shown in the view "Tiles" can be selected in the [Mask "Field definitions"](#), group "Display of files in view "Tiles"". The mask can be opened via context menu in file list (in this case directly with selection of group) or via menu.

The column width in the view "List" corresponds to the column width for column "Name" as set in view "Details".

Several grids can be displayed on top of the image, for example to examine the distortion of a lens or to "measure" details. Using entry "Define grid ..." in menu "View" the [Mask "Define grid"](#) can be opened to define up to six grids. With the menu item "Image with grid" display of grid is switched on or off. By moving the mouse while holding down the right mouse button over the image, the grid can be moved. If image details are displayed (see [Display of image details](#)), the grid will be moved, when the mouse pointer is outside the frame, which marks the detail area. If the mouse pointer is inside the frame while holding the right mouse button, the Details section is moved.

The image selected in the file list is displayed in the middle of the mask in the tab "Single image edit". Via symbols (see [Tool bar](#)), the menu "Zoom/Rotate" or shortcut (see [Keyboard shortcuts](#)) the magnification can be changed and the image can be rotated.

The magnification can be selected:

- fit (the picture fills the available space)
- 1:4 = reduction 1:4 (referring to the pixel)

- 1:2 = reduction 1:2 (referring to the pixel)
- 1:1 = one pixel in the image is represented as a pixel on the screen
- 2:1 = magnification 2:1 (referring to the pixel)
- 4:1 = magnification 4:1 (referring to the pixel)
- 8:1 = magnification 8:1 (referring to the pixel; for technical reasons, only available in the 64-bit variant)

In the settings 1:4 to 8:1 magnification depends on the resolution of the image.

In the "Zoom/Rotate" menu is the option to select a magnification factor. This does not refer to the pixels, but to the size of the image in the available frame. Factor "x 2" means, that the image is displayed twice as large as with "fit" - regardless of the resolution of the image.

In addition, you can adjust the zoom level using the mouse wheel.

In case the image is bigger than the available space, the visible area can be shifted using the scroll bars on bottom and right or by moving the mouse with left button pressed.

Images can contain an Exif information with the orientation (Exif.Image.Orientation or manufacturer-specific tags). If this is present, the image will be rotated accordingly. For RAW images, this only applies if this is selected via the menu item "Zoom/Rotate - RAW: Rotate after decoding", because many RAW decoders already rotate the image accordingly. If it is selected on one image, it applies to all images read with the same decoder. The menu item is only active if it is a RAW image that is to be rotated according to the Exif information.

Right to the tab "Single image edit" are five or six tabs in which properties of the image are displayed:

- Overview

A selection of properties, which can be customized using [Mask "Field definitions"](#), group "Display in tab "Overview" ...", separated for images and Videos. The mask can be opened via context menu in list of properties (in this case directly with selection of group) or via menu.

In the Overview tab a red bar on the left indicates, that there is a conspicuity or error in the properties. These are displayed in the bottom of this tab. A conspicuity may be:

- For certain properties for which there should be only one value, there are several values in the image.
- The various properties (Exif, IPTC, XMP) in which artists (Author) and comment will be saved (according to selection in [Mask "Settings"](#)), have different values.

Errors may be reported by the library exiv2 when reading the properties, such as "The memory contains data of image at unknown type". If ExifTool is used, messages from ExifTool can be displayed as well.

Errors can also occur when displaying the image. If a message starting with "BitmapDecoder:" or "LibRaw:" is displayed next to "Error displaying image", a codec for reading the RAW image is missing and should be installed. As an alternative, the Microsoft Raw Image Extension can be installed, which supports various RAW formats. Other messages indicate a software error and should be reported to quickimagecomment@gmail.com.

Properties can be marked (using the left mouse button) and then - using the context menu (right mouse button) - added to area for changeable properties, the fields for search or into the multi-edit-table.

- Exif
- IPTC
- XMP

For properties of type "LangAlt" the first value is for default language (x-default), then values for specific languages are listed; the language identifier is shown after the name of the property.

- ExifTool (only if ExifTool is activated)

The metadata that were read using ExifTool is displayed here.

- Others, such as:
 - File Properties
 - ExifEasy properties (values are selected from a several Exif properties, for details see [Hints on special properties](#))
 - Properties that are defined in general configuration file (see [Adjustment and configuration](#) and [General configuration file](#))

For the tables in the tabs Exif, IPTC, XMP, ExifTool and Other you can use the context menu (right mouse button) or the [Mask "Adjust view"](#) to select different views. The "... - English" views are not available for ExifTool. For ExifTool, the language can be selected separately via the menu item "Tools - Language for ExifTool".

- List with Headings
This is the default view. The properties are assigned to different groups. Before each group the group name is displayed in a cell with bold font. By clicking in the bold line, the properties belonging to the group can be shown or hidden.
- Simple list
In this view, the group name does not appear on a separate line but is at the beginning of the tag name, so a little more width is required for viewing. In this view, the columns can be sorted, e.g., by the tag.
- Simple list, group at the end
In this view, the group name does not appear on a separate line but is at the end of tag name. In this way properties can be sorted regardless of their group. This is useful (especially in case of manufacturer-specific properties) if you do not know in which group a property can be found. In addition, there are properties that are included in different groups - these are then also with each other.
- List of headings - English
Same as "List with Headings", tag names in English
- Simple List - English
Same as "Simple list", tag names in English
- Simple list, group at the end - English
Same as "Simple list, group at the end", tag names in English.

In these tables, fields can be marked (using the left mouse button) and then - using the context menu (right mouse button) - added to area for changeable properties, the tab "Overview", the fields for search or into the multi-edit-table.

Hint for language "German":

In the views "List with Headings" and "Simple List" mainly German tag names are displayed. If the meaning of the tag and thus a correct translation was not sure, it was not translated and the original (English) name is displayed. Translations are preferably chosen so that tags belonging together are together in the sort order.

Example: "Category" and "SuppCategory" were translated as "Kategorie" and "Kategorie zusätzlich", not as "Kategorie" and "zusätzliche Kategorie".

In this way the sorting in display with group at the end has a higher benefit for German than for English.

In the tabs Exif, IPTC and XMP the description of the property (if available) is displayed when the mouse hovers over the first column.

On the far right, the key words are displayed. Key words can be predefined in the program ([Mask "Predefined keywords"](#)). The pre-defined key words are listed here with a checkbox. Additional key words (free text) can be directly assigned to the image. These are entered in the field at the top.

On the bottom right is the configurable input area. Here configurable properties are displayed, which can be changed there too. The properties can be selected in the [Mask "Field definitions"](#), group "Change of properties". The mask can be opened via context menu in this area (in this case directly with selection of group) or via menu. Additionally, properties can be marked in the tabs Exif, IPTC, XMP, ExifTool or Others and then added using the context menu.

If the image is changed by another program and there are no unsaved changes in this program, the display is refreshed automatically.

Displaying the Focus Point

If the image contains a value for Exif.Fujifilm.FocusPoint, the focus point can be displayed point by selecting "View - Show Focus Point" from the menu. The focus point can also be displayed in [Display of image details](#). There are customization options (size, color) available that are also used for this display.

3.3 Selection and display of videos

In addition to the display of images and their properties, frames from video files and their properties can be displayed. The remarks of [Selection and display of images](#) also apply to videos. The program basically supports all video file types, which are also supported from the library exiv2 (www.exiv2.org) resp. ExifTool (www.exiftool.org). In the [Mask "Settings"](#), the file extensions can be defined, which are displayed in the file list. For them the metadata are displayed.

For videos other properties can be selected than for images to be displayed in tab "Overview" and for display of files in the view "Tile". For this purpose, the list for the group of properties in [Mask "Field definitions"](#) contains following entries:

- Display in tab "Overview" - Video
- Display of files in view "Tiles" - Video

The display of frames from the video file depends on the operating system and possibly from installed components. Unfortunately, I could not find a solution that works on all (still) popular Windows operating systems. If no frame can be displayed, unfortunately this is not directly shown by a corresponding notice, but shows up in the way, that after a certain delay a black screen will appear. Therefore, in the [Mask "Settings"](#) separately it can be defined, for which video file types a frame is displayed. Depending on the video file and computer it can take a long time until a frame is displayed. This may be a reason to avoid the display of frames without having to sacrifice the display of metadata.

It is not the first frame of the video, which is displayed, but a frame after a predetermined time difference from the start. The pre-set can be defined in the [Mask "Settings"](#). Below the frame (above the file name), a different frame position can be selected for each video individually.

Changes in the metadata of video files are only possible, if ExifTool has been configured ("ExifTool settings" button in [Mask "Settings"](#)).

The display of the video itself is not part of the program, but - as long as the respective video type is supported by the system - is possible by double click in the file list. This will open the program that is associated with the appropriate file type.

If the video is changed by another program, the display is refreshed automatically.

3.4 Display of image details

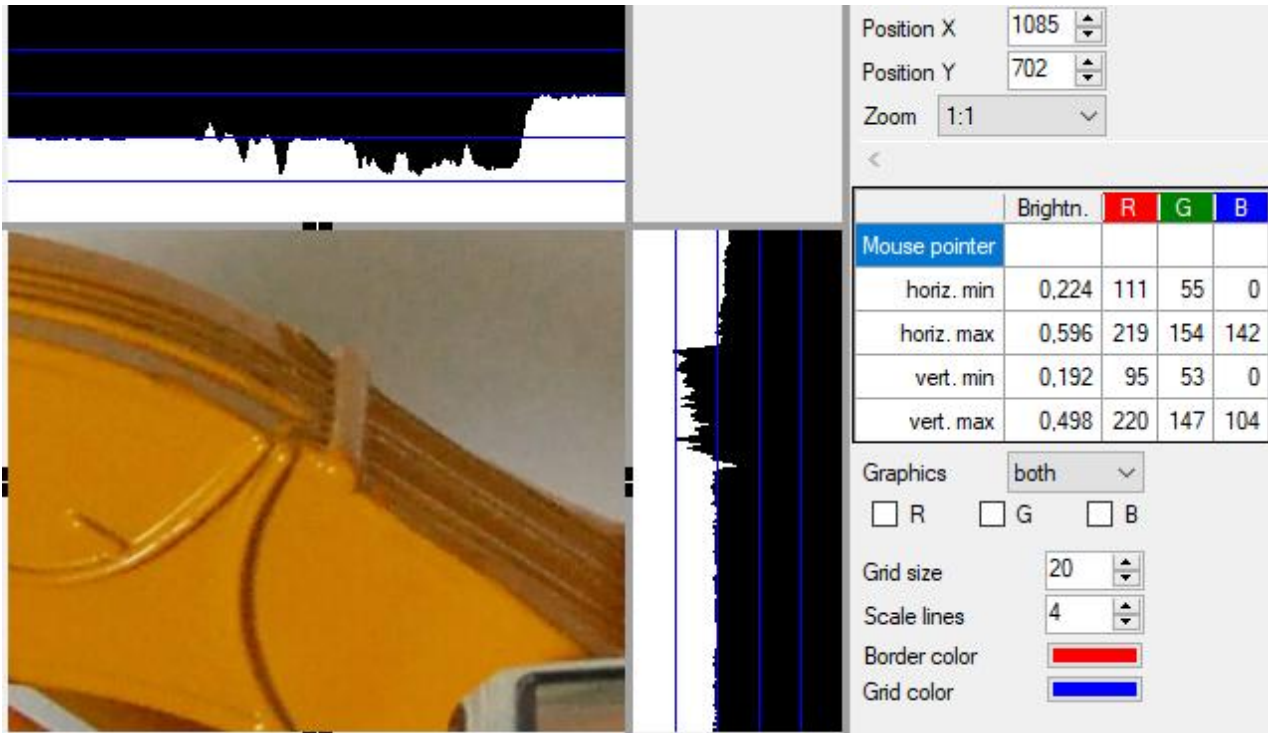
The image details can be shown in two ways:

- In main mask: Use [Mask "Adjust view"](#) to adjust the main mask so that "image details" is displayed in one of the areas.

- In own window: Open own window via menu entry "Tools - Image details in own window".

The display of image details is useful to

- view parts of the image magnified
- see brightness and color gradients graphically and numerically
- analyze images with pixel accuracy



Bottom left you can see the image section. The visible area of image can be shifted by moving the mouse with left button pressed. Above and on the right, graphics represent the brightness profile along the horizontal and vertical centerlines.

In the right part are:

- Position X and Y: display and input capability for the X and Y position of the upper left corner of the detail of the selected image displayed here
- Zoom: Shortlist for magnification
By selecting "variable" the slider below the selection list for setting the magnification factor is enabled.
Various fixed magnifications of 1:4 to 9:1 can be selected directly.
With the "3:1 grid", "5:1 grid" and "9:1 grid", the pixels of the image are represented by 3x3, 5x5 or 9x9 pixels. A grid line is placed centrally over the pixels in order to align the pixels exactly to their values in the graphs.
- A table shows the brightness value and the values for red, green and blue for:
 - Pixel under the mouse pointer
 - minimum value in the horizontal centerline
 - maximum value in the horizontal centerline
 - minimum value in the vertical centerline
 - maximum value in the vertical centerline
- Graphics: In the selection list it can be selected if both, none, only the horizontal or only the vertical graph are displayed.
- R, G, B: Using these checkboxes it can be selected individually, whether in addition to the brightness, curves for red, green and blue are displayed.

- **Grid Size:** The setting for grid size is only relevant for the zoom settings "3:1 grid", "5:1 grid" and "9:1 grid". The value 20 indicates here that every 20 pixels of the image a grid line is drawn.
- **Scale lines:** The value of 4 indicates that 4 scale lines are shown in the graphs.
- **Frame color:** Using this button, the color of the frame can be defined, which highlights the displayed detail section in the main picture box.
- **Grid color:** Using this button the color of the grid and scale lines can be defined.

In addition to the Zoom-drop-down, you can adjust the zoom level using the mouse wheel.

In the main picture box, the displayed detail section is marked by a frame with horizontal and vertical centerline. When the mouse pointer is within the frame, the detail section can be shifted by moving the mouse while holding the right mouse button.

The information for image details is preferably displayed in a region which is in landscape mode. If the area is in portrait mode (taller than wide), the graphics are displayed in the upper part, the other controls are shown below.

Displaying the Focus Point

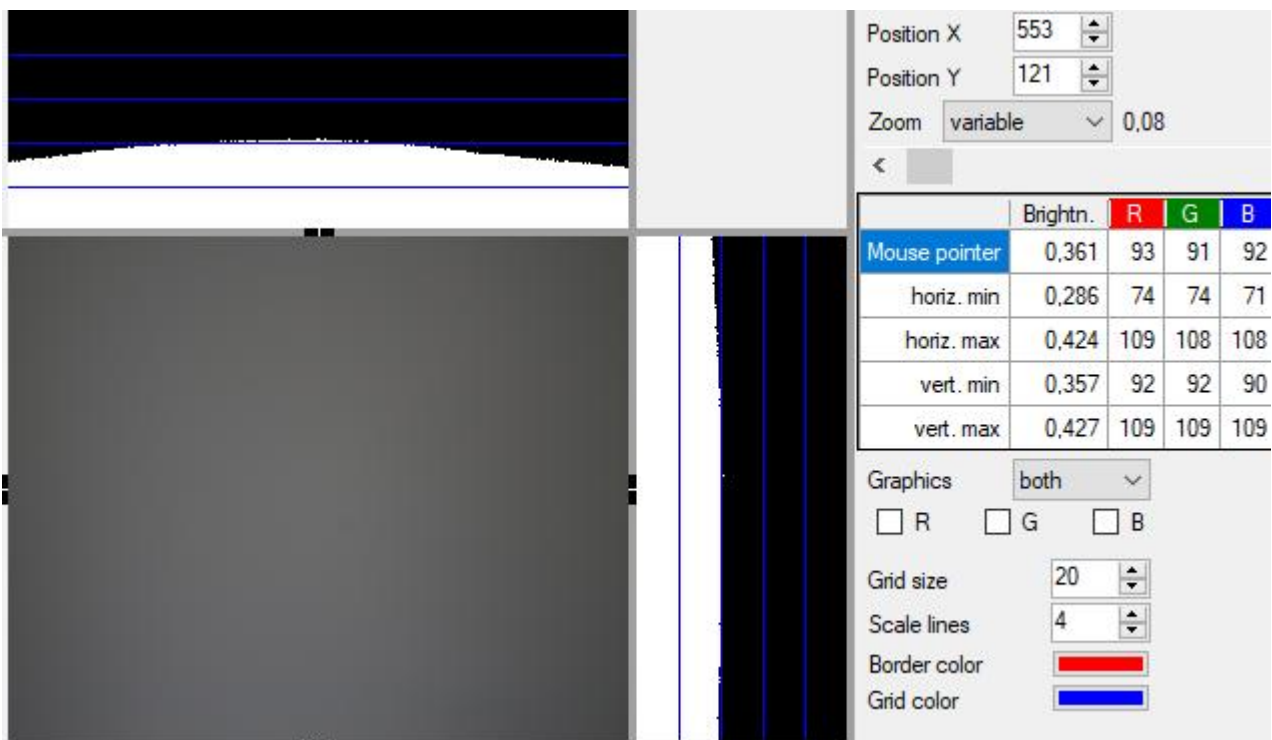
If the image contains a value for Exif.Fujifilm.FocusPoint, the focus point can be displayed. Then additional controls are visible:

- **Show focus point:** When checked, focus point is shown
- **Focus point color:** Using this button the color of the circle around shown around focus point can be defined
- **Center focus point:** After pressing this button, the focus point is shown in the center of image display
- **Radius:** Defines radius of circle shown around the focus point
- **Line width:** Defines line width of circle shown around the focus point

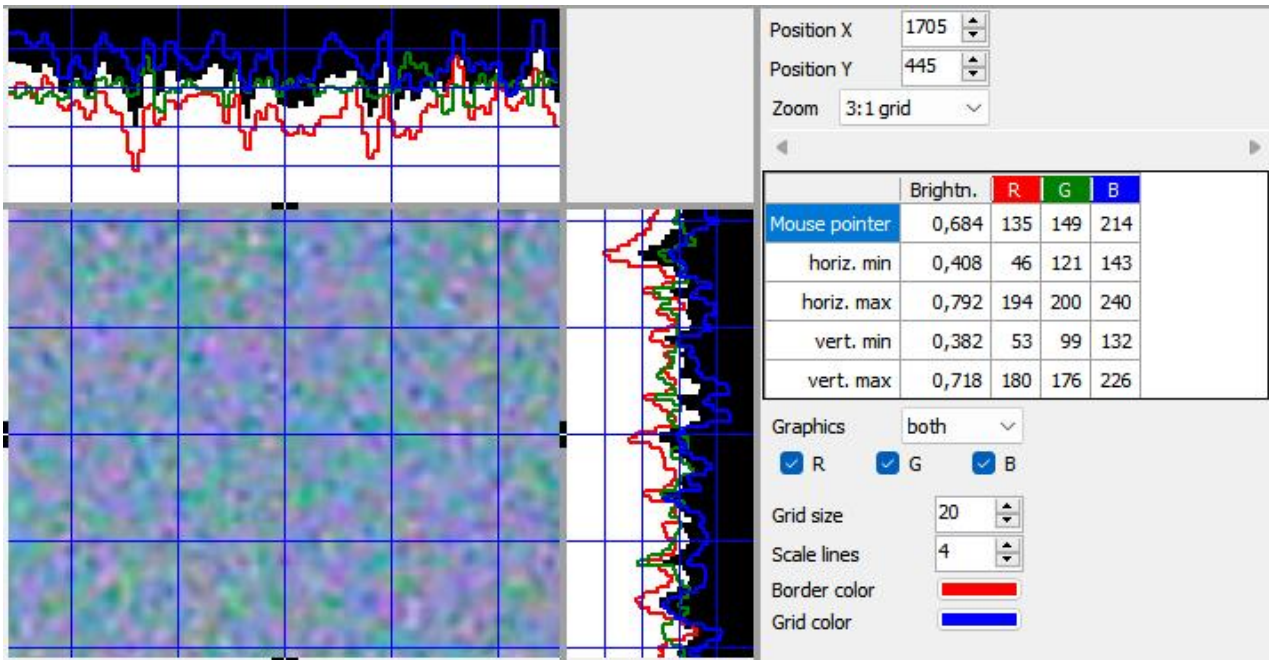
Note: These settings are also used for display of focus point in image display of main mask.

Examples of use:

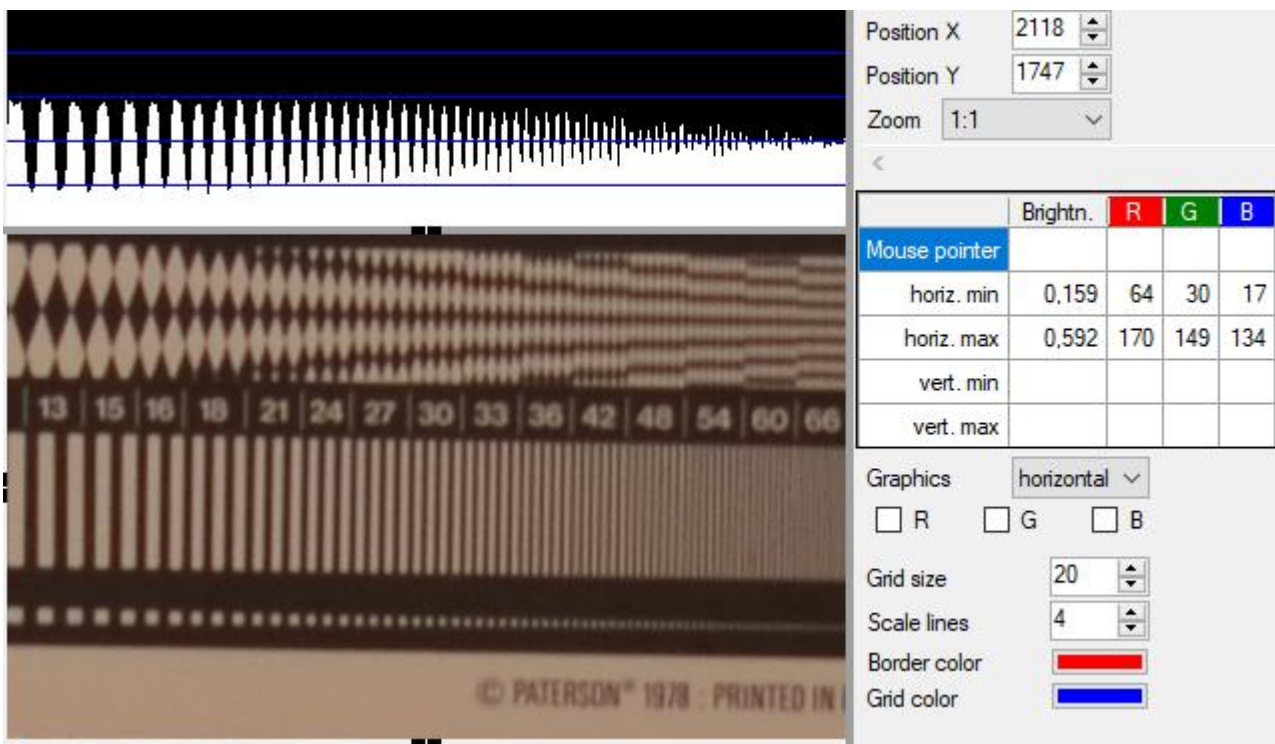
Examination of vignetting:



Testing of color noise of an image taken with compact camera and high ISO-setting:



In the following picture you can clearly see that although the narrow lines on the right-hand side can be seen separated, the difference between light and dark line becomes increasingly much smaller:



3.5 Recording location on map

The recording location on map can be shown in two ways:

- In main mask: Use [Mask "Adjust view"](#) to adjust the main mask so that "map" is displayed in one of the areas.
- In own window: Open own window via menu entry "Tools - Map in own window".

For display and change of recording location on a map OpenStreetMap is used. The license conditions of OpenStreetMap have to be considered:

<https://www.openstreetmap.org/copyright>

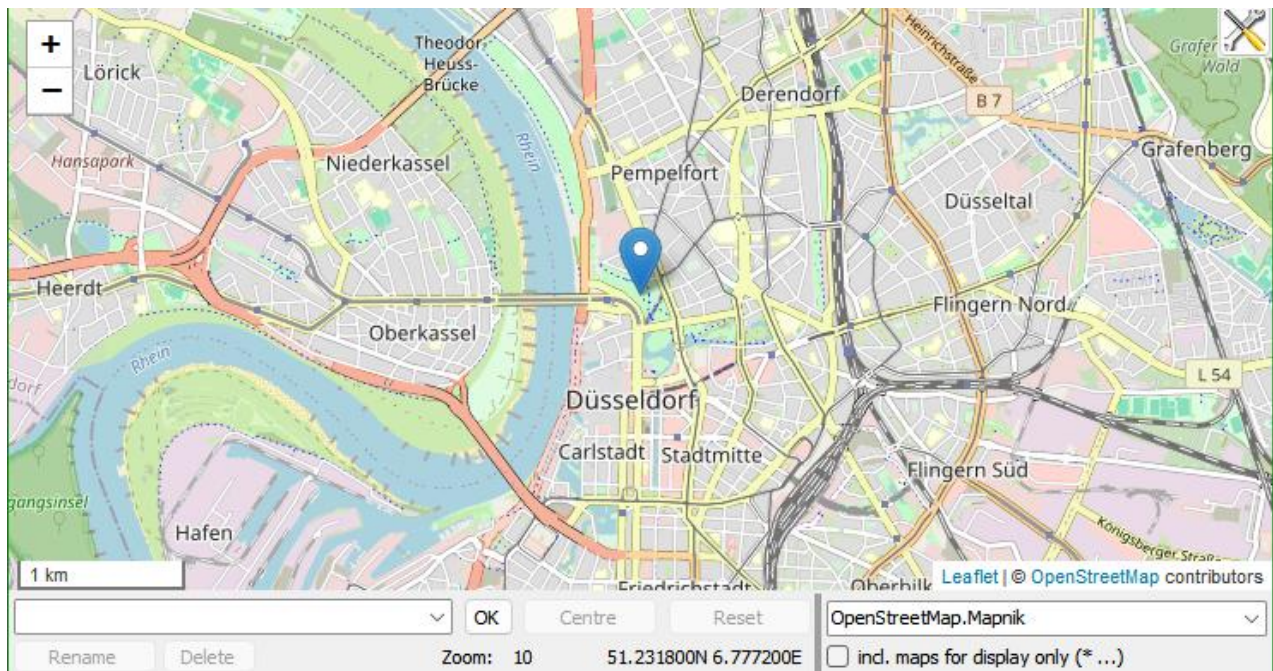
Hint: Technically it would also be possible to use Google Maps, but this would require a fee-based account. With Bing Maps, at least a personalized key is necessary. Due to that, the full functionality is only offered with OpenStreetMap.

The display (only display, no change) of the recording location in maps from Google Maps or Bing Maps is possible

- via display of a map in the standard browser, see [Other features](#).
- in the variant for .Net 4.6.1 or higher and if WebView2 runtime is installed, more details at the end of this chapter.

Note for users of the variant for Windows XP/.Net 4.0: The maps are loaded via Internet Explorer. Windows XP only runs old versions of Internet Explorer, which massively limits the number of usable maps. So, it seems (as of December 2022) with Internet Explorer 8 it is only possible to use the maps from OpenStreetMap.Mapnik, when selecting other maps, the display remains blank.

Functionality with OpenStreetMap



In the displayed map section two buttons "+" and "-" are shown in the upper left corner to select the zoom factor. Zoom factor can be changed via mouse wheel as well. With pressed shift key, left mouse button and mouse pointer an area can be marked which then is shown enlarged.

In case the selected image contains GPS-coordinates, the corresponding map section is displayed and the recording location is marked. The map section can be moved with the mouse. Via moving the marker, a new position can be set, which then can be stored in the image together with the other changed data (e.g., comment).

If the selected image contains a value in Exif.GPSInfo.GPSImgDirection, the shooting direction is displayed as a line starting from the marker for the recording location. If Exif.Photo.FocalLengthIn35mmFilm is also filled, the shooting angle is derived from this and the shooting direction is displayed as a circle segment on the map. If Exif.Image.Orientation indicates that the photo was taken in portrait format, this is taken into account accordingly. The shooting angle may be displayed incorrectly because the picture was taken in portrait format but Exif.Image.Orientation is not filled accordingly or if the picture was cropped after it was taken.

In case the selected image does not contain GPS-coordinates, the map section around the last used position will be displayed without marker - unless the map is hidden using the option described below in section [Controls](#). By using the right mouse button, a marker can be set, which also can be moved later. An existing marker can be removed with the right mouse button.

Search and selection of a position

Below the map section is a combo box in which coordinates, addresses or other search terms can be entered to display the corresponding position on the map. The search is started by pressing the Return key or the "OK" button. The following entries are possible:

- Free input, e.g.
New York, central station
Düsseldorf, Königsallee 1a
A "free-form query" is carried out using Nominatim. Commas are optional, but improve performance by reducing the complexity of the search.
- Structured query
With the "Structured query" from Nominatim, you can search more specifically because you use parameters. There is a mask for entering the parameters, which is opened by double-clicking with the mouse or pressing F10 in the combo box for the search. You can enter
 - City
 - House number and streetname
 - County
 - State
 - Country,
 - Postal code

You can also enter the query directly in the combo box, e.g:
city=Düsseldorf&street=Königsalle 1a

The following parameter are supported according to [Nominatim-Documentation](#):

amenity	name and/or type of POI
street	houzenumber and streetname
city	city
county	county
state	state
country	country
postalcode	postal code

Note: I have not been able to make a successful query with "amenity". In this context, it is interesting that "amenity" is not supported on [Nominatim Demo](#), which is why it is also missing in the mask for the structured query.

- Coordinates such as
52.432N 8.345E
or
52°30'18.4 "S 8°42'32.9 "W
The decimal point or comma can be used as a decimal separator.

If a Nominatim search returns several results, these are displayed in a table in which you can then select the appropriate location. A maximum of 10 results is returned. If the matching

location is not included, the search must be narrowed down by entering additional parameters.

If a location is found or selected, the corresponding map section is displayed and the corresponding location is marked.

The last search results and the last items saved with an image are displayed when the field is expanded and can be selected. After selection, the corresponding map section is displayed and the selected position is marked.

More information on queries using Nominatim (Free-from Query and Structured query) is described here: <https://nominatim.org/release-docs/develop/api/Search/>.

Controls

The button in the top right-hand corner of the map can be used to define settings for the map:

- Units of length: km/m or mi/ft
The selected unit then also applies to the search circle diameter in the [Mask "Search via properties"](#).
- Show scale on map
- Hide map if no GPS data available
This makes it easier to visualize when no GPS data is available for an image. If you want to add GPS data, click in the area intended for the map to display the map there.

Settings for displaying the search circle and for recording direction with recording angle:

- Color
- Opacity of the lines
- Opacity of the fill area in the circle segment
- Radius display direction of view in pixels

Changes are applied directly; the original settings can be restored using the "Cancel" button.

Below the map section you find:

- Combo box for search and selection of a position
The input options are described under [Search and selection of a position](#).
- Button "OK"
After pressing this button, the search for a position is started.
- Button "Centre"
After pressing this button, the map is moved in a way that the marker is shown in the center.
- Button "Reset"
In case coordinates were already stored in the image and the marker was moved, the marker will be moved back to the stored position. In case no coordinates were stored in the image and a marker was set, the marker will be removed.
- Selection list for map source

One of the following sources can be selected:

Name	Type	Max. Zoom	Copyright
CartoDB.Voyager	Street	19	© OpenStreetMap contributors © CartoDB
CartoDB.VoyagerLabelsUnder	Street	19	© OpenStreetMap contributors © CartoDB

Name	Type	Max. Zoom	Copyright
Esri.WorldImagery	Satellite	20	Tiles © Esri — Source: Esri, i-cubed, USDA, USGS, AEX, GeoEye, Getmapping, Aerogrid, IGN, IGP, UPR-EGP, and the GIS User Community
Esri.WorldImagery+Hydda.RoadsAndLabels	hybrid (Satellite + Street up to Zoom 17)	20	Tiles © Esri — Source: Esri, i-cubed, USDA, USGS, AEX, GeoEye, Getmapping, Aerogrid, IGN, IGP, UPR-EGP, and the GIS User Community, Tiles courtesy of OpenStreetMap Sweden — Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors
Esri.WorldImagery+Stamen.TonerHybrid	hybrid (Satellite + Street)	20	Tiles © Esri — Source: Esri, i-cubed, USDA, USGS, AEX, GeoEye, Getmapping, Aerogrid, IGN, IGP, UPR-EGP, and the GIS User Community, Map tiles by Stamen Design, CC BY 3.0 — Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors
Esri.WorldStreetMap	Street	19	Tiles © Esri — Source: Esri, DeLorme, NAVTEQ, USGS, Intermap, iPC, NRCAN, Esri Japan, METI, Esri China (Hong Kong), Esri (Thailand), TomTom, 2012
Esri.WorldTopoMap	topographic	19	Tiles © Esri — Esri, DeLorme, NAVTEQ, TomTom, Intermap, iPC, USGS, FAO, NPS, NRCAN, GeoBase, Kadaster NL, Ordnance Survey, Esri Japan, METI, Esri China (Hong Kong), and the GIS User Community
OpenStreetMap.Mapnik	Street	18	© OpenStreetMap contributors
OpenStreetMapDE	Street	18	© OpenStreetMap contributors
OpenTopoMap	topographic	17	Map data: © OpenStreetMap contributors, SRTM Map style: © OpenTopoMap (CC-BY-SA)
Stamen.Terrain	Terrain	17	Map tiles by Stamen Design, CC BY 3.0 — Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors
Wikimedia	Street	19	Wikimedia

- Checkbox "incl. maps for display only (* ...)"

If checked, additional maps that can only be used for display are displayed in the selection list, see also [Displaying the recording location on maps from Google Maps/Bing Maps](#) below.

Background information: Google Maps and Bing Maps require WebView2. However,

WebView2 occasionally causes problems. These problems are avoided if you do not check this option, However, this means that Google Maps and Bing Maps are not usable.

- Button "Rename"

If a position is selected in the combo box for search and selection, it can be renamed. This allows especially saved locations, which are initially only listed with coordinates, to be given a meaningful name. After pressing the button, a mask is opened in which the new name is to be entered.

- Button "Delete"

If a position is selected in the combo box for search and selection, it can be deleted from the list.

Note: The maximum number of named and unnamed positions that are saved in the user-related configuration file when the program is closed is defined in [Mask "Settings"](#).

- Display of position and zoom

In the center below the zoom factor selected in the map as well as the latitude and longitude of the marked position are displayed.

The bottom right corner of the map contains links to "Leaflet" (this component is used to display the map) and links to the sources for showing maps, which are opened in standard browser.

The configuration of maps is based on:

<http://leaflet-extras.github.io/leaflet-providers/preview/>.

Additional map sources for Leaflet can be configured, see [Configuration of Leaflet map sources](#).

Displaying the recording location on maps from Google Maps/Bing Maps

The recording location can be displayed in the program on maps from Google Maps or Bing Maps if the following requirements are met:

- The variant for .Net 4.6.1 and higher is used.
- WebView2 Runtime is installed.

The map options configured as URLs (Google Maps, Bing Maps and possibly others, see [Configuration of URLs for displaying a map](#)) can then be selected. These options are marked with "*" at the beginning.

With these map options, the recording location can only be displayed but not changed. Therefore, all the controls listed above are not activated, except for the selection list for map source. The display in the program is only an integrated web browser and the terms and conditions of Google Maps or Bing Maps apply for the use and privacy, for self-defined map sources the conditions of the respective provider.

If WebView2 Runtime is not yet installed, it can be downloaded here:

<https://developer.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-edge/webview2/#download-section>

On this page, select and install the "Evergreen Standalone Installer" suitable for the operating system.

Before installing WebView2 Runtime, you can use the menu item "Tools - Map in Standard Browser" to check whether the additional map options are useful for.

3.6 Single image edit

For the editing of single images/videos, the tab "single image edit" has to be selected.

Below the picture are:

- Combo box for the name of the artist (author)

The name can be entered directly. When you save the name, it will be entered in a list so that the name later can be selected from the list or is completed after entering the first letters.

If no artist was entered for the image, a default can be used (defined in the [Mask "Settings"](#)). If the default is used, this is indicated by a note behind the combo box.

If in the [Mask "Settings"](#) no field (tag) has been configured to store the name, "not configured" is displayed as the label and the input field is not active. The configured fields (tags) are displayed as tooltips when the mouse pointer is positioned over the label.

- Buttons to select rating (for more details see [Rating](#))
- Text field for comment

The comment can be freely entered or taken from the lists "Recent comments" or "Predefined comments" and then can be changed. Once the input begins, the input is used as filter for the list "Recent comments", i.e., the list displays the entries in which the text entered in the text field for comment is included. However, this requires that the tab "Recent comments" is in front, not "Predefined comments".

When you save the comment, it will be added to the list of recent comments. If it is configured (see [Mask "Settings"](#)) you can jump directly into the list of "Recent comments" using the cursor down key. In this case, if necessary, it is automatically switched from the tab "Predefined comments" to tab "Recent comments".

If in the [Mask "Settings"](#) no field (tag) has been configured to store the comment, "not configured" is displayed as the label and the input field is not active. The configured fields (tags) are displayed as tooltips when the mouse pointer is positioned over the label.

Two lists are available for an easier entry of the comment:

- Recent comments

This list displays the most recent comments saved. Above the list there is a text box for entering a filter. If, for example, "Smith" is entered there, all comments are displayed in the list that contains "Smith". Also, after an input in the text field for comment the list is filtered accordingly.

- Predefined comments

This list displays comments, which have been predefined in [Mask "Predefined comments"](#). In that mask predefined comments are assigned to a category (e.g., city, Last Name). Above the list is a selection list for these categories. With "*", all entries are displayed.

Entries from the two lists can be transferred into the text field for comment via the context menu of the list (right mouse button) or via a keyboard shortcut:

- Transfer (overwriting the text field for comment)
Keyboard shortcut: Return key
- Append with space
Keyboard shortcut: Spacebar
- Append with comma
Keyboard shortcuts: Comma
- Append with semicolon
Keyboard shortcut: Semicolon

For the assignment of keywords there are two options in the input area on the far right:

- Text box for free keywords

In the text box on top several key words can be entered. Each line is regarded as a keyword. Keywords can include spaces.

- Tree with check boxes for predefined keywords

In the [Mask "Predefined keywords"](#) predefined keywords with hierarchy can be defined. For each of these keywords a check box is displayed.

The keywords for images are stored in Iptc.Application2.Keywords, for videos in XMP-dc:Subject. The tags can be changed in [General configuration file](#), see [Tag for keywords](#).

Rating

Rating can be entered using the star buttons on the right hand side of input field for artist. In the version for Windows XP with .NET 4.0, small circles are displayed instead of stars until a rating is selected. If configured ([Mask "Settings"](#)), additionally a rating "rejected" can be defined as it is foreseen by Adobe XMP specification and MWG Guidelines for handling image metadata:

<https://developer.adobe.com/xmp/docs/xmp-namespaces/xmp/>

xmp:Rating: A user-assigned rating for this file. The value shall be -1 or in the range [0..5], where -1 indicates "rejected" and 0 indicates "unrated".

[Metadata Working Group \(MWG\)](#)

The rating property allows the user to assign a fixed value (often displayed as "stars") to an image. Usually, 1-5 star ratings are used. In addition, some tools support negative rating values (such as -1) that allows for marking "rejects" without deleting files in production.

Two buttons on the right-hand side of the stars allow to reset rating to last stored value or to delete rating (i.e. set to zero).

Rating can be stored in several tags. The following tags are defined in standard configuration (notation exiv2/ExifTool):

- Xmp.xmp.Rating / XMP-xmp:Rating
- Exif.Image.Rating / IFD0:Rating
- Exif.Image.RatingPercent / IFD0:RatingPercent
- Xmp.MicrosoftPhoto.Rating / XMP-microsoft:RatingPercent
- Xmp.xmp.RatingPercent / XMP-xmp:RatingPercent

Please note, that -1 for "rejected" is stored in Xmp.xmp.Rating / XMP-xmp:Rating only. The other tags seem not to provide for this or even do not allow negative values technically. If "Reject" is selected, a zero will be stored in the other tags.

When displaying the stars, values are checked in the above sequence. So, if Xmp.xmp.Rating is filled, it's value is used.

Some tags store rating as percent. The following table shows, how Microsoft Explorer does conversion. QuickImageComment follows this approach:

Rating percent	Converts to Stars	Stars are written as
1 - 12 %	1	1 %
13- 37 %	2	25 %
38 - 62 %	3	50 %
63 - 87 %	4	75 %
88 - 100 %	5	99 %

Configurable input area

On the bottom right is a configurable area in which additional properties can be changed. The configuration is done in the [Mask "Field definitions"](#), group "Change of properties". The mask can be opened via context menu in this area (in this case directly with selection of group) or via menu.

On the left-hand side of each input field is the description. The description is supplemented with the data type of the field. Please note, that for some ExifTool properties no data type is

provided. If multiple values are allowed for a property by the program, the text box is displayed with vertical scroll bar. The number of rows displayed is configured in [Mask "Field definitions"](#). One row corresponds to one value. Properties, for which only one value is allowed, are displayed in a combo box. This makes it possible to select recently entered values for this property.

For properties of type "date" is a small button on the right-hand side of the input field:



With this button a calendar is opened to select a date. For properties, which can have several values, only the first date can be set via the calendar.

For property "Exif.Image.Orientation" (type: Short), a drop down list shows the valid (numeric) values together with an explanation (e.g., "bottom, left (180° + horiz.flip)"). After saving changes of Exif.Image.Orientation, image will be rotated accordingly. Same applies for the ExifTool-Tag "IFD0:Orientation" (which refers to the same meta data but exiv2 and ExifTool use different names).

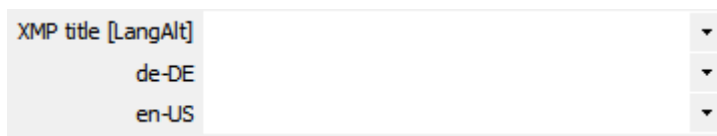
The following explanations of Exif and XMP properties only apply to fields that are to be changed with exiv2:

For Exif properties the program allows only one value. For IPTC and XMP properties it depends on the particular property or the data type. According to the Exif specification, it seems permissible to assign several values to each property and the library exiv2 used in the program allows it too. However, there is (almost) no Exif property for which multiple values are meaningful and also other programs usually do not support it. Therefore, this program allows only one value per Exif property. If multiple values were assigned to an Exif property with another program, these values will be shown as one string in the input box, separated by vertical bar ("|"). This string can be changed. Only one value is stored then.

ExifTool indicates for each property if several values are allowed. This information is taken into account by this program.

Special features are XMP properties of the data type "LangAlt" (exiv2) or "lang-alt" (ExifTool). For them multiple values can be defined, with one value for the default language and one value for each additional language. The mask contains a corresponding number of input boxes for each property. The languages can be selected in the [Mask "Settings"](#).

In the following example, the input fields for the XMP property Xmp.dc.title are shown. As a description "XMP title" was configured. The text box directly on the right-hand side of this label is used for the value of the default language, below fields for German (Germany) and English (United States):



In case in the image a value is defined for a language that is not selected in [Mask "Settings"](#), it is displayed additionally and the value for this language can be changed too.

XMP properties of the data type "XmpText" can have very complex values, such as the following value, which was added by Windows Live Photo Gallery as information about people displayed in the image:

```
/MPRI:Regions[1]/MPReg:Rectangle=0.210938, 0.477372, 0.079102, 0.119708
/MPRI:Regions[1]/MPReg:PersonDisplayName=Max Mustermann
/MPRI:Regions[2]/MPReg:Rectangle=0.498047, 0.421898, 0.084961, 0.125547
/MPRI:Regions[2]/MPReg:PersonDisplayName=Barbara Beispielfrau
/MPRI:Regions[2]/MPReg:PersonEmailDigest=1234567890ABCDEF1234567890ABCDEF123456
/MPRI:Regions[2]/MPReg:PersonLiveIdCID=1234567890123456789
/MPRI:Regions[2]/MPReg:PersonSourceID=WL:1234567890123456789
```

This program can not verify the validity of those values. On the other hand, usually you will change such complex values also with the program, with which the values originally were assigned. But in this particular example, you could delete the values for PersonEmailDigest, PersonLiveIdCID and PersonSourceID for reasons of data protection before distributing the image. For the same reason you might also just save the first name instead of the full name. In this way not the whole information is lost, who is displayed in the picture.

Separate mask for data input

With the F10 key or double-click in input fields for artist (author), comment or in configurable input area, a [Mask for input of data](#) is opened to have a larger and variable input range for long and/or multi-line values. Via this mask also the [Mask "Edit / insert placeholder"](#) can be opened.

Mask to insert and edit placeholders

With the Shift-F10 key or double-click with Shift-key in input fields for artist (author), comment or in configurable input area the [Mask "Edit / insert placeholder"](#) is opened. Placeholders are replaced with the value of the referenced property during saving and thus allow copying values from one property to another.

Reset entries

By pressing the Esc key, the inputs for artists, comment and keywords as well as in the configurable input range are reset and the corresponding values from the image are displayed again. With the menu item "Image - Reset" or the corresponding icon (see [Tool bar](#)), all inputs to the image are reset.

Color marking of inputs

Changed entries for artist, comment and keywords as well as in the configurable input area are marked by a light-yellow background. If the entry is reset, the background becomes white again.

Instead of light-yellow, another color can be specified in the general configuration file: [General configuration file](#) - [Colors](#)

Restrictions

Some properties can be changed, but cannot be added. This is especially true for vendor-specific EXIF information and for the more complex XMP data structures. If properties could not be added, a message is displayed after saving.

Input in the tabs for properties

Some properties can also be changed in the "Overview", "Exif", "IPTC" and "ExifTool" tabs. Changeable values are displayed with a white background, non-changeable ones with a light gray background.

Changing the properties is only possible in single image editing. In contrast to input in the configurable input area, it is not possible to define input checks and to select older input directly. After changing and exiting the cell, it is displayed in light yellow. Input in the tabs is enabled for simple texts to make occasional changes without configuring an input field for this purpose.

Since properties can be changed both in the tabs and in the standard input fields, conflicts may occur. These are detected when you save and you can then decide which input to use.

Here for information are the rules, what properties can be changed in the tabs:

- For exiv2 properties, the data type is one of the following:
 - Ascii - except for Exif date values.
 - Comment

- Byte, if used for UCS2 encoded text
- String

Numeric data types are not supported here. Examples for these values are exposure time, aperture and resolution. For these examples, and for the vast majority (if not all) numeric values, it is not useful to change them after the image has been taken. For some tags (e.g. Exif.Image.ExifTag = pointer to EXIF IFD) there is an additional risk that a wrong value will cause the metadata as a whole to become unreadable.

Changing values for date/time is not supported here, because these values are mostly set when the file is created and should hardly be changed afterwards.

There is no data type restriction for ExifTool properties.

- The representation of the value in the tab corresponds to the original format for this property.

This condition is almost always met for the supported data types, regardless of the display format.

Example for a property where this is not always given: Exif.GPSInfo.GPSLongitudeRef is stored as "E" or "W". If "Interpreted" is selected for the display, "East" or "West" will be displayed. Then the value cannot be changed.

In the following two cases the display format must be set to "Interpreted" for a change:

- UCS2 encoded text is stored as a byte sequence, so original format is a number sequence - which would be very unwieldy for input.
 - For the Comment data type, the original format consists of the charset specification and the actual value. Since the charset specification is set via [Mask "Settings"](#), it should not interfere with input.
- Only one value can be stored for the property.
This restriction is made because entering multiple values in two places (in a tab for properties and in the configurable input area or the input area for keywords) can lead to further conflicts. The decision would then arise not only which of two values to save, but which values from two lists of values. In the sense of a simple handling - and for this the input in the tabs of properties is made possible - therefore only properties with one value are supported here.

Since all XMP data types provide to store several values for one property, the input in the tab "XMP" is not possible.

Save changes

The changes can be saved by:

- Menu item "Image - Save"
- Menu item "Image - Previous" (after saving the previous image is displayed)
- Menu item "Image - Next" (after saving the next image is displayed)
- Return key in the text field for comment (if configured in this way, see [Mask "Settings"](#))

For these menu items, there are also icons in the toolbar (see [Tool bar](#)) and keyboard shortcuts (see [Keyboard shortcuts](#)).

3.7 Multiple images edit

In order to edit several images/videos in one batch the tab "Multi image edit" has to be selected.

To change the properties of several images/videos together, these images/videos first have to be selected. But you also can add images/videos to the selection later. If all images/videos have same value for one property (e.g., all images/videos have the same artist), this value is also displayed. If they have different values, the corresponding field is left blank.

On the right-hand side in the tab "Multi image edit" a table with the selected images/videos and their current values will be displayed for the chosen properties. The properties can be

defined in Mask "Field definitions", group "Table view during multiple editing". The mask can be opened via context menu in the table (in this case directly with selection of group) or via menu. By clicking on the column header, the images/videos are sorted by the column. By clicking on a line, the corresponding image/video will be selected and will be displayed when you switch to tab "Single image edit".

The values for properties are input in the appropriate fields as described in Single image edit.

For each property you can decide whether they are to be taken over for all images/videos.

For the comment you have following possibilities:

- No change of existing comment
- Overwrite existing comment
- Insert new comment before existing
- Append new comment to existing

For keywords you have following possibilities:

- No change of existing keywords
- Overwrite existing keywords
- Append new keywords

For all other values you can define via checkboxes whether the value is taken over or not.

Changes in settings, whether data are to be taken over for all images/videos, are marked with gold background. Instead of gold, another color can be specified in the general configuration file: [General configuration file](#) - [Colors](#).

The changes are saved using the menu entry "Image - Save", the corresponding icon (see [Tool bar](#)) or the associated keyboard shortcut (see [Keyboard shortcuts](#)).

Notes:

The tab "Multi image edit" can also be used just to see different properties for a selection of images/videos in one table. This is the reason why you can select any property in [Mask "Field definitions"](#) and you are not limited to editable properties there.

If an image/video is removed from the selection, no new comparison of the values takes place for performance reasons. If different values were found before and the corresponding field is empty because of that, it will not be filled if the values of the now still selected images/videos are identical.

3.8 Other features

Menu "File"

Select folder ...	Opens a mask, where a folder can be selected in a folder tree or from a list box with last selected folders. In this list box, folders can be selected via double click. In this way the space for folder tree in main mask can be used for other information, e.g., a longer a list of files.
Open ...	Opens an input mask to open folders or files via entering the full name (i.e., including complete path). Also, URLs can be entered, the respective file will then be downloaded into folder "Downloads".
Search via properties	Opens Mask "Search via properties"

Select all	All images/videos displayed in the file list are selected, e.g., to rename them.
Refresh folder tree	The folder tree is updated.
Refresh file list	The file list is updated. In general file list is updated automatically, when a file was added, renamed or deleted by another program. In rare cases the update may not work or is delayed. Then this feature can be used to ensure an update.
Rename files	Opens Mask "Rename files"
Compare files	Opens Mask "Compare files"
Change recording date/time	Opens Mask "Change recording date and time"
Remove meta data	Opens Mask "Remove meta data"
Export: selected properties of images in folder	Writes selected properties of all the images/videos contained in one directory, including subdirectories, into a file. The file contains a header with the name of the exported properties and for each image one line with the values. The columns are separated by tabs, so that the file easily can be opened with Excel or another spreadsheet calculation program. Use Mask "Field definitions" (group: "Export of properties in text file") to define, which properties are exported. The file is encoded in UTF-8 with Byte Order Mark (BOM).
Export: all properties of selected images	Writes all properties of the selected images/videos into files; for each image one text file with all properties (meta-data) of the image is created. The files are encoded in UTF-8 with Byte Order Mark (BOM).
Set file date to date image generated	The file properties "Created at" and "Modified at" can be set to the date/time when image was generated. The date when image was generated is read from Exif.Photo.DateTimeOriginal. The property can be changed in General configuration file .
Exit	Exit the program

Menu "Image"

Save	Save the changes in the image/video
First	Save the changes in the current image/video and switch to the first image/video
Previous	Save the changes in the current image/video and switch to the previous image/video
Next	Save the changes in the current image/video and switch to the next image/video

Last	Save the changes in the current image/video and switch to the last image/video
Reset	Changes in current image/video made since the last save are reset
Delete	Delete the selected image/video files, if it applies with associated files (see Mask "Settings", setting "rename and delete also for following file extensions"). Depending on the settings of Recycle Bin, it is moved to Recycle Bin or deleted permanently. To view and change this: right click on Recycle Bin on Desktop and select properties. Confirmation prior to delete: • If more than one file shall be deleted, this always has to be confirmed. • If a single file shall be deleted, it depends on property "Display delete confirmation dialog" of Recycle Bin, if confirmation is needed.
Copy to ...	Copy the selected images/videos to another folder
Move to ...	Move the selected images/videos to another folder
Permanently delete	Permanently delete the selected image files, if it applies with associated files (see Mask "Settings", setting "rename and delete also for following file extensions"). The files cannot be restored. Confirmation before permanent deletion is required according to the same rules as for "Delete".

Menu "Tools"

Settings	Opens Mask "Settings"
Field definitions	Opens Mask "Field definitions"
Predefined comments	Opens Mask "Predefined comments"
Predefined keywords	Opens Mask "Predefined keywords"
Select/edit data template	Opens Mask "Select and edit data template"
Load data from template:	Load data from template; for more details see Mask "Select and edit data template"
Image in own window	Opens Mask "Image in own window"
Image details in own window	An additional window is opened to show the image details (see Display of image details). Hint: only possible, if image details are not yet displayed in main mask; useful if two monitors are available.

Map in own window	An additional window is opened to show a map (see Recording location on map). Hint: only possible, if map is not yet displayed in main mask; useful if two monitors are available.
Map in Standard Browser	A submenu contains several options for displaying Google Maps and Bing Maps in the default browser. URLs for this display are stored in General configuration file , which contains also further hints to change the entries or add new ones. Note: change of GPS-data is not possible here.
Customize mask	Opens Mask "Customize mask"
Remove all mask adjustments	Removes all adjustments in all masks, which were defined using Mask "Customize mask" and set to default values again.
Language	For selection of language (Deutsch, English, ...)
Language for ExifTool	To select the language for ExifTool, applies to tag names and some values.
Storage location for user settings	Opens a mask to display and change the storage location for user settings: • %Appdata%: If several users are created on the computer, each user has his own settings. Settings are kept during upgrade on newer program version. Also to be selected, if Program folder is write-protected. • Program folder: Recommended for portable usage on USB-stick: the settings are on USB-stick too, no settings will be stored on other computer. When upgrading to a newer program version, settings need to be copied manually or program files in currently used folder have to be overwritten.

Menu "Edit-external"

...	The beginning of the menu is filled dynamically according to the entries in Mask "Configuration Edit-external" .
Manage ...	Opens Mask "Configuration Edit-external" .

Menu "Help"

List shortcut keys	Lists all shortcut keys for all masks
About ...	Displays mask with program information (version, etc.)
Check for new version ...	Opens Mask "Check for new version"

Webpage	Direct access to the website www.quickimagecomment.de : Homepage with recent messages, download area and change history
GitHub	Direct access to the GitHub repository with source code, issues (errors, feature requests) and discussions
Help	Displays the help for this mask

3.9 Tool bar

Via the menu "View" the tool bar can be displayed or hidden or displayed in the same row as the menu. The last option allows using the symbols without reducing the usable height of the main mask. However, then the symbols are rather small.

List of symbols:

	Refresh file list In general file list is updated automatically, when a file was added, renamed or deleted by another program. In rare cases the update may not work or is delayed. Then this feature can be used to ensure an update.
	Opens Mask "Rename files"
	Opens Mask "Change recording date and time"
	Save
	Save image/video and switch to first image
	Save image/video and switch to previous image
	Save image/video and switch to next image
	Save image/video and switch to last image
	Load data from template; for more details see Mask "Select and edit data template"
	Reset of changes since last save

	Delete image/video files, if it applies with associated files (see Mask "Settings", setting "rename and delete also for following file extensions") Depending on the settings of Recycle Bin, it is moved to Recycle Bin or deleted permanently. If this button is pressed while holding down the Shift key, it is deleted permanently. In Mask "Settings", you can specify that pressing this button always deletes files permanently (i.e. even if the Shift key is not pressed). If this is activated, the button has a red border. Confirmation prior to delete: • If more than one file shall be deleted, this always has to be confirmed. • If a single file shall be deleted, it depends on property "Display delete confirmation dialog" of Recycle Bin, if confirmation is needed.
	Zoom - fit (whole image is displayed)
	Zoom - 1:4 (show image with scale 1:4)
	Zoom - 1:2 (show image with scale 1:2)
	Zoom - 1:1 (show image with scale 1:1)
	Rotate image to the left (Rotation is saved in Exif.Image.Orientation when the image is saved)
	Rotate image to the right (Rotation is saved in Exif.Image.Orientation when the image is saved)
	Opens Mask "Adjust view"
	Opens Mask "Settings"
	Opens Mask "Field definitions"
	Opens Mask "Predefined comments" to enter and change predefined comments
	Opens Mask "Predefined keywords" to enter and change predefined keywords
	Opens Mask "Search via properties"

3.10 Keyboard shortcuts

The following general shortcut keys are defined:

F1	Opens help
----	------------

F2	Opens Mask "Rename files"
F5	Refresh file list
F6	Show image and central input fields only
F7	Rotate image to the left (Rotation is saved in Exif.Image.Orientation when the image is saved)
F8	Rotate image to the right (Rotation is saved in Exif.Image.Orientation when the image is saved)
F11	Save image and switch to previous image If this assignment is deleted (see Mask "Customize mask" , Shortcut key), F11 will toggle view mode between normal and maximized.
F12	Save image and switch to next image
Ctrl-1	Zoom - 1:1 (show image with scale 1:1)
Ctrl-2	Zoom - 1:2 (show image with scale 1:2)
Strg-4	Zoom - 1:4 (show image with scale 1:4)
Ctrl-Shift-2	Zoom - 2:1 (show image with scale 2:1)
Ctrl-Shift-4	Zoom - 4:1 (show image with scale 4:1)
Ctrl-Shift-8	Zoom - 8:1 (show image with scale 8:1)
Ctrl-E	Opens Mask "Settings"
Ctrl-F	Zoom - fit (whole image is displayed)
Ctrl-I	Opens Mask "Predefined keywords" to enter and change predefined keywords
Ctrl-K	Opens Mask "Predefined comments" to enter and change predefined comments
Ctrl-L	Delete image/video file
Ctrl-S	Save

These shortcut keys can be modified and new can be defined, see [Mask "Customize mask"](#). The current settings are displayed using menu entry "? - List shortcut keys".

Additionally, in special areas some shortcut keys are defined, which cannot be changed.

In the lists for last and predefined comments:

Return key	Transfer (overwriting the text field for comment)
Space bar	Append with space
Comma	Append with comma

Semicolon	Append with semicolon
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In all input fields for properties:

Esc	Reset input and show again the value saved in the image file
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In input fields for artist (author), comment and in configurable input area:

F10	Open a mask with larger and variable input field Mask for input of data
Shift-F10	Open Mask "Edit / insert placeholder"

In the input field for comment:

Return key	Save and show next image (if configured)
------------	--

In the input field for file filter above the file list:

Return key	Refresh the file list using the filter
------------	--

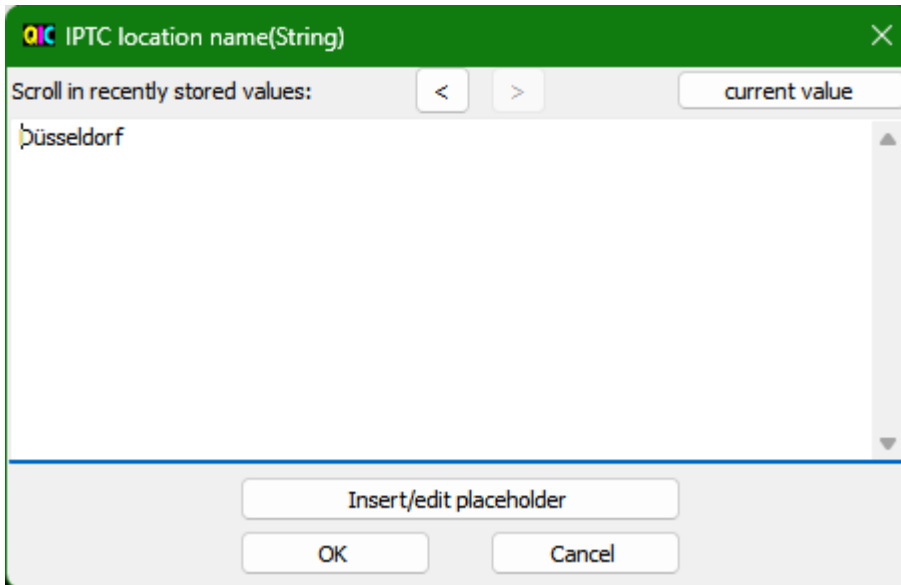
3.11 Footer

In the footer are displayed:

- Number of images or videos in the file list
- Main memory (Physical memory in use by active processes) used by the program and free main memory
- Note if the displayed file is read-only or no access is allowed
- The information that an image is read ("read ...") when an image is to be displayed, which has not yet been read in advance and therefore is not present in the cache
- , when the cache is stuffed (i.e., images/videos are read on "stock")

4 Mask for input of data

With the F10 key or double-click in input fields for artist (author), comment or in configurable input area this mask is opened to have a larger and variable input range for long and/or multi-line values:



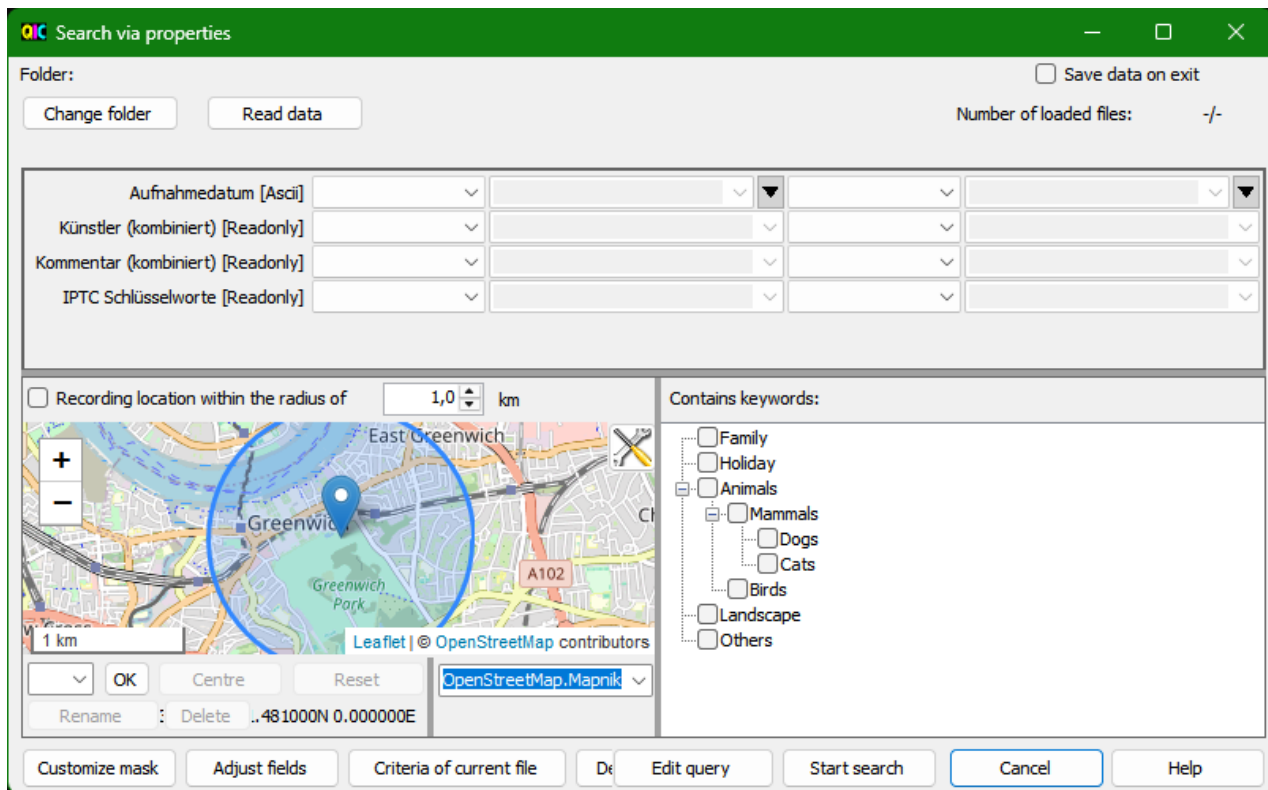
The size of the mask can be adjusted.

Command buttons:

<	Scroll in recently stored values - back
>	Scroll in recently stored values - forward
current value	Show current value
Edit/insert placeholder	Open Mask "Edit / insert placeholder"
OK	Accept input and close mask
Cancel	Close mask without accepting input

5 Mask "Search via properties"

With this mask you can search for images and videos using the stored properties.



Preparation

First you should define the fields you want to search with "Adjust fields". Only for these fields, data is read from the images/videos, so that if you change the fields later, the data must be read in again.

Fields of the type "Date" always have the format "Original", as well as fields for which fixed values are given due to the Exif specification (e.g., Exif.Image.Orientation). For other fields you can choose between "Original" and "Interpreted". For numeric fields, "Interpreted" means that the values are treated as text. Often this is necessary because the interpreted values are texts like "70 mm" or "Auto" (for the value 0 of Exif.Photo.WhiteBalance).

In the "Original" format, the values of numeric fields are treated as numbers, which is important for comparisons (larger or smaller). Problems are caused by the few numeric fields, which can have several values. For example, Exif.GPSInfo.GPSLongitude consists of three values for degrees, minutes and seconds. Only one value could be used for the numerical comparison. Therefore, the format "Original" should not be used in such cases. In the concrete example (Exif.GPSInfo.GPSLongitude), it makes sense to use Image.GPSLongitudeDecimal.

For most fields, only the meta data needs to be read, which is quite fast even for larger images. However, to read data for the fields "File.ImageSize" and "Image.CodecInfo", the entire image must be read, which takes significantly more time. These fields should therefore only be included in the search if it is really necessary. In other cases, it makes little difference when reading in individual fields that may not be needed after all.

The first time it is called, the last selected folder is used as the start folder for the search. With the button "Change folder" the folder can still be changed. Afterwards the import of the data has to be started with "Read data". First the start folder and all subfolders are searched for images and videos. The number of files found is displayed in the upper right corner. For these files the data will be read in and stored in an internal table for the search. The progress bar shows the percentage of files for which data has been read in. With the button "Cancel"

next to "Read data" the reading can be cancelled. For technical reasons, however, canceling is only possible after the folders have been searched and the actual import of the data has begun.

It can happen that values are found in the files that do not have a valid format. This can happen e.g., with Exif date fields, because they are stored as texts (Exif data type "Ascii") and therefore values can be stored which do not correspond to the Exif date format. Another problem can be numeric fields which consist of several values and are configured with format "Original" (see above). If such incorrect values are found, they are displayed in a separate mask. In the case of numeric fields with multiple values, the "Interpreted" format can be used instead of the "Original" format. The values are then treated like texts during the search. In other cases, you have to decide whether to ignore this (i.e., you cannot search for the file in question using this property) or to correct the values before searching.

If the mask is closed and opened again, the data is available for the search again. A new read-in is necessary if the fields for the search criteria or the start folder are changed.

Search

The controls for entering the search criteria are

- Selection list for the first comparison operator
"=", "<>", ">", ">=", "is empty", "is not empty", for texts also "contains", "does not contain", "starts with", "does not start with", "ends with" and "does not end with"
- Input field for first value
- For date fields: Button to select a date in a calendar
- Selection list for the second comparison operator
"<>", "<", "<=", for texts also "contains", "does not contain", "does not start with", and "does not end with"
- If the first comparison operator is "=", the second comparison operator is meaningless and therefore disabled.
- Input field for second value
- For date fields: Button to select a date in a calendar

Some fields can have multiple values, e.g. keywords. For the search these values are combined to a string (e.g. "Family | Vacation | Landscape"), where the order is not defined. Therefore, for these fields only the comparison operators are available, where the order of the single values does not matter: "is empty", "is not empty", "contains", "does not contain".

The input fields for values allow to select previous entered values for this property directly. The list is completed when the search is started.

Depending on the data type of the field (displayed in square brackets after the field name) the values are to be entered as string, integer, decimal number or date.

Valid formats for decimal numbers:

- Decimal number, if necessary, with decimal separator according to regional settings in Windows and without thousands separator.
Examples: 2 or 2.1
- Fractions with numerator and denominator separated by slash.
Example: 12/100

Valid formats for date:

- Date according to the regional settings in Windows
- Exif date format: YYYY:MM:DD
- Exif date format with time: YYYY:MM:DD HH:mm or YYYY:MM:DD HH:mm:ss
- IPTC date format: YYYY-MM-DD

If only one date is specified for a date/time search, only the date is compared. If a time is also specified, the date and time will be compared.

During the search, leading or following spaces are ignored. This applies to the input in this mask and to the values read from the images/videos. For example, if the stored value is " ABC", this file will be found with the criterion "starts with 'A'".

In the lower part of the screen a map is displayed, with which you can limit the recording location. How the map can be adapted and a specific location marked there is described in [Recording location on map](#). Above the map, you can define the radius within which the search will be performed around the marked recording location. The unit of length can be changed using the button in the top right-hand corner of the map. The search area is displayed on the map with a blue circle. The checkbox to the left of this activates or deactivates the search via recording location.

The button in the top right-hand corner of the map can be used to adjust the display for the circle:

- Color
- Opacity of the lines
- Opacity of the fill area in the circle

Changes are applied directly. If main mask or the separate mask shows recording location on map, display is adjusted there as well. Due to this, here also the "Radius display direction of view" can be set, although it does not apply to the search mask. The original settings can be restored using the "Cancel" button.

If "Image.KeyWordsAccordingConfigString" is defined as a search field, a tree with the predefined keywords is displayed on the right in the lower area of the mask. Keywords to be searched for can be checked here. There may be other fields used to store keywords, but only using "Image.KeyWordsAccordingConfigString" ensures that the search is looking for the data entered in keywords section of main mask.

With "Start search" the search for the files is started, which fulfill all entered criteria. If at least one matching file is found, the mask is closed and the found files are listed in the file list of the main mask. If no matching file is found, a message is displayed and the search mask remains open.

To see all files in the selected folder again after the search in the main mask, use the menu item "File - Refresh file list" or the following button:



Saving/reading the data for search

Reading the data from the images or videos is time-consuming if there are many files to be checked. Therefore, there is an option "Save data on exit" in the top right corner of the screen.

If this option is selected:

- When the program is closed, the read-in data is saved to an XML file. This XML file has the name "QuickImageComment_FindDataTable.xml". (is configurable, see [General configuration file](#)) and is written to the same folder where the user related configuration file is located.
- When the program is restarted, this XML file is read in.
- When reading in the data structure is checked. If it does not match the configured fields, the data is not read in.
- After reading in, changes that have occurred since saving are searched for in the background:
 - Newly created files are entered
 - Entries of deleted files are removed

— Data of changed files are updated

The search can already be used, but might give incorrect results due to outdated data.

As long as the update is in progress, this is indicated at the top of the screen. As soon as the update is finished, the corresponding message disappears.

Warning: Whether a file has been modified is determined by the file attribute "modification date" (contains time with seconds). You can configure the program so that the modification date is not changed (see [File modification date when saving](#)). Then file changes will not be detected.

The following figures can only be transferred to a limited extent in absolute terms, but the relations are very clear. In the scenario, a folder with a total of 25,000 files, total size 63 GB, 15,000 of which are images or videos, is considered.

Reading in the data	About 15 minutes
Saving the data in XML file	About 1 second
Reading the data from the XML file	About 1 second
Check for changes - check only, no update required	About 2 seconds
Check for changes with about 300 new files	About 20 seconds

Further hints

The data read from the images/videos for the search is updated when images/videos are changed or deleted via this program. Generally, an update also takes place if files are added, deleted or renamed by another program. In rare cases, however, this update may not occur or is delayed.

The values of the following fields depend on the settings ([Mask "Settings"](#) and [Mask "Predefined keywords"](#)):

- Image.CommentAccordingSettings
- Image.ArtistAccordingSettings
- Image.MetaDataWarnings
- Image.MetaDataWarningsNotExiv2

The values of the following fields depend on configuration in [General configuration file](#):

- Image.RecordingDateAccordingConfig
- Image.KeywordsAccordingConfigString

If the settings or configuration are changed after the values have been read in, the values may not be correct according to the new settings. To prevent this, all values would have to be checked after the settings have been changed, which would be very time consuming - depending on the number of images and videos. When an image is re-read to display it, these values are updated. It can therefore happen that images/videos are found in the search for which the search criteria are no longer met when they are displayed. If necessary, you should re-read the data using the "Read data" button.

The XMP specification allows to specify only year (e.g., 2019) or year and month (e.g., 2019-03) as the date. These values are considered the first day of the year (2019-01-01) or the first day of the month (2019-03-01) in the search.

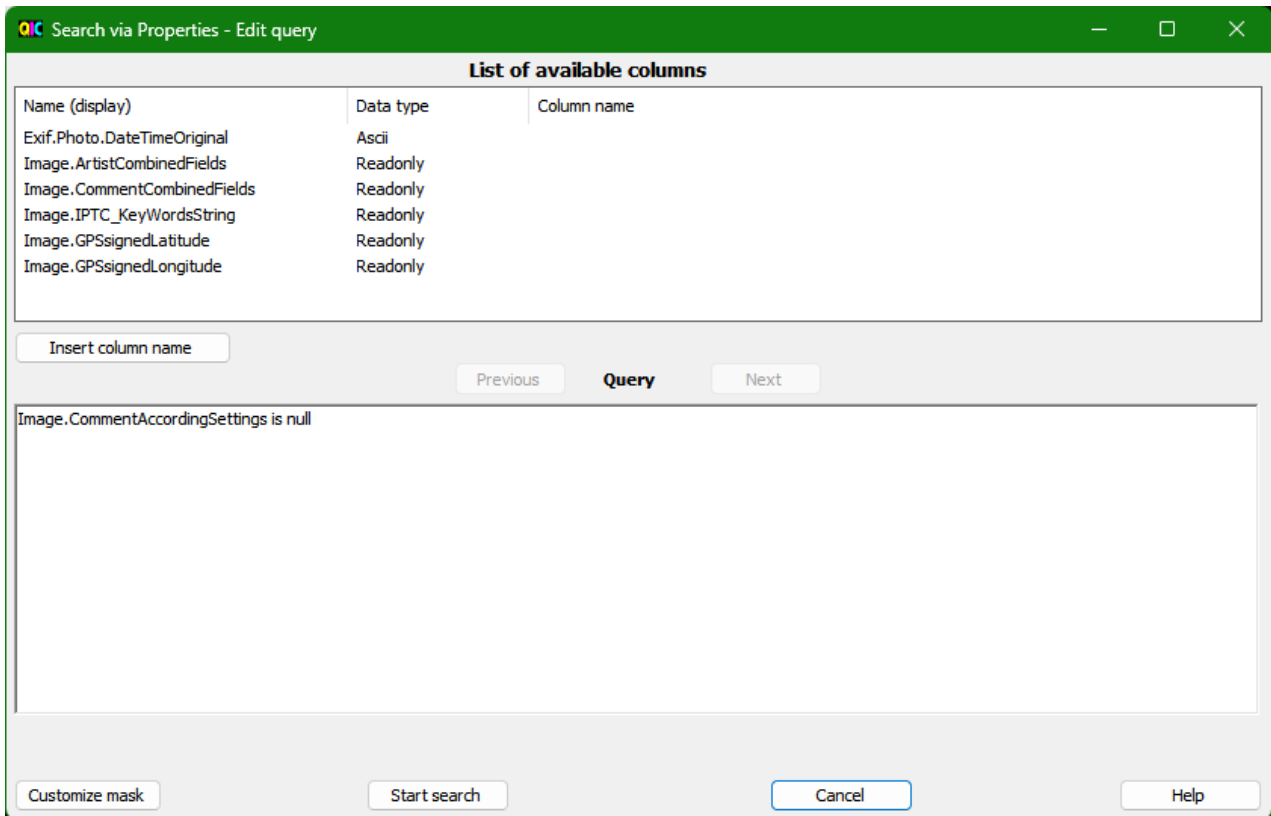
Command buttons:

Change folder	Opens a mask where the start folder for the search can be selected in a folder tree or from a drop-down list with last selected folders.
Read data	Read the data into an internal table for the search
Customize mask	Customize the mask, more details in Mask "Customize mask"
Adjust fields	Opens Mask "Field definitions" to define the fields to be searched
Criteria of current file	Accepts the values of the currently selected file as search criteria
Delete criteria	Deletes the entered criteria
Edit query	Opens Mask "Search via properties – edit query" to edit the query or to select a previously executed query
Start search	Starts the search
Cancel	Close mask without search
Help	Displays the help for this mask

5.1 Mask "Search via properties – edit query"

In this mask the query can be edited, which is formulated in a SQL-like syntax (see [DataView RowFilter Syntax \[C#\] \(csharp-examples.net\)](#) or <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/dotnet/api/system.data.datacolumn.expression?view=netframework-4.6.1>). This allows for more complex queries. Also, a previously executed query can be selected to customize and re-execute.

Some useful customizations - see examples below - are quite simple, so do not be put off by the syntax rules.



When the mask is opened, the query corresponding to the entries in [Mask "Search via properties"](#) is displayed in the text field at the bottom. The query does not contain the restriction that is defined via the map. For this restriction an additional calculation is necessary, which cannot be represented in the query alone.

The query can be changed or supplemented in the text field. To avoid typing errors, the column names can be selected in the list above and then inserted in the text field at the current cursor position using the "Insert column name" button.

Using the "Previous" button, the previously executed queries can be selected and then modified and executed again. The "Next" button is used to scroll in the other direction until you are finally back at the query that was used to open the mask - including any manual adjustments that have already been made.

Manual changes can be undone with Ctrl-Z and restored with Ctrl-Y. All changes made since the text field was filled (when the mask was opened or when "Previous" or "Next" was pressed) are undone.

The query is executed with "Start search". If a restriction was previously defined via the map in [Mask "Search via properties"](#), this will be considered during execution.

Examples:

We start with entering two criteria for Image.CommentCombinedFields in [Mask "Search via properties"](#):

Comparison operator	Value
Contains	abc
Contains	def

When opening this mask, the query will be:

Image.CommentCombinedFields like '*abc*' and Image.CommentCombinedFields like '*def*'

- Instead of searching for images/videos, where comment contains both "abc" and "def", we want to search for images/videos where comment contains one of the strings. For this we must change "and" to "or" (marked in bold):
Image.CommentCombinedFields like '*abc*' **or** Image.CommentCombinedFields like '*def*'
- [Mask "Search via properties"](#) allows to enter only two criteria for each column name. Here we can add more criteria:
Image.CommentCombinedFields like '*abc*' and Image.CommentCombinedFields like '*def*' and Image.CommentCombinedFields like '*xyz*'
- With the next query, images/videos are searched, where artist contains "Norbert Wagner" and comment contains "abc" or "def". For this purpose, brackets are needed. For better readability line breaks are included:
Image.ArtistCombinedFields like '*Norbert Wagner*' and
(Image.CommentCombinedFields like '*abc*' or Image.CommentCombinedFields like '*def*')

Hint:

Queries restricting to keywords by ticking in the tree with the predefined keywords look quite complicated:

(= 'Dogs' or like 'Dogs | *' or like '* | Dogs | *' or like '* | Dogs').

Background: For the search, the keywords are combined in a string, separated by "|", e.g., "Family | Vacation | Landscape". With this query "Dogs" will be found if it is the only, the first, the middle or the last keyword in the string. Simpler would be "like '*Dogs*'", but this would also find "Dogs cage", which may not be desirable.

Command buttons:

Insert column name	Inserts the selected column name into the text field at the current cursor position
Previous	Switch to the previously executed query
Next	Switch to next query
Customize mask	Customize the mask, more details in Mask "Customize mask"
Start search	Starts the search
Cancel	Close mask without search
Help	Displays the help for this mask

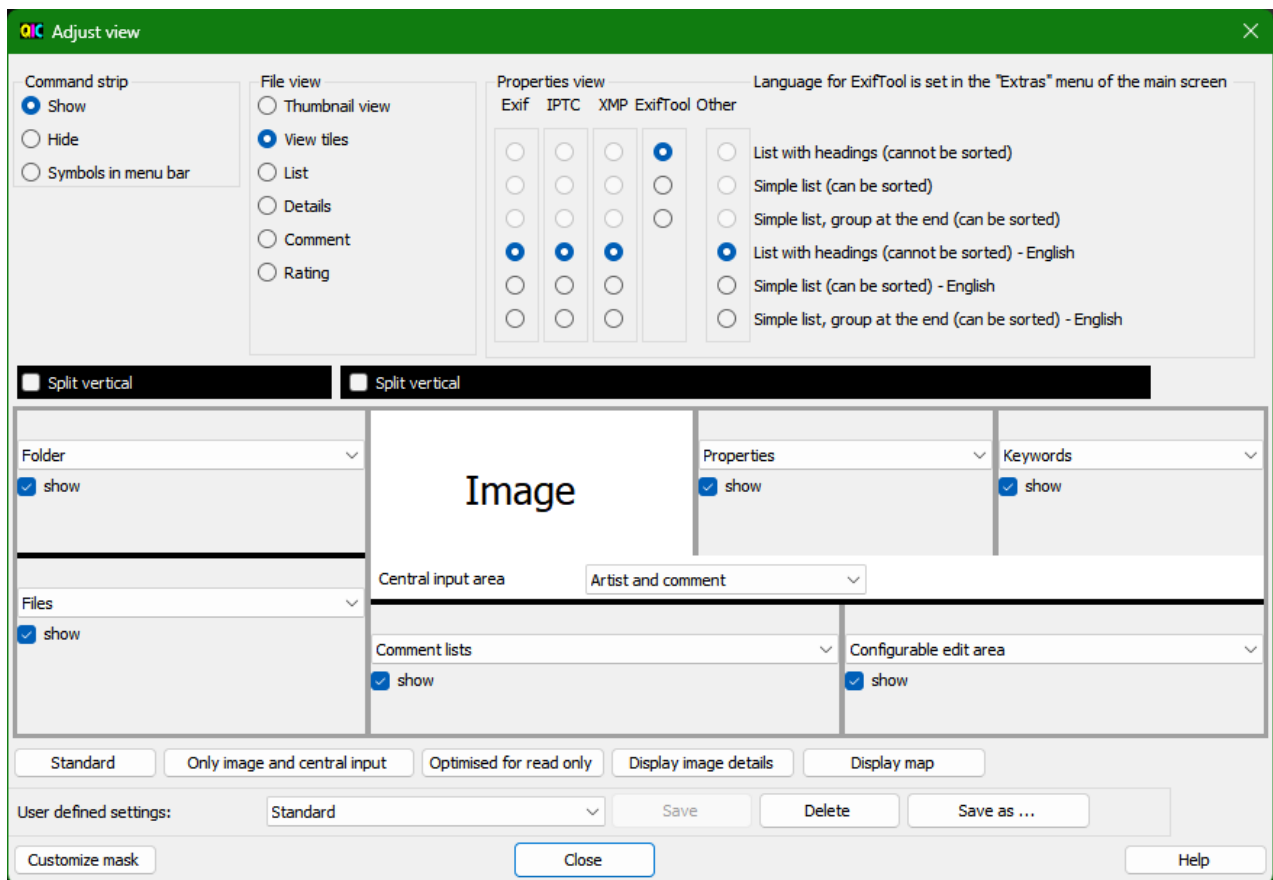
6 Mask "Adjust view"

In this mask the view of the main mask can be adjusted. The main task of this mask is to define the mapping of the various contents (folder list, file list, ...) to the display areas and to show or hide the display areas.

Example: If you do not need the lists of recent and predefined comments, you can use the area to the left of the configurable input area to show the keywords and thus you have a bit more space for the image and / or the display of the properties.

Additionally, following adjustments are possible:

- Display of the toolbar (also possible via menu bar)
- File view (also possible via menu bar or context menu)
- Views of the properties (Exif, IPTC, XMP, Others, also possible via context menu)



In each panel is a selection list to select the content for this display area. The content will possibly be exchanged, i.e., (starting from the setting shown in the picture) after selecting "Files" rather than "Folder" in the list on the top left, in the display area below "Folder" will be displayed instead of "Files".

The checkbox allows hiding the display area when the corresponding content is not needed. This gives you more space for the other contents and the display is more clearly laid out.

For the central input area, the selection list allows to specify whether the input fields for artists and comment (individually, both, none) are displayed.

The main mask is separated in two areas, on the left-hand side with Folder on top and Files on bottom, on the right hand side with Image, Properties and keywords on top and Comment lists and Configurable edit area on bottom. For both areas the horizontal split (top and bottom) can be changed to a vertical split (left and right) with the black check boxes. In this way wide monitors can be used more efficient.

The user defined settings can be saved with a name and activated again via the drop-down list. Activation is also possible via menu "View" of the main mask.

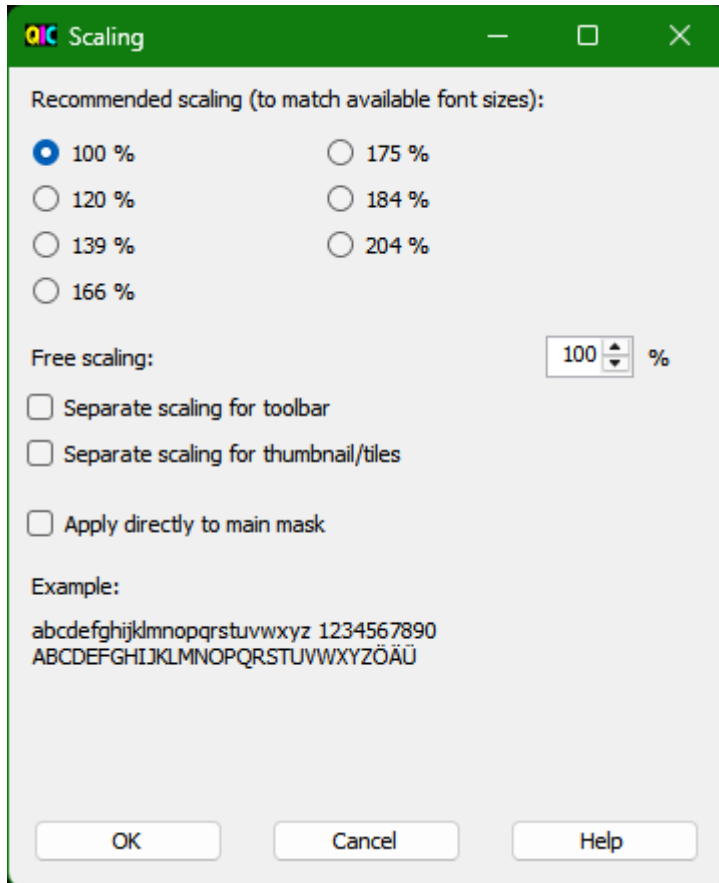
Command buttons:

Standard	Mapping of content to display areas according standard (like right after installation)
Only image and central input fields	Only the picture and the central input fields for artists and comment will be displayed
Optimized for read-only	Only the content is shown, which is usually interesting to see the pictures and read the properties; Contents normally needed to change data (central input area, keywords, comment lists, configurable input range) are hidden.
Display image details	Similar to "Optimized for read-only "; additionally, image details are displayed (see Display of image details)
Display map	Similar to "Optimized for read-only "; additionally, a map is displayed (see Recording location on map)
Save	Saves the user defined settings with the name displayed in the drop-down list
Delete	Deletes the user defined settings with the name displayed in the drop-down list
Save as ...	Saves the user defined settings with a new name
Customize mask	Customize the mask, more details in Mask "Customize mask"
Close	Close mask
Help	Displays the help for this mask

7 Mask "Scaling"

To improve readability on high-resolution monitors, the masks can be scaled.

With this mask the scaling can be selected for all masks. With [Mask "Customize mask"](#) the magnification for a specific mask - deviating from this general setting - can be further defined.



Since the font can only be enlarged in certain steps, recommended scalings are offered for selection in the upper area. At 100%, for example, the default font size is 8.25 points. The next largest font is reached at 120%.

Below that there is the possibility to choose a free scaling, but this is rather rarely useful. If, for example, 119% is selected, all input fields are enlarged accordingly, but the font size remains at 8.25 points, because the next largest font requires 120% for a complete display. So, the setting 119% does not increase the readability compared to 100%. Free scaling can be useful if you want to go below 100% or above 200%.

If desired, the toolbar can be scaled separately. If scaling is greater than 100%, the icons appear blurred. In addition, the symbols should usually be understandable even without magnification. Therefore, it is possible to scale the toolbar separately, e.g., leave it at 100%.

Thumbnail view and tiles can also be scaled separately, i.e., the size of the images in the file view can be changed. This was already possible in previous versions via the general configuration file (see [Definitions for views "Thumbnail" and "Tile"](#)), but is of course easier via this mask. Old settings for ThumbNailSize in the general configuration file are still considered. The size of the preview image is calculated as ThumbNailSize multiplied by the scaling factor. If this value is greater than 256, 256 is used because this is the system's maximum value.

The change of the scaling on the font can be judged directly on the example text. For a better evaluation, the scaling can also be applied directly to the main mask.

Hint:

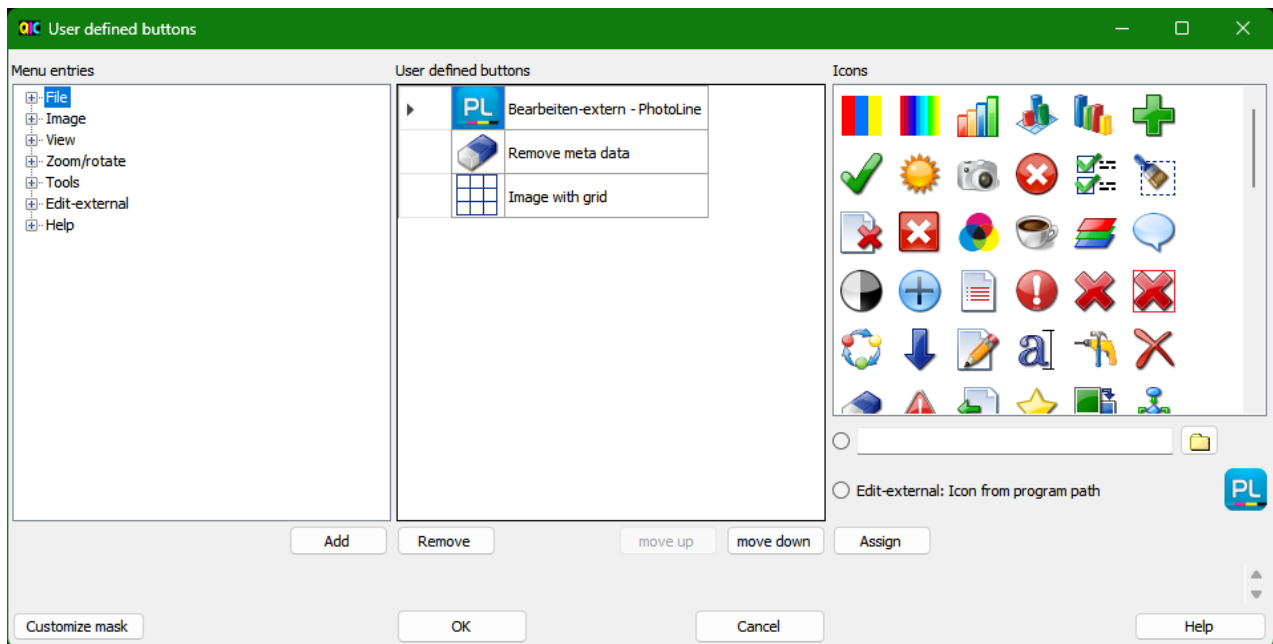
The ambition when implementing the scaling was to allow multiple changes to find the most favorable setting - and then use it. It can happen with multiple changes of the scaling that individual control elements become too small or too large. Avoiding this has proven to be disproportionately time-consuming. However, as soon as you restart the program, any layout errors are eliminated.

Command buttons:

OK	Applies selected scaling and closes mask
Cancel	Reverts changes in scaling since opening mask and closes mask
Help	Displays the help for this mask

8 Mask "User defined buttons"

Buttons can be defined for frequently used menu items. Self-defined buttons are displayed in the command strip, to the right of the predefined ones. With this mask the buttons can be defined and deleted.



On the left, the menu is displayed in a tree view. After selecting a menu item, a button is defined with the "Add" button and displayed in the center. There the text can be changed. This text is displayed at the button as tooltip.

On the right, an icon can be assigned to the marked button (black triangle in the first column). There are three ways to do this:

- By double-clicking on an icon in the top list or selecting it and clicking the "Assign" button.
- By specifying a file with icon (image file or file with icon assigned). The file can be selected via the folder button or its full name can be entered directly in the text field. If a valid file is specified, the icon is displayed on the right. After selecting this option, the icon can be assigned using the "Assign" button.
- If the menu item is an entry from "Edit-External" with "Program" configuration, the icon assigned to the program is displayed on the right. After selecting this option, the icon can be assigned using the "Assign" button.

To change the order of the buttons, a button can be marked and moved with "move up" and "move down".

Buttons that are no longer needed can be removed with "Remove".

Hints:

- Buttons can only be assigned to menu items that do not have sub-entries. Menu items with sub-entries can be recognized by the [+] in front of the text.
- User-defined buttons are never displayed grayed out. If the assigned function is not available at the moment (e.g., if you have only selected one file and "Compare files" is assigned to the button), a corresponding message appears after pressing the button.
- Some menu entries are created dynamically, e.g. entries for user-defined views (see [Mask "Adjust view"](#)). If the menu entry is no longer available (e.g., because the user-defined view has been deleted), this is reported when the button is pressed.

When opening this mask, buttons without a valid menu entry are indicated. When leaving this mask with "OK" such buttons are deleted.

Command buttons:

Add	Button for selected menu item is added.
Remove	Selected button is removed.
move up	Marked button is moved up.
move down	Marked button is moved down.
Assign	The selected icon will be assigned to the selected button.
Customize mask	Customize the mask, more details in Mask "Customize mask"
OK	Apply changes and close mask
Close	Close mask
Help	Displays the help for this mask

9 Mask "Settings"

In this mask the most important settings for the program can be changed. Further adjustments are described in [Mask "Adjust view"](#), [Mask "Field definitions"](#), [Mask "Predefined comments"](#), [Mask "Predefined keywords"](#), [Mask "Customize mask"](#) and [Adjustment and configuration](#).

The following table describes the various settings:

Make backup from image file	File before saving remains as a backup file with the extension ..._ bak (e.g., for .jpg-file as .jpg_bak). Before you save, a backup file is always generated regardless of this setting. If this option is not enabled, the backup file is deleted after the file is saved. If during saving a fatal error occurs, which leads to a program abort, the backup file is retained, even if this option is not enabled.
With "Delete" button files are deleted permanently	If this is activated, files are permanently deleted when the "Delete" button is pressed. Otherwise, it is depending on the settings of Recycle Bin, if it is moved to Recycle Bin or deleted permanently. The "Delete" button gets a red frame if permanent deletion is activated.
In field comment: Save with Return and show next image	When the focus is in the text field for comment, with return key the image is saved and the next one is displayed.
In field comment: with cursor down switch to list of recent comments	With the key "cursor down" focus moves into the list of recent comments so that you directly can select an appropriate comment.

In case of error or conspicuity in meta data: bar in list "Overview"	In case an error or a conspicuity is detected in the meta data, a bar (standard color: red) appears in the list "Overview" on the left. A conspicuity can be: • If for artists or comment several properties were elected for saving and these properties have different values (e.g., Exif.Image.ImageDescription contains something else than in Exif.Photo.UserComment and in both - according to the configuration - the comment should be contained • For one of the properties for artists and comment there are several entries in the image. • Error while reading meta data by exiv2 or ExifTool, e.g., "The memory contains data of image at unknown type" Errors can also occur when displaying the image. If a message starting with "BitmapDecoder:" or "LibRaw:" is displayed next to "Error displaying image", a codec for reading the RAW image is missing and should be installed. As an alternative, the Microsoft Raw Image Extension can be installed, which supports various RAW formats. Other messages indicate a software error and should be reported to quickimagecomment@gmail.com.
In case of error or conspicuity in meta data: show message box	In case an error or conspicuity is detected in the meta data, a message box is shown.
Navigation with tab to split bar	The tab key can be used also to navigate to the split bars (grey bars between areas). Thus, you can adjust the size of the areas with the keyboard.
Single Edit: if no artist entered, use:	If an image/video is displayed in single image edit, for which no artist is entered yet, the name given here is displayed by default (with a note behind the combo box for artists).
Maximum number of recent user comments, which are saved	When saving images/videos, the comments are saved in a list (last entries as first) so that you can use them for the following pictures again. When you exit the program, the maximum specified number of entries is stored in the configuration file, so that they are available again when you start the program the next time.
Maximum number of values for "artist", which are saved	When saving images/videos, the entries for artist are saved in a list (last entries as first) so that you can use them for the following pictures again. When you exit the program, the maximum specified number of entries is stored in the configuration file, so that they are available again when you start the program the next time.

Maximum number of locations/values per configurable input field, which ...	When saving images/videos, the entries for fields in configurable input area are saved in a list (last entries as first) so that you can use them for the following pictures again. When you exit the program, the maximum specified number of entries for each input field is stored in the configuration file, so that they are available again when you start the program the next time. This setting also applies to the maximum number of GPS positions that are stored for the search list of the map display, separately for unnamed entries that were created by marking on the map and for named entries that are the result of a search (recognizable by a speaking name such as "Düsseldorf Hbf"). This is to prevent new unnamed entries from gradually displacing named entries from the list.
At mouse double click in list box of predefined comments	Here you can set the action that is executed after a double click on an item in the list box of predefined comments. Possibilities are: • Overwrite • Append with space • Append with comma • Append with semicolon
At inserting: check, if text ends with one of the following characters:	In the case of multiple image editing, comment can be inserted before the existing one. You can get it checked that there is a separator in between. Valid delimiters can be defined here. If the text to be inserted does not end with one of these characters, a warning is issued and you can decide whether the text is still pasted and images/videos are stored in this way.
At appending: check, if text starts with one of the following characters:	In the case of multiple image editing, comment can be appended after the existing one. You can get it checked that there is a separator in between. Valid delimiters can be defined here. If the text to be appended does not start with one of these characters, a warning is issued and you can decide whether the text is still pasted and images/videos are stored in this way.
During renaming and deleting of files consider also following file extensions (separated by ";")	Some programs create additional files for image files that have the same name but a different file extension (e.g., image.xyz related to image.jpg). Here such file extensions ("xyz") can be given so that these additional files are also renamed or deleted when renaming or deleting the image file.

Settings for caching: Maximum number of images, which are buffered for display	In order to speed up the display of previous or next images/videos, they can be read in advance from disk. This setting defines how many images/videos are read into the buffer. In contrast to the buffer configured via the subsequent setting, in the buffer configured here, the images/videos are read completely and therefore this buffer consumes more memory.
Settings for caching: Maximum number of images, which are buffered for file list	In order to speed up scrolling in file list, thumbnail images/videos or properties of images/videos can be read in advance from disk. This setting defines how many images/videos are read into the buffer.
Settings for caching: Maximum used main memory (above no further caching)	Apart from the two previous settings for the number of images/videos read into buffers you can also define the maximum memory used for caching. This setting applies to both buffer areas together. For this setting consider the total available main memory. Note: In the footer of the main mask the main memory currently used by the program is displayed.
Save comment in	The contents of the text field for comment on the main mask can be saved for images in exiv2-tags: • Exif-Tag "Exif.Image.ImageDescription" • Exif-Tag "Exif.Image.XPComment" • Exif-Tag "Exif.Image.XPTitle" • Exif-Tag "Exif.Photo.UserComment" • IPTC-Tag "Iptc.Application2.Caption" • XMP-Tag "Xmp.dc.description" (with language code lang=x-default) • XMP-Tag "Xmp.dc.title" (with language code lang=x-default) • Field "JPEG comment", called by some programs "Image Comment" for videos in ExifTool-tags: • ItemList:Description • ItemList:Comment • ItemList:Title • XMP-acdsee:Caption • XMP-crd:Description • XMP-dc:Description • XMP-dc:Title • XMP-exif:UserComment See also note below.

Artist (author) save in	The contents of the text field for artist (author) On the main mask can be saved for images in exiv2-tags: • Exif-Tag "Exif.Image.Artist" • Exif-Tag "Exif.Image.XPAuthor" • IPTC-Tag "Iptc.Application2.Byline" • IPTC-Tag "Iptc.Application2.Writer" • XMP-Tag "Xmp.dc.creator" for videos in ExifTool-tags: • ItemList:Artist • ItemList:Author • XMP-acdsee:Author • XMP-dc:Creator See also note below.
Languages (for XMP data type Lang-Alt)	The XMP data type lang-Alt (exiv2, lang-alt in ExifTool) allows defining values in different languages for a tag. Here you can select for which languages an input field is always displayed in the configurable input area. The languages to select from are defined in the general configuration file. For more information, see General configuration file.
Video: File extensions - display properties (separated by ";"):	Video files with specified file extensions will be displayed in the file list and their metadata are read.
Video: File extensions - display a frame (separated by ";"):	For video files with the specified file extensions, a frame is displayed.
Video: Frame Position [s]	Defines the position of the displayed frame in seconds from the start of the video
charset for Exif.Photo.UserComment	Character set in which Exif.Photo.UserComment is written. This setting applies also for a few other Exif tags of type "Comment". In general, "Unicode" is better supported by other programs to display Meta data.
Write Exif in UTF8	Write Exif data in UTF8-encoding. In general, "UTF8" is better supported by other programs to display Meta data. The Metadata Working Group (MWG) recommends in the Guidelines for handling image metadata to write Exif-Strings in UTF8.

Write IPTC in UTF8	Write IPTC data in UTF8-encoding. In general, "UTF8" is better supported by other programs to display Meta data. The Metadata Working Group (MWG) recommends in the Guidelines for handling image metadata to write Exif-Strings in UTF8.
Button "ExifTool settings"	Opens the mask Settings for ExifTool.
Rating: Show "Reject" button	Rating is usually stored as value in the range [0..5], but Xmp.xmp.Rating / XMP-xmp:Rating allow also to store -1 to indicate "rejected". Check this option if you want to assign "rejected" as rating. Note: As -1 is only stored in Xmp.xmp.Rating / XMP-xmp:Rating, in other tags a 0 will be stored if "Reject" is selected.
Log changes to the metadata	Changes to the metadata are logged in a separate screen. This applies to changes made with QuickImageComment as well as to changes to files that are displayed in the file list and made by another program. This can be used to get a mapping of the field names of exiv2 and ExifTool. For example, if Exif.Image.Artist is changed, a change will also be shown for IFD0:Artist - which is the same in the ExifTool nomenclature as Exif.Image.Artist in the exiv2 nomenclature. Logging changes outside of QuickImageComment helps to recognize unwanted changes. Some image editing programs delete metadata when editing images. Note: In rare cases a change of a file outside QuickImageComment is detected late or not at all. Reason for this is unclear. The separate logging mask opens when this option is enabled or if it is enabled when the program starts. If the mask has been closed, it can be reopened via "Tools – Show logging". Changes are still recorded even when the mask is closed.

Some thoughts to be considered, when deciding where to store comment and artist:

- The [Metadata Working Group \(MWG\)](#) recommends in the [Guidelines for handling image metadata](#) the following tags for storing the description:

Tag-ID	Exiv2 Notation	ExifTool Notation
0x010E	Exif.Image.ImageDescription	IFD0:ImageDescription
IIM 2:120	Iptc.Application2.Caption	IPTC:Caption-Abstract
	Xmp.dc.description [x-default]	XMP-dc:Description [x-default]

The following are recommended for artist (creator):

Tag-ID	Exiv2 Notation	ExifTool Notation
0x013B	Exif.Image.Artist	IFD0: Artist
IIM 2:80	Iptc.Application2.Byline	IPTC:By-line
	Xmp.dc.creator	XMP-dc:Creator

The MWG also recommends keeping all types of metadata synchronized. The easiest way to do this is to enter the comment and artist in all the fields listed, i.e., to select all the fields mentioned here in the mask. The program does not check which fields already contain a value when you enter data.

- Have a look, which tags are shown by other software you use.
- Windows Explorer also displays some metadata and allows you to change it. It might be useful to know which tags and how Windows Explorer works with them. Details can be found here: <https://quickimagecomment.de/en/meta-data-windows-explorer.html>
- Some programs remove XMP-entries.
- Character set can be a problem when you have to enter special characters (e.g. German Umlaute). Then IPTC-tags should not cause problems, as IPTC specification defines a tag for the character set used. Also, XPCComment and XPAuthor should not have trouble with character set, as UCS-2 is prescribed for these according to the documentation of ExifTool and exiv2.
- When you use only QuickImageComment to edit artist and comment, using several tags is no problem. But if you change artist and comment also with another program, which stores only in one tag, you can get inconsistencies.
- A very comprehensive look at saving metadata can be found here: https://exiftool.org/gui/articles/where_what.html

Command buttons:

Customize mask	Customize the mask, more details in Mask "Customize mask"
OK	Save changes and close mask
Cancel	Close mask without saving changes
Help	Displays the help for this mask

9.1 Settings for ExifTool

The main advantage of ExifTool over exiv2 is that metadata can also be saved in some video file formats. ExifTool also supports more tags than exiv2. The differences between ExifTool and exiv2 are discussed in more detail below.

To be able to use ExifTool:

- Download ExifTool from <https://exiftool.org/> (or another download portal)
- Unzip the zip file in a folder of your choice
- Enter the path to ExifTool in the "ExifTool settings" screen
- Start the ExifTool process
- If necessary, make further settings

Note: QuickImageComment closes more slowly when the path "...\\exiftool(-k).exe" is specified. It closes faster if you rename the ExifTool file to remove the "(-k)".

Description of the mask

Information on ExifTool process	When the ExifTool process is started, its path and version are displayed
Button "Refresh"	Refreshes the information on the ExifTool process
Path for ExifTool	Input field for the path of ExifTool
Button with folder icon	Opens a window to select ExifTool.exe
Button "Start"	Starts the ExifTool process with the specified path
Button "Stop"	Stops the running ExifTool process
ExifTool options	See separate table below
Button "OK"	Saves the entries, restarts the ExifTool process (if this has not already been done via "Start") and closes the mask
Button "Cancel"	Closes the screen without saving changes
Button "Help"	Displays help for this mask

ExifTool options

Following options can be selected to be used by ExifTool. Explanations are taken from https://exiftool.org/exiftool_pod.html

Read:

-m	(-ignoreMinorErrors) Ignore minor errors and warnings. This enables writing to files with minor errors and disables some validation checks which could result in minor warnings. Generally, minor errors/warnings indicate a problem which usually won't result in loss of metadata if ignored. However, there are exceptions, so ExifTool leaves it up to you to make the final decision. Minor errors and warnings are indicated by "[minor]" at the start of the message. Warnings which affect processing when ignored are indicated by "[Minor]" (with a capital "M"). Note that this causes missing values in -tagsFromFile, -p, -if and -fileNUM strings to be set to an empty string rather than an undefined value (but this may be avoided for -if using the API UndefTags option).
-fast	Increase speed of extracting information. With -fast, ExifTool will not scan to the end of a JPEG image to check for an AFCP or PreviewImage trailer, or past the first comment in GIF images or the audio/video data in WAV/AVI files to search for additional metadata. These speed benefits are small when reading images directly from disk, but can be substantial if piping images through a network connection. Also bypasses CRC validation when writing PNG images which can be very slow. For more substantial speed benefits

Write:

-m	(-ignoreMinorErrors) Ignore minor errors and warnings. This enables writing to files with minor errors and disables some validation checks which could result in minor warnings. Generally, minor errors/warnings indicate a problem which usually won't result in loss of metadata if ignored. However, there are exceptions, so ExifTool leaves it up to you to make the final decision. Minor errors and warnings are indicated by "[minor]" at the start of the message. Warnings which affect processing when ignored are indicated by "[Minor]" (with a capital "M"). Note that this causes missing values in -tagsFromFile, -p, -if and -fileNUM strings to be set to an empty string rather than an undefined value (but this may be avoided for -if using the API UndefTags option).
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Additional options can be defined in the [General configuration file](#); see [Options for ExifTool](#).

Differences ExifTool / exiv2

Advantages of ExifTool compared to exiv2:

- Metadata can also be written to some video file formats. Which formats are supported is documented here: <https://exiftool.org/#supported>
- ExifTool (version 13.32) recognizes 28465 tags with 17681 unique names. exiv2 (version 0.28.7) recognizes around 4400 different tag names. There may be differences in the counting method, but the difference is very clear in any case. To what extent the additional tags of ExifTool are relevant for the individual use of metadata is something you have to evaluate for yourself.
- ExifTool uses [Composite Tags](#) to provide information that is derived from other tags. This is partly comparable with [ExifEasy](#) from exiv2, but also goes beyond this. For example, the calculated depth of field is shown with Composite:DOF.
- ExifTool shows the descriptions and display values for many different languages, whereas only German translations are available for exiv2.
Note: The translations for both ExifTool and exiv2 are not complete.
- With ExifTool, data can also be partially entered in the format converted for display considering the selected language. However, most of these data are stored by the camera and will not be entered or changed manually. One tag, which may be changed by user, is the image orientation, which is saved as a number. But "Horizontal" is also a valid value with ExifTool. As Orientation may be frequently changed by user, QuickImageComment provides a selection list for valid values (as defined in Exif specification, not translated) which then are given as number to exiv2.

Advantage of exiv2 over ExifTool

- Exiv2 is integrated as a C++ library, while ExifTool runs separately as a Perl process. This means that reading with exiv2 is faster. However, in practice there is usually no noticeable difference. Less than 10% of the total time required to read an image is spent reading the metadata with ExifTool. In addition, the properties of the images/videos are read in the background (read buffer), so that this delay only plays a role if an image is to be displayed that is not yet contained in the read buffer.

When exporting metadata or importing meta data for searching via properties, several images/videos are usually involved, so the additional time required for reading with ExifTool can be noticeable. Many properties can be read with both ExifTool and exiv2. You can save up to 20% time if you read the properties with exiv2 where possible.

Initialization with ExifTool takes longer than with exiv2. However, this rarely has an effect. During the first initialization with a specific version of ExifTool, the information required for QuickImageComment is written to separate files. During a subsequent initialization, these files are read, which is considerably faster. In addition, the initialization is parallelized so that ExifTool does not normally delay the overall start. If QuickImageComment is configured for a new version of ExifTool, this time expenditure of a few seconds occurs once again.

- Some manufacturers assign a lens identification number. For the display of ExifEasy.LensName, exiv2 translates many of these lens identification numbers into the lens name using an integrated translation table. However, there are identification numbers that exiv2 does not translate, and some of the identification numbers are not unique. For these identification numbers, the assignment can be defined in [exiv2.ini](#). ExifTool does not offer the option of defining mappings between identification numbers and lens names.

Why is exiv2 still used?

As just described, exiv2 offers an additional configuration for the display of lens names compared to ExifTool. Apart from that, it is theoretically possible that there is more information that exiv2 can read and write, but ExifTool cannot. But if you compare the number of tags supported by exiv2 and ExifTool, this is extremely unlikely. Therefore, exiv2 is in principle no longer necessary with the option of using ExifTool.

However, exiv2 is still used for reasons of compatibility. QuickImageComment offers many options for configuring which tags are used, e.g. for display in the overview, for display in the tile view or for renaming files. The tags were previously specified in exiv2 notation. Unfortunately, there seems to be no easy way to determine the ExifTool notation for an exiv2 notation of a tag. So, if you do without exiv2, all these tags would have to be manually translated into the ExifTool notation.

Regardless of the configuration, dispensing with exiv2 would generally mean that users would have to get used to other tag names. In individual cases, the displayed values also change. For example, exiv2 displays "left, top (90° + horiz.flip)" for the value 5 of Exif.Image.Orientation. The same tag is called IFD0.Orientation in ExifTool and for the value 5 it displays "Mirror horizontal and rotate 270 CW", i.e. a different text. While the display of exiv2 corresponds to the Exif specification, the display of ExifTool is probably easier to understand for many users - as soon as you get used to the fact that it is different from the (familiar?) text of exiv2.

For these reasons, it was decided to continue using exiv2. In later versions, there may be an option to dispense with exiv2, which would make reading slightly faster again. The prerequisite for this, however, is that there is a convenient way to change the tag names in the configuration from exiv2 to ExifTool.

10 Mask "Field definitions"

At various places of this program field (or tag) information is displayed. In this mask you select which fields are displayed in these places. For some places you also can select the display format.

This mask and its use are described in the following sections:

- [Layout of mask](#)
- [Create new field definition](#)
- [Change field definition](#)
- [Define Input Check](#)

Please consider [Hints on special properties](#) and [Hints on data types – exiv2](#) too.

Command buttons:

Customize mask	Customize the mask, more details in Mask "Customize mask"
OK	Save changes and close mask
Cancel	Close mask without saving changes
Help	Displays the help for this mask

10.1 Layout of mask

The mask is roughly divided into two parts.

In the upper part is a list of the meta-data with tag name, data type, and description:

☒ Display name/description in English (original) **List of available meta data**

☒ Show only meta data contained in selected image Exif.Photo. Search < >

Tag name	Data type	Description
Exif.Photo.ExposureProgram	Short	The class of the program used by the camera to set exposure when the picture is taken.
Exif.Photo.ExposureTime	Rational	Exposure time, given in seconds (sec).
Exif.Photo.FileSource	Undefined	Indicates the image source. If a DSC recorded the image, this tag value of this tag always be set to 3, in
Exif.Photo.Flash	Short	This tag is recorded when an image is taken using a strobe light (flash).
Exif.Photo.FlashpixVersion	Undefined	The FlashPix format version supported by a FPXR file.
Exif.Photo.FNumber	Rational	The F number.
Exif.Photo.FocalLength	Rational	The actual focal length of the lens, in mm. Conversion is not made to the focal length of a 35 mm film cam
Exif.Photo.FocalLengthIn35mmFilm	Short	This tag indicates the equivalent focal length assuming a 35mm film camera, in mm. A value of 0 means th
Exif.Photo.GainControl	Short	This tag indicates the degree of overall image gain adjustment.
Exif.Photo.InteroperabilityTag	Long	Interoperability IFD is composed of tags which stores the information to ensure the Interoperability and p
Exif.Photo.ISOSpeedRatings	Short	Indicates the ISO Speed and ISO Latitude of the camera or input device as specified in ISO 12232.

Value original: 45/10 Interpreted: F4.5 Transfer selection as Meta Date 1 Meta Date 2

If ExifTool is configured, meta data from ExifTool is displayed in addition to meta data from exiv2. For ExifTool the language is determined by the setting in the menu item "Tools - Language for ExifTool".

For the meta data there are the following options above the list on the left:

- to display the names and descriptions in English (i.e., in the original, only available if language is not set to English; applies for exiv2 tags only) and
- to filter the list to show only tags, which are included in the currently displayed image.

Near to it - in the middle - is a selection list to jump directly to the beginning of a group of properties. Besides groups from exiv2 with EXIF, IPTC and XMP (each with sub-groups) and the locations from ExifTool, there are following groups:

- Define: these tags are defined via configuration file, see [General configuration file](#)
- ExifEasy: Values are selected from several Exif properties, for details see [Hints on special properties](#)
- File: This group contains file properties of the image
- Image: other tags that cannot be assigned to any of the other groups.

On the right-hand side is a text box and two buttons (backward, forward) to search for tags, e.g., to search for all tags containing "time" in the name or description.

If a tag is selected in the list and an image is displayed in the main mask, the value of the tag will appear below the list, once in the original format and in addition in an interpreted format. "Exif.Photo.FNumber" for examples is displayed originally as "45/10", interpreted as "F4.5".

In the lower part, field definitions are displayed and can be changed:

The screenshot shows the 'Display in tab "Overview" - Image' window. On the left is a list of field definitions: 01 Maker:, 02 Camera model:, 03 Recording date:, 04 Exposure time:, 05 Aperture: (selected), 06 ISO-setting:, 07 Focal length:, 08 Flash:, 09 Image size:, 10 Exif artist:, 11 Exif comment:, 12 JPEG comment:, 13 IPTC key words:. In the center are buttons: Beginning, move up, move down, End, Add, Copy, Delete. On the right is the definition for 'Aperture:'. It includes fields for Name, Prefix, Meta Date 1 (ExifEasy.FNumber), Display (Interpreted (Original)), Separator, Meta Date 2, Display (Interpreted), Postfix, and Result of definition (F4.5). Below these are 'In entry mask: distance up' (1) and 'Number of rows for input' (1). At the bottom right are 'Input check:' buttons: Create, Edit, Delete.

On the left-hand side is a selection list of groups of field definitions and below the list of corresponding entries. On the right-hand side of this list are command buttons to:

- move the selected item to the beginning
- move the selected item one position up
- move the selected item one position down
- move the selected item to the end
- add a new item
- copy the selected item
- delete the selected item

On the right-hand side, the definition of the selected item in the list is displayed and can be changed there. Below the fields for definition - if an image is displayed on the main mask - the value of this definition is displayed.

For field definitions of the group "Change of properties" additionally the display of the input field can be customized:

- distance upwards
- number of lines for input, if the tag allows multiple values

10.2 Create new field definition

- Select group for field definition

First select the group, for which you want to create the field definition. This is done with the list on the left between the list of all properties and list of field definitions (Initial value: "Display in tab "Overview" - Image").

The groups are:

— Display in tab "Overview" - Image

These fields are displayed for image files in the main window, area for properties on the right-hand side of the image, in tab "Overview".

- Display in tab "Overview" - Video

These fields are displayed for video files in the main window, area for properties on the right-hand side of the image, in tab "Overview".

- Display of files in view "Tiles" - Image

These fields are displayed in the file list of the main mask (bottom left) for image files when the view "Tiles" is selected.

- Display of files in view "Tiles" - Video

These fields are displayed in the file list of the main mask (bottom left) for video files when the view "Tiles" is selected.

- Display Image in own window - Image

These fields are displayed for image files in the [Mask "Image in own window"](#).

- Display Image in own window - Video

These fields are displayed for video files in the [Mask "Image in own window"](#).

- Display Image in own window - Header line

These fields are displayed in header line of [Mask "Image in own window"](#).

- Rename of Files

These fields are available in [Mask "Rename files"](#) so that they can be used as part of the file name.

- Sort order during renaming of files

If files are renamed in [Mask "Rename files"](#), they can be sorted first. This order is relevant when the file names are unique only by adding a sequential number. These fields can be used as a sorting criterion.

- Change of properties

In the main mask is a configurable input area, in which further properties can be changed. The fields of this group are displayed there.

- Search via properties

For these fields data is read from the images/videos and can be searched for in [Mask "Search via properties"](#).

- Grouping during changing recording date/time

In [Mask "Change recording date and time"](#) recording date and time for groups of images/videos will be changed. The fields of this group are used for this grouping.

- Export of properties in text file

The values of these fields are exported to a text file via menu entry "Export: selected properties of images/videos in folder" of the main mask.

- Remove of Meta data in groups - exceptions

The properties defined here are exceptions during removing the meta data of groups (e.g., all Exif data) in the [Mask "Remove meta data"](#), i.e., they are not removed.

- Remove single Meta data - name the meta data

The properties defined here can individually be selected in the [Mask "Remove meta data"](#) to be removed.

- Table view during multiple images editing

These properties are displayed for all selected images/videos in the main window, tab "Multi image edit".

- Exceptions during comparing files

The properties defined here are not considered during comparing files ([Mask "Compare files"](#))

- Subtitles in slide show

These fields are displayed in [Slideshow](#).

- Logging metadata changes - exceptions

When logging metadata changes, changes in these fields are not logged. The default setting for this group includes e.g. file modification date and some derived fields.

- Select Tag
Select a tag in the list on top. You may use the selection list for groups of properties (top center) or the search functionality to find the tag wanted.
- Press command button "Add"
- The selected tag is used as Meta data 1. The last part of tag name is used as preset for the name of the field definition, e.g. "Copyright" for "Exif.Image.Copyright". Via a general configuration parameter, it can be defined that the whole tag name is used, see [Creating field definitions: Use tag name as definition name](#).
- Where applicable, adjust name and other properties
More details in [Change field definition](#).
- Where applicable, adjust sequence with the command buttons "Beginning", "move up", "move down" and "End".
- With command button "Ok", the changes are accepted and the mask is closed.
- With command button "Cancel", all changes since opening the mask are discarded and the mask is closed.

Field names can also be entered manually in the Meta Date 1 and 2 fields. Please note that names are not checked if they are Xmp properties as XMP is an open standard.

10.3 Change field definition

- Select group for field definition
 - Select item
The details on the item are displayed on the right-hand side.
 - Change Details
 - Name: this is the name by which the field definition is displayed in the lists
 - Prefix: A text that is displayed before the first value
 - Meta date 1: the first Meta date
The entry can be overwritten directly. But it is safer, to select the Meta date in the list above and then to transfer it with the command button "Meta date 1".
 - Display: selection list for formatting the value with the following options:
 - Interpreted
 - Interpreted (Original)
 - Interpreted = Original
 - Original
 - Original (Interpreted)
 - Original = Interpreted
- For datatypes "Rational" and "SRational" additionally:
- Decimal - 1 decimal place
 - Decimal - 2 decimal places
 - Decimal - 3 decimal places
 - Decimal - 4 decimal places
 - Decimal - 5 decimal places
 - Decimal - without decimal places
- For date/time values additionally:
- Local date/time format (according system settings)
 - ISO/IPTC date/time format (e.g., 2016-09-20T18:25:00)
 - Exif date/time format (e.g. 2016:09:20 18:25:00)
 - five formats defined via general configuration file, predefined are:
<weekday short> DD.MM.YYYY HH:mm:ss

<weekday short> YYYY-MM-DD HH:mm:ss
<weekday long> DD.MM.YYYY HH:mm:ss
DD-<month short>-YYYY HH:mm:ss
D. <month long> YYYY HH:mm:ss

Note referring to the options, in which both the interpreted value and the original value is displayed:

If the interpreted value is identical to the original value, only one value is displayed.

- Separator: A text that is displayed after the first value
- Meta date 2: The second Meta date

The entry can be overwritten directly. But it is safer, to select the Meta date in the list above and then to transfer it with the command button "Meta date 2".

- Display: list for formatting the value
- Postfix: A text that is displayed after the second value.

If previously an image has been selected in the main window, the resulting value for that image is displayed in below these fields.

The definition can combine two Meta data, e.g., to show the image size, which is given by two values in the EXIF data, in one value ("2560 x 1920").

- For items in group "Change of properties":

In order to group the input fields in the configurable input area the distance to the field above can be adjusted (enlarged). For tags that allow multiple values, the number of simultaneously-viewable input lines can be defined.

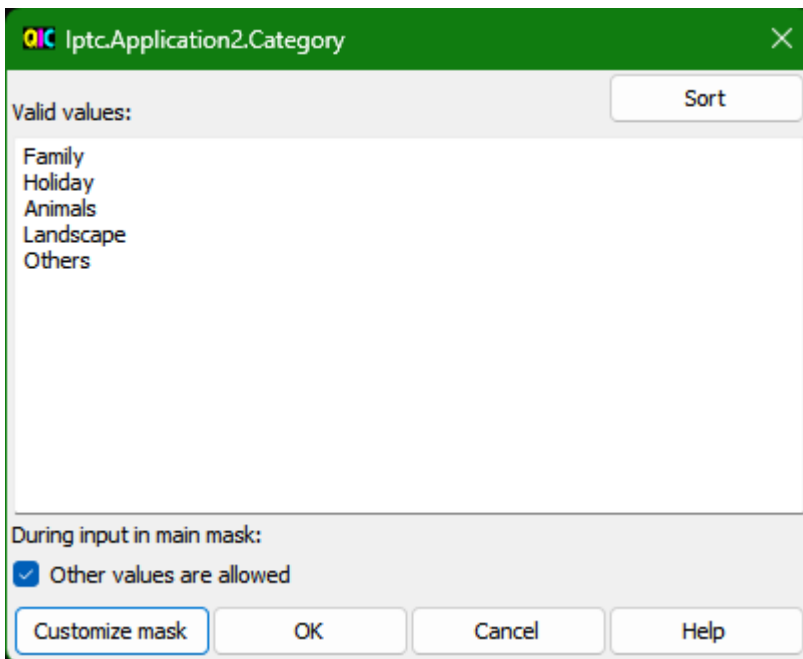
Depending on the selected field, an input check may be defined, see [Define Input Check](#).

- With command button "Ok", the changes are accepted and the mask is closed.
- With command button "Cancel", all changes since opening the mask are discarded and the mask is closed.

10.4 Define Input Check

The [Mask "Field definitions"](#) has three buttons to create, edit and delete input check configurations for the selected field. For technical reasons input check configurations are available only for fields allowing only one value. The buttons are disabled for fields allowing multiple values.

The input check configuration allows to specify a list of valid values for the tag, e.g., in order to assure that only defined categories are used. After pressing "Create" or "Edit" following mask opens:



In the text box in the middle, the valid values can be entered, each line is one value.

Below this text box is the check box "allow other values". When this is checked, also other values can be entered in the configurable input area of main mask. When this is done, user is asked if the value shall be added to this list of valid values. In this way in exceptional cases an "invalid" value can be entered, but more important, this is an easy way to add new valid values. If the check box is not checked, only one the value of the list can be selected.

Command buttons:

Sort	Sorts the entries in the text box
Customize mask	Customize the mask, more details in Mask "Customize mask"
OK	Save the settings and close mask
Cancel	Close mask without saving settings
Help	Displays the help for this mask

10.5 Hints on special properties

Composite

Only if ExifTool is configured.

The values of the composite tags are Derived From the values of other tags. These are convenience tags which are calculated after all other information is extracted. Only a few of these tags are writable directly, the others are changed by writing the corresponding Derived From tags.

Define

Properties of the group "Define" are defined via the [General configuration file](#). Based on existing properties new properties can be defined by extracting single strings. This can be used to reformat the values of properties (e.g., to another date format).

ExifEasy

Some information can be stored both in the general Exif properties as well as in manufacturer-specific properties. Other information is stored only in the manufacturer-specific properties. Properties of the group "ExifEasy" allow it to access these values without referring to a specific camera manufacturer. When the values are determined, the various properties assigned to it are scanned.

Two examples:

- If in a Nikon SLR camera ISO setting is set to "Hi", Exif.Photo.ISOSpeedRatings contains no value. The setting is memorized in Exif.Nikon3.ISOSettings. Exif.Nikon3.ISOSettings is of course not stuffed by cameras from other manufacturers. With the tag name ExifEasy.ISOSpeed the ISO setting is always displayed, no matter whether on a Nikon "Hi" was used or it is any other camera.
- SLR cameras from different manufacturers save the lens used, e.g., Sony in Sony1.LensID. Nikon only stores a reference number in NikonLd3.LensIDNumber. With ExifEasy.LensName the lens is displayed for a number of manufacturers, where the reference number used by Nikon in many cases is replaced by the lens name.

ExifEasy.LensName

As described above, some makers store the lens name directly, others store a lens-Id. exiv2 translates these lens-Ids to lens names based on a mapping included in the program itself. However, there are Ids, which are not yet included in the built-in mapping, and some IDs are not unique. For these Ids the mapping can be defined in [exiv2.ini](#).

File

In group "File" file properties (such as file size, modified date) are summarized.

MWG

Only if ExifTool is configured.

The [Metadata Working Group \(MWG\)](#) recommends techniques to allow certain overlapping EXIF, IPTC and XMP tags to be reconciled when reading, and synchronized when writing. The MWG Composite tags are designed to aid in the implementation of these recommendations. As well, the MWG defines new XMP tags which are listed in <https://exiftool.org/TagNames/MWG.html>.

See

https://web.archive.org/web/20180919181934/http://www.metadataworkinggroup.org/pdf/mwg_guidance.pdf for the official MWG specification.

Image.ArtistCombinedFields Image.CommentCombinedFields

These two properties contain the values of different fields for artist and comment respectively to make it easier to search for them: When searching it is not important to know which artist or comment field is filled.

10.6 Hints on data types – exiv2

Exif, IPTC and XMP use different data types. For some data types, the following hints should be considered:

IPTC - Character Encoding

For IPTC the used character encoding can be documented in tag Iptc.Envelope.CharacterSet. Independent from the value in this tag, this program tries to recognize the used encoding and to display the texts accordingly.

Note: because of this special meaning `Iptc.Envelope.CharacterSet` cannot be selected as changeable property. It is set based on configuration in [Mask "Settings"](#).

Comment (Exif)

This type is used for `Exif.Photo.UserComment` and a few other tags. The type of these tags according Exif specification is "Undefined". As values have to follow a special rule, the type "Comment" was introduced for identification.

Before the value itself the character encoding is defined. In this program, Unicode is used as default. (`charset=Unicode`), but this can be changed in [Mask "Settings"](#). The character encoding is only visible in the display format "original" (see [Change field definition](#)).

Date (IPTC)

The format is: YYYY-MM-DD

Example: 2012-04-28

Exif date/time

Exif date/time specifications are stored in fields of the data type "Ascii", where the Exif specification prescribes the following format:

YYYY:MM:DD HH:MM:SS

Example: 2012:04:28 14:23:58

LangAlt (XMP)

With this data type values can be specified in different languages. One value is for the default language (x-default).

ReadOnly

Values of this data type cannot be changed. Basically, it consists of three groups:

- Tags defined via the [General configuration file](#) or from program itself based on data of "real" tags. In this case, ReadOnly means that the tag cannot be changed directly. However, changing the value of the underlying tag also changes the value of the dependent tag.
- Parts of an XMP-data structure.
For example, in an image with "Xmp.MP.RegionInfo" additionally to this main tag itself also "PersonDisplayName" can be selected with type "ReadOnly". It is read only because it cannot be changed separately. For the display in the tab "Overview" however it is quite useful to select just this portion of "Xmp.MP.RegionInfo", because the other parts of the tag for most users are probably rather unimportant.
Because these parts are not defined in the underlying library `exiv2`, they are only displayed if they are included in the selected image.
- File properties (such as file size) that are treated in the same way as other tags for the purpose of uniform handling when displaying properties.

Time (IPTC)

The format is HH:MM:SS+hh:mm where hh:mm is the time zone correction relative to UTC. The indication of seconds and time zone correction are optional. They may be added when leaving the input field.

Examples: 14:23:02+02:00 14:23:00 14:23

Undefined

This data type is usually used for binary data. Values of this data type are displayed as a sequence of bytes in decimal form and therefore are barely legible. These values cannot be changed by the program.

XmpBag

An unordered array of values of an Xmp basic data type, usually text.

XmpSeq

An ordered array of values of an Xmp basic data type, usually text.

XmpText

The name suggests that any text can be entered. However, there are some tags that according specification should contain only numeric values (e.g., Xmp.photoshop.Urgency, valid range 1 - 8). Some other tags of this type store complete data structures. The following example is taken from an image, where person's markings were added with Windows Live Photo Gallery:

```
Xmp.MP.RegionInfo
Xmp.MP.RegionInfo/MPRI:Regions
Xmp.MP.RegionInfo/MPRI:Regions[1]
Xmp.MP.RegionInfo/MPRI:Regions[1]/MPReg:Rectangle
Xmp.MP.RegionInfo/MPRI:Regions[1]/MPReg:PersonDisplayName
Xmp.MP.RegionInfo/MPRI:Regions[1]/MPReg:PersonEmailDigest
Xmp.MP.RegionInfo/MPRI:Regions[1]/MPReg:PersonLiveIdCID
Xmp.MP.RegionInfo/MPRI:Regions[1]/MPReg:PersonSourceID
```

XmpText is therefore a very flexibly usable data type. Thus, I cannot guarantee that this program covers all occurring ways of using the data type XmpText.

A "Value Type" is also defined in exiv2 for XMP data types. This value type is used here to refine the XmpText data type:

- XmpText-Boolean
- XmpText-Date
- XmpText-Integer
- XmpText-Rational
- XmpText-Real
- XmpText-Text
- XmpText-Time
- XmpText-URI
- XmpText-URL

While XmpText can contain complex structures (see above), the refined data types can only store one value of each value type.

Numeric data types - general

The values of numeric data types may be changed. Examples for these values are shutter speed, aperture and resolution. For these examples, and for the vast majority (if not all) numerical values, it is not useful to change them after the capture. For some tags (e.g., Exif.Image.ExifTag = pointer to EXIF IFD) additionally, there is the risk that an incorrect value leads to the fact that the metadata no longer will be readable at all.

As a change hardly makes sense and can possibly lead to problems, a warning is issued when a Meta date with a numeric data type is selected for the list of changeable properties. This

approach aims to avoid the problems caused by incorrect inputs. However, in principle you can change numerical data.

Byte

Integer value, range: 0 to 255

SByte

Integer value, range: -128 to 127

Short

Integer value, range: 0 to 65535

SShort

Integer value, range: -32768 to 32767

Long

Integer value, range: 0 to 4294967295

SLong

Integer value, range: -2147483648 to 2147483647

Float

Decimal number: enter a dot as a decimal separator, e.g., 123.456

The value is often not stored exactly as it is typed. E.g., entering 2.4 results in 2.40000009536743

Double

Decimal number: enter a dot as a decimal separator, e.g., 123.456

Rational

Rational number (fraction), numerator and denominator are of type Long, separated by slash.

Example: 12/100

SRational

Rational number (fraction), numerator and denominator are of type SLong, separated by slash.

Example: -12/100

10.7 Hints on data types – ExifTool

ExifTool recognizes the following data types:

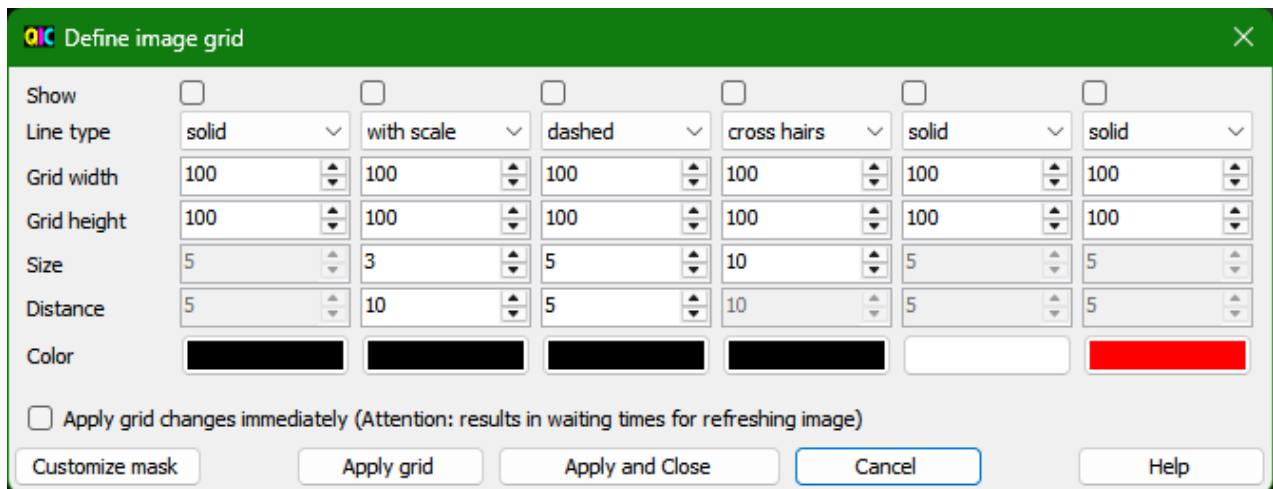
- int8u
- string
- int16u
- int32u
- rational64u
- int8s
- undef

- int16s
- int32s
- rational64s
- float
- double
- ifd
- unicode
- complex
- int64u
- int64s
- ifd64

The ExifTool documentation does not provide any further information on this, but the description of the field is usually sufficient for entering values.

11 Mask "Define grid"

With this mask you can define grids, which are laid over the image.



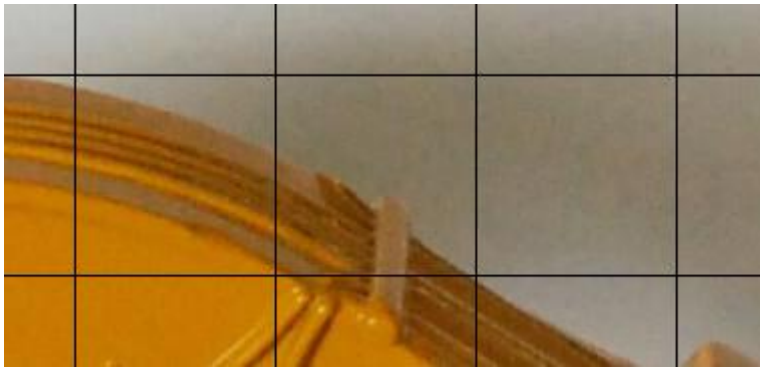
Up to six grids can be defined. It is also possible to display several grids one over the other.

For each grid you can define:

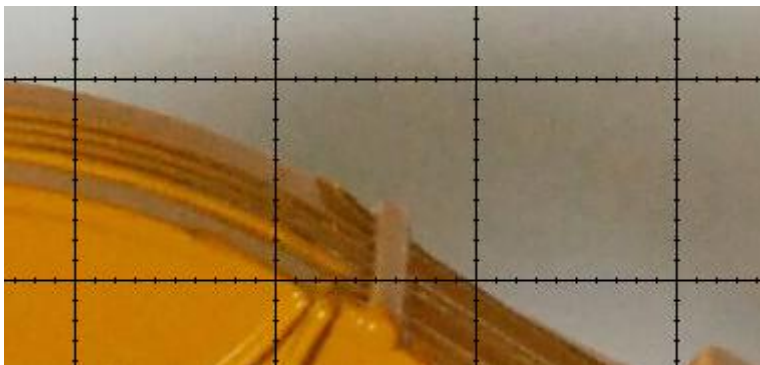
- Show (if checked, the grid is shown)
- Line type
- Grid width
- Grid height
- Color

The line types are:

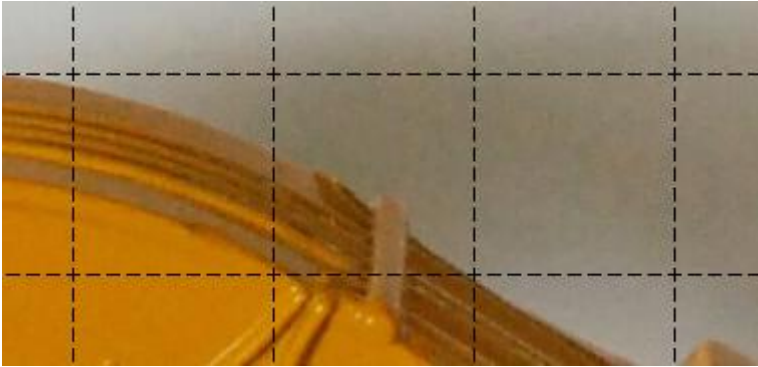
- Solid Line:



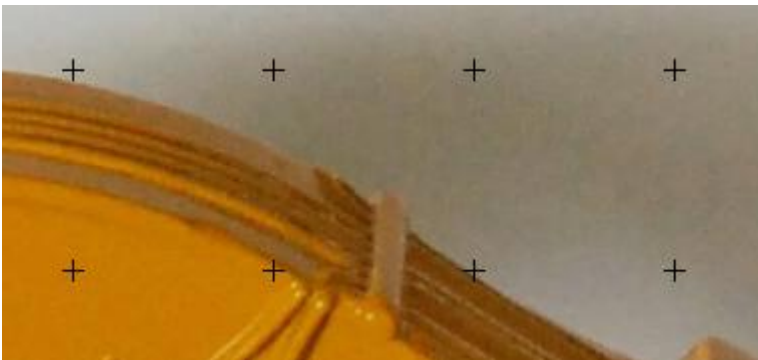
- with scale:



- dashed:



- cross hairs:



For the line type "with scale" can be defined additionally:

- Size (length of scaling strokes)
- Distance (distance between scaling strokes)

For the line type "dashed" can be specified additionally:

- Size (length of the individual strokes)
- Distance (distance between the strokes)

For the line type "cross hairs" can be defined additionally:

- Size (length of the strokes of the crosshairs)

The values are given in pixels on the image.

If "Apply grid changes immediately (Attention: results in waiting times for refreshing image)" is checked, any change of grid is applied directly. Depending on the detail level of the grid, this can cause longer waiting times for refreshing the image.

Command buttons:

Customize mask	Customize the mask, more details in Mask "Customize mask"
Apply grid	The grids checked in "Show" are laid over the image.
Apply and Close	The grids checked in "Show" are laid over the image and the mask is closed.
Cancel	Close mask without saving changes
Help	Displays the help for this mask

12 Mask "Change recording date and time"

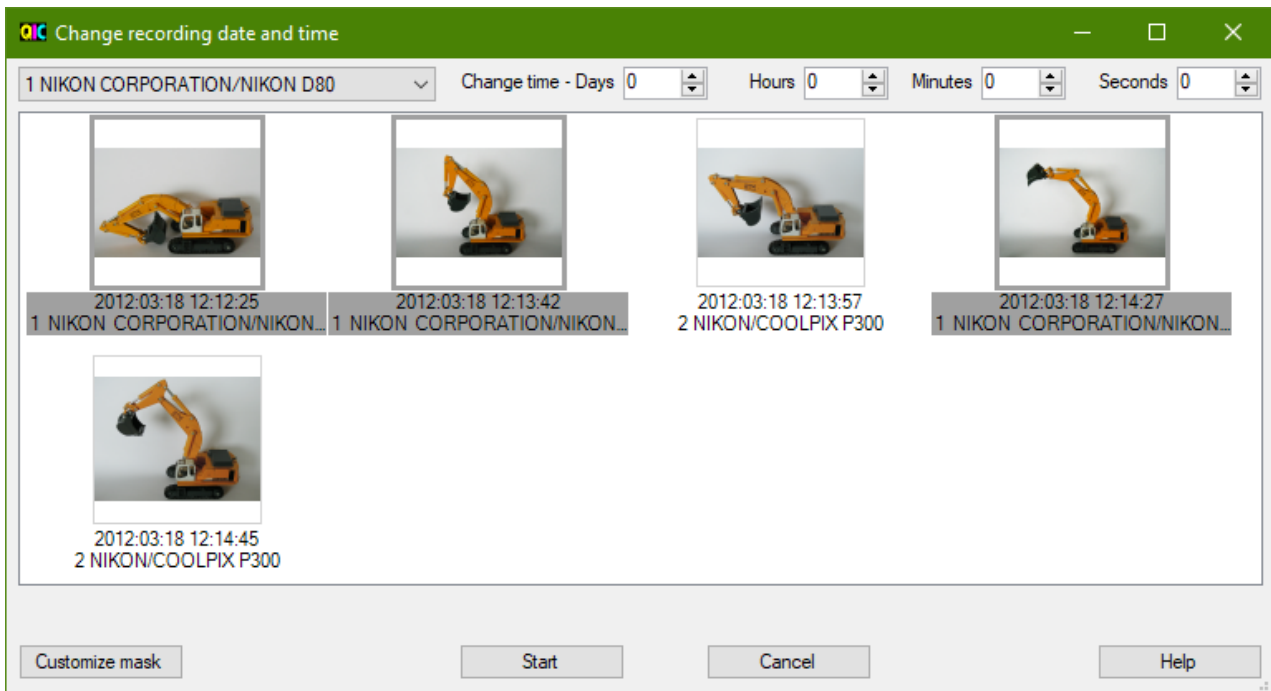
With this mask you can be modify recording date and time. First, date and time can be changed by a difference for all images and videos. For this select grouping "all" in the drop down on top left. But you can also make change only for a selection of images/videos so that the time is synchronized with the time with other images/videos retroactively.

Examples:

- The clock in the camera was not switched from summer to winter time.
- At an event images are taken with different cameras, whose time is set different. To sort these images chronologically correct retroactively, the time for each camera model is adjusted. In the view the images are directly sorted accordingly so that you can easily determine the proper correction.

The second, more complex case is described now in more detail:

First you have to mark the images/videos in the main mask, whose recording date and time is to be changed. Then open this mask (via menu or toolbar). The selected images (here a sequence in which an excavator lifts his bucket) are displayed:

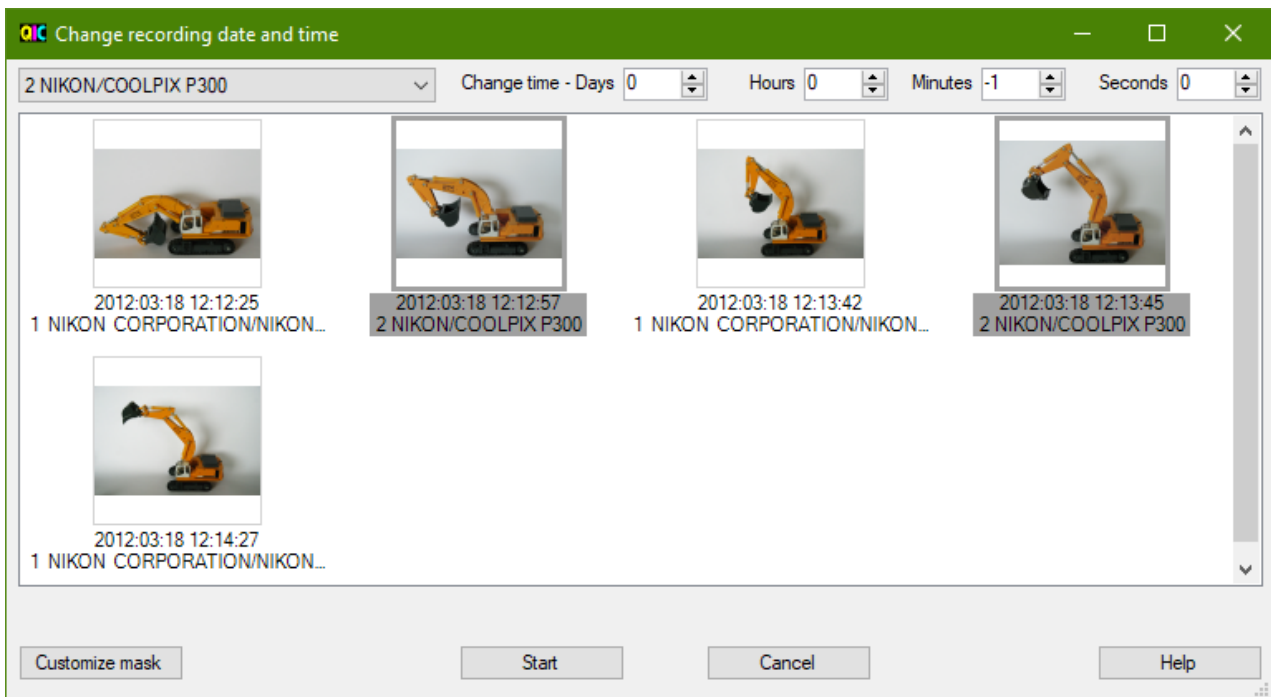


On the top left is a selection list, with which images are grouped. Images of the chosen group are highlighted in grey. The default setting for the group is a manufacturer and model of camera. This setting can be adjusted by selecting "other grouping" in the selection list (or by opening the [Mask "Field definitions"](#) via menu and selecting group "Grouping during changing recording date/time").

On the top right are input controls to shift the recording time for the selected images.

You can now determine the correction by comparing the clocks in the different cameras or you successively move to the correct value. After each change of the correction values the images are sorted accordingly, while no corrected time is stored in the images yet.

In this particular example, the recording times for the images taken with the COOLPIX P300 are put back by one minute:



Now, the images appear in a plausible chronological order. By pressing the command button "Start", the corrected recording time is written to the image files and the mask is closed.

Notes:

- In this example time was changed for one camera model. It is also possible to define a time shift for each of several camera models (or whatever is used to group the images/videos), check the order and then update the image files with "Start".
- Exif defines different tags for time. This mask changes "Exif.Photo.DateTimeOriginal" for images. This is the tag that according Exif specification is provided in a digital camera for recording date and time. "Exif.Photo.DateTimeDigitized" for example, remains unchanged. So, in this tag you can still see the original time. If also "Exif.Photo.DateTimeDigitized" (or other properties for times) should be modified, this can be done later using placeholders (see [Mask "Edit / insert placeholder"](#)).
- For videos it is not so clear which tag is used for recording date and time. The best choice seems to be the ExifTool-tag "QuickTime:CreateDate" (exiv2: "Xmp.video.DateUTC"). Before trying to change recording date it is recommended to first check if the videos have this tag filled.
- If another tag than "Exif.Photo.DateTimeOriginal" or "QuickTime:CreateDate" shall be used, this can be changed in [General configuration file](#), see "[Tag for recording date](#)".

Command buttons:

Customize mask	Customize the mask, more details in Mask "Customize mask"
Start	Change date and time and then close the mask.
Cancel	Close mask without changing date and time
Help	Displays the help for this mask

13 Mask "Rename files"

With this mask you can rename files.

First you have to select the images/videos to be renamed in the main mask. Then open this mask via menu or toolbar.

	fixed text	Field	Start	from right	Length	fill up right	with	up to
1	☒	Recording date YYYYMMDD	3	☐	0	☐		0
2	☐		1	☐	0	☐		0
3	☐	Camera maker	1	☐	0	☐		0
4	☐	Camera model	1	☐	0	☐		0
5	☐	ISO-setting	1	☐	0	☐		6
6	☐		1	☐	0	☐		0
7	☐		1	☐	0	☐		0
8	☐		1	☐	0	☐		0
9	☐		1	☐	0	☐		0
10	☐		1	☐	0	☐		0
11	☐		1	☐	0	☐		0

Change sequence - row 1

Running number - running over all files, for which else the same name would be used

☒ Always append number fixed text: - No. of digits (min.): 3 fixed text: sort by:
 Replace the not allowed characters in file names \/:*?"<>| by: @_
 Example: 120318-001.jpg

Choose settings:

The mask is roughly divided into four input area:

- Selection of fields and formatting for the file name

In eleven lines you can be chose fields from which the file name is composed. For each line you have:

- checkbox indicating whether the line is used or not
- a fixed text that is inserted before the field content
- the field (selection list can be modified via entry "<new Field>" - or by opening the [Mask "Field definitions"](#) via menu and selecting group "Rename of files")
- starting position, from which the field value is taken over (allows to cut off characters at the beginning or end)
- checkbox "from right": if checked, the start position is counted from right, otherwise from left
- length, maximum number of characters; value 0: all characters
- checkbox "fill up right": if checked, is filled up with characters from the right
- "with": fill up with this character
- "up to": number of characters up to which is filled up, i.e., the minimum number of characters that will be used for this part of the file name

With two command buttons the sequence of rows can be changed.

- Settings for serial number and sorting

Here it is defined:

- whether always a continuous number is added; if not checked, a sequential number is added only if otherwise the file name is not unique.
- fixed text before the serial number
- minimum number of digits for the serial number
- fixed text after the serial number
- sort criteria used when assigning the serial number (selection list can be modified via entry "<new Field>" - or by opening the [Mask "Field definitions"](#) via menu and selecting group "Sort order during renaming of files")

- Definition for replacing characters that are not allowed in file names; filename as a result

Certain characters such as ":" must not occur in the file name. If any of these characters appears in the content of a field, it is replaced with the character below. If not for all the characters a replacement character is defined, the last replacement character is used.

Directly below this field the file name is displayed, which is the result of these settings for the first file selected to rename.

- Field to select and save named settings

The settings can be saved under a name. Additionally, there is always an unnamed set of settings available additional to the named sets of settings.

- via a selection list a set of settings can be loaded
- with command button "Save" the changes of the settings are saved
- with command button "Delete" a named set of settings is deleted
- with command button "Save As ..." the settings are saved under a new name

Hints to the settings in the example:

With the settings shown in the screenshot files are renamed as follows:

- Date in the format YYMMDD based on recording date in the format YYYYMMDD, but from position three, so the year is two digits
- Hyphen (fixed text before serial number) and always at least three-digit sequential number

The rows three, four and five are not active.

If the line one is disabled and the lines three to five are enabled, you get an example how you could rename test images to check the noise behavior:

- first the camera manufacturer
- then, separated by underscore, the camera model
- at the end the ISO setting, filled up with underscores to at least six characters so that files with ISO 200 (...__200.jpg) will be sorted before files with ISO 1600 (...__1600.jpg).

Command buttons:

Customize mask	Customize the mask, more details in Mask "Customize mask"
Start	Rename files and then close the mask.
Cancel	Save settings and close mask without renaming files
Help	Displays the help for this mask

14 Mask "Compare files"

With this mask you can compare Meta data of several files.

First you have to select the images/videos to be compared in the main mask. Then open this mask via menu or toolbar. The files are compared and the different Meta data are displayed. Meta data that have the same value in all images/videos are not displayed.

File name	Define.RecordingTimeAccConfig_hhmmss	Exif.Image.DateTime	Exif.Image.ExifTag	Exif.Image.GPSTag	Exif.Image.ImageDescription	Exif.Image.ImageSize
Demo-1.jpg	121225	2012:03:18 12:28:33	248	40264		NI
Demo-2.jpg	121357	2012:03:18 12:28:35	274	30888		NI
Demo-3.jpg	121342	2012:03:18 12:28:36	290	42324		NI
Demo-4.jpg	121445	2012:03:18 12:28:39	274	31398		NI
Demo-5.jpg	121427	2012:03:18 12:28:41	248	43164		NI

By clicking on one of the headers (e.g., Exif.Image.DateTime) you can sort the images/videos according the values in this column. When the mouse pointer hovers over the column heading, the description of the property is displayed (if available).

Options for display are:

- Show values in original format

Initially the data are displayed in interpreted format, e.g., "Exif.Photo.FNumber" is shown interpreted as "F4.5". Using the checkbox on top left you can switch to "Original format". "Exif.Photo.FNumber" is then displayed as "45/10".

- Exiv2 names English (original)

This option is usable only if language is not set to English. For languages others than English a translation of the exiv2 property names may be available. If translations are available the names of the properties are displayed initially in the selected display language. When this checkbox is checked, always English names are displayed.

Note for German translations: If the meaning of the tag and therefore the correct translation was not sure, the translation was omitted and the original (English) name is displayed.

ExifTool property names are always displayed in the language selected via the "Tools - Language for ExifTool" menu item in the main screen.

- Show thumbnails

With the checkbox "Show thumbnails", the display of thumbnails can be switched on and off.

- No further comparison of marked values

Some values are rather uninteresting for comparison, e.g., "Exif.Image.ExifTag" in the screen shot above. In order not to compare these values any longer, click on a value in the column and then the command button "No further comparison of marked values". You can also select several columns with Ctrl or a region with Shift and click in order to remove them together from the comparison. It is important to click the values and not on the header, because by clicking the column header the sort order is changed.

The chosen columns are stored in the settings.

- Configure hidden columns

This button opens the [Mask "Field definitions"](#) and selects the group "Exceptions during comparing files". Here you can delete the columns (so that they are no longer excluded from comparison) or chose other properties from the list of properties in order to exclude them from the comparison.

Command buttons:

Customize mask	Customize the mask, more details in Mask "Customize mask"
Close	Close the mask.
Help	Displays the help for this mask

15 Mask "Remove meta data"

With this mask you can remove Meta data (properties) from images – for videos this function is not supported. Properties must always be specified here in the notation used by exiv2.

There are limitations resulting from dependencies of single Meta data. Following limitations are considered in the program:

- Exif.Photo.MakerNote is a container for manufacturer specific Meta data. This field therefore cannot be deleted individually or defined as an exception. As long as a manufacturer specific field is present, Exif.Photo.MakerNote remains.
- If Exif.Image.Make is deleted, all manufacturer specific Meta data will be deleted. This field therefore cannot be deleted individually or defined as an exception.

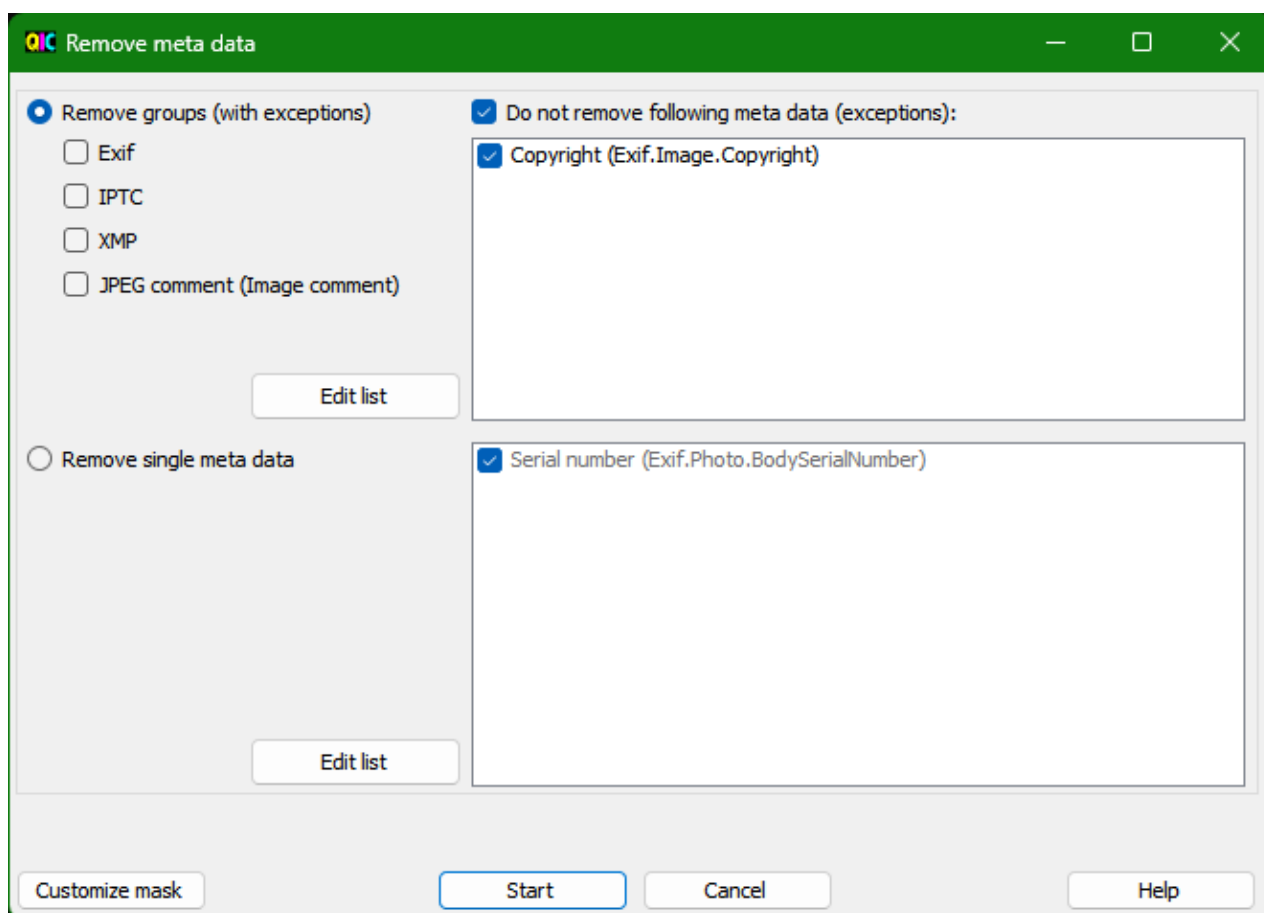
Dependencies can also lead to the fact that individual properties are not deleted, even though they are not defined as exceptions. I noticed so far:

- Exif.ExifTag
- Exif.MakerNote.ByteOrder
- Exif.MakerNote.Offset

Other special situations are possible, which can lead to the fact that properties are not removed as expected or exceptions are ignored. New settings in this screen (or corresponding configurations in [Mask "Field definitions"](#)) therefore should be first tried with copies of the images.

The mask allows two different approaches to remove Meta data:

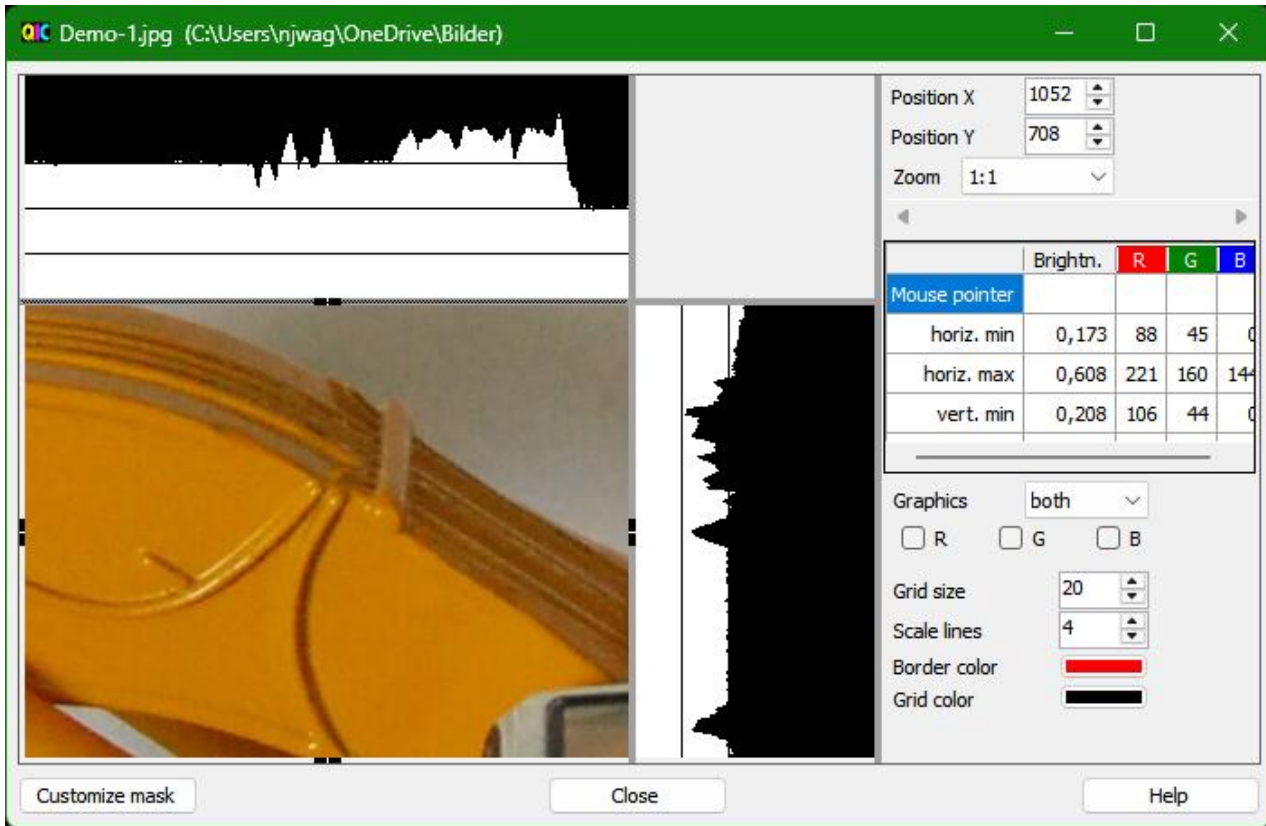
- Removing groups of Meta data: Exif, IPTC, XMP and JPEG comment
The groups can be selected individually. You can select properties that are not removed (exceptions). Additionally, you may generally switch on or off the consideration of exceptions. The properties available for selection can be defined in the [Mask "Field definitions"](#), group "Remove of meta data in groups - exceptions". The mask can be opened via button "Edit list" (in this case directly with selection of group) or via menu.
- Removal of meta-data which are selected individually
The properties available for selection can be defined in the [Mask "Field definitions"](#), group "Remove single meta data - name the meta data". The mask can be opened via button "Edit list" (in this case directly with selection of group) or via menu.

**Command buttons:**

Customize mask	Customize the mask, more details in Mask "Customize mask"
Start	Start removing meta data
Cancel	Close mask without removing meta data
Help	Displays the help for this mask

16 Mask "Image Details"

With this mask, image details can be shown. This is also possible via adjustment ([Mask "Adjust view"](#)) in one of the areas of the main mask. However, with this mask more space is available, which is especially useful if a second monitor is available.



For each selected image/video one window is shown. This allows to compare image details of several images, e.g., to find the image with best sharpness. The last opened window is superior to the other windows. This means:

- The settings of superior window are transferred to secondary windows .
- A shift of picture section in superior window is transferred synchronously to the secondary windows.
- In secondary windows, settings are hidden.
- Picture section in secondary windows still can be adjusted separately, as the point of interest can be on a slightly different position in each image.
- With the button "Close all" of the superior window, also the secondary windows are closed.

Further details are described in [Display of image details](#).

Command buttons in lower part of the mask:

Customize mask	Customize the mask, more details in Mask "Customize mask"
Close all	Close all masks for image details
Close	Close mask
Help	Displays the help for this mask

17 Mask "Image in own window"

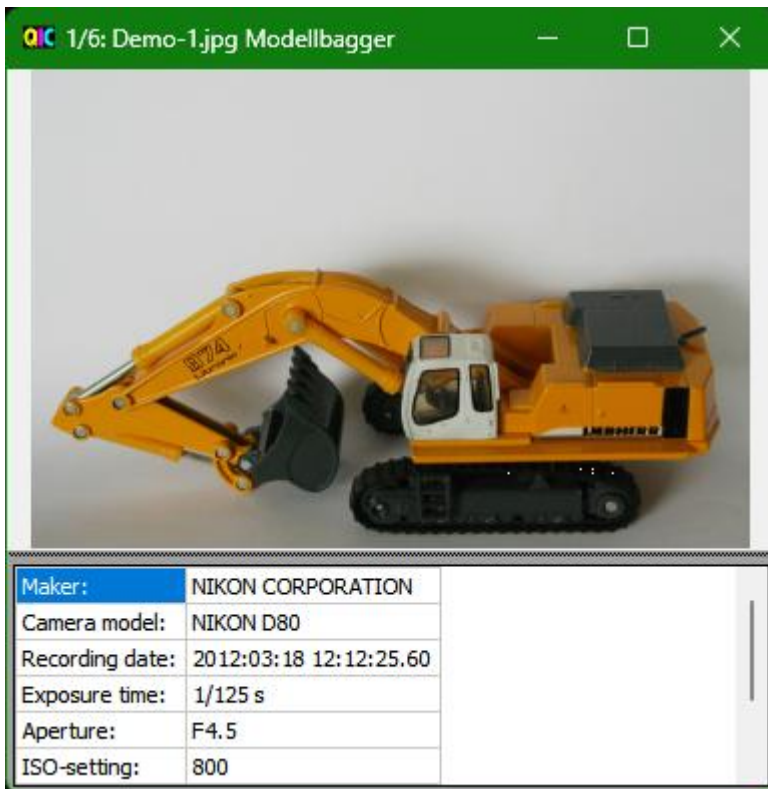
This mask has three purposes:

- If a second monitor is available, this mask can be used to show the selected image with maximum size there.
- To compare several images: they can be selected together in the main mask and for each image one window is opened.
- Scroll through the images, displaying the images with maximum size and a few information (meta-data).

In order to make use of available space on monitor at the best, the mask contains only the picture box and table for properties, which can also be hidden via the context menu.

The header displays the number of the image in the file list, the total number of files in the file list and properties configured in [Mask "Field definitions"](#).

Which properties are displayed in the table can also be configured in [Mask "Field definitions"](#), separately for images and videos. The division between image and table can be adjusted by moving the gray separator line.



Scroll images/videos:

- One image/video forward/backward with cursor keys right/left.
- One image/video forward/backward by clicking on the right third or left third of image display.
- Multiple images/videos forward/backward with the "Page up" and "Page down" keys. The number of images/videos can be changed via the context menu. Default is 5 images/videos.

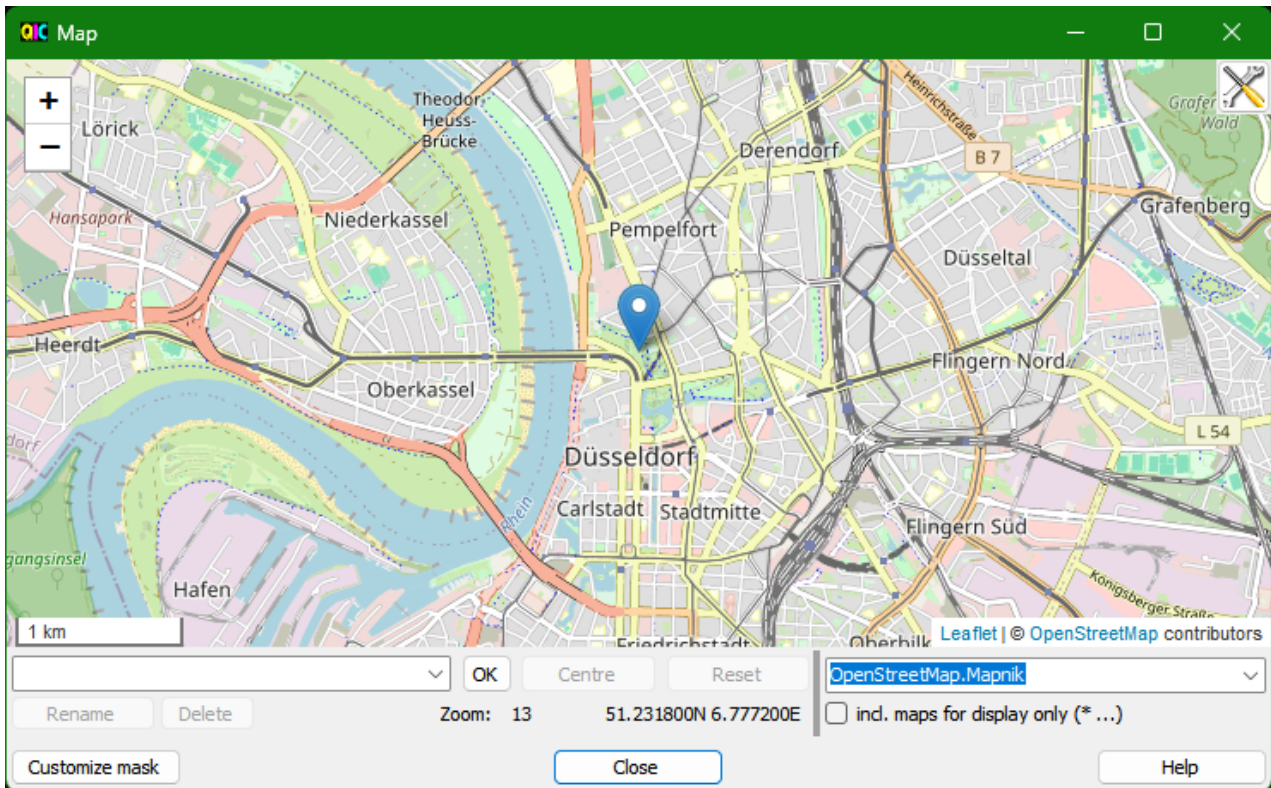
The context menu (right-click in mask) contains:

- Adjust fields
Opens [Mask "Field definitions"](#) to configure the properties displayed in the table. Depending on whether an image or video is displayed, the appropriate group is selected.

- Adjust header line
Opens [Mask "Field definitions"](#) to configure the properties displayed in the header line.
- Properties
 - Off = no display of properties
 - Bottom = display of properties below the picture
 - Right = display of properties on right hand side of picture
- Scroll with image up/down - Number of images
Opens a mask for entering the number of images/videos to be scrolled through with the "Page up" and "Page down" keys.

18 Mask "Map"

With this mask, recording location can be shown on a map and associated data can be changed. This is also possible via adjustment ([Mask "Adjust view"](#)) in one of the areas of the main mask. However, with this mask more space is available, which is especially useful if a second monitor is available.



Further details are described in [Recording location on map](#).

Command buttons in lower part of the mask:

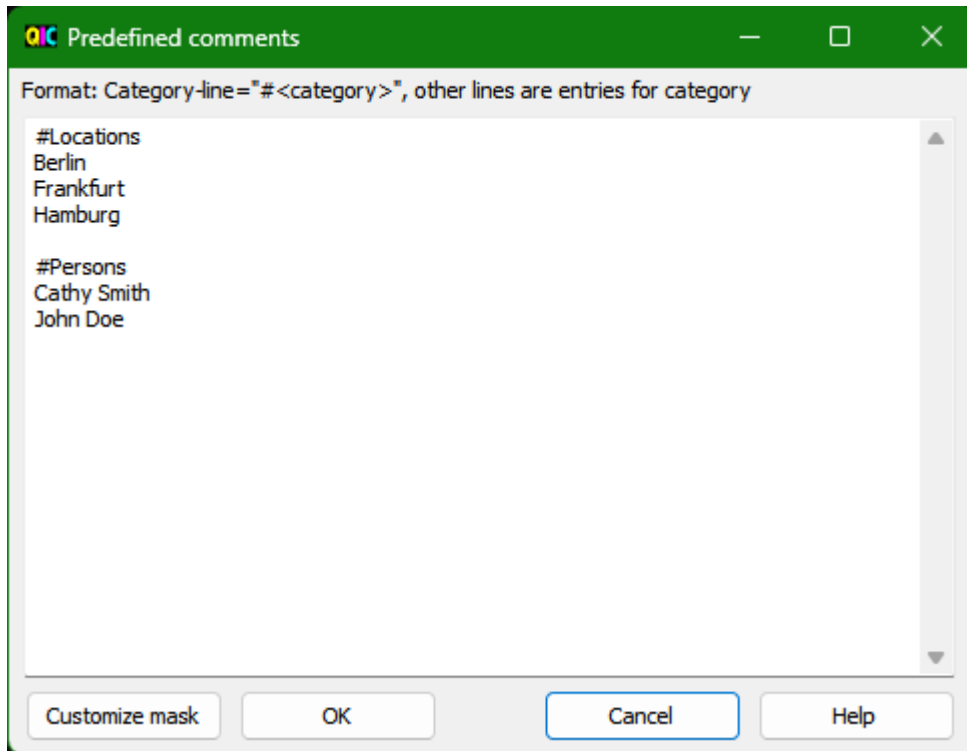
Customize mask	Customize the mask, more details in Mask "Customize mask"
Close	Close mask
Help	Displays the help for this mask

19 Mask "Predefined comments"

In this mask you can predefine comments that are then displayed on the main screen in the list "Predefined comments". These comments can be divided into categories. According to these categories the list "Predefined comments" in the main mask can be filtered.

Lines with "#" at the beginning define a category; all other lines are comments to the category above.

In the following example, two categories are defined: "Locations" and "Persons":



Command buttons:

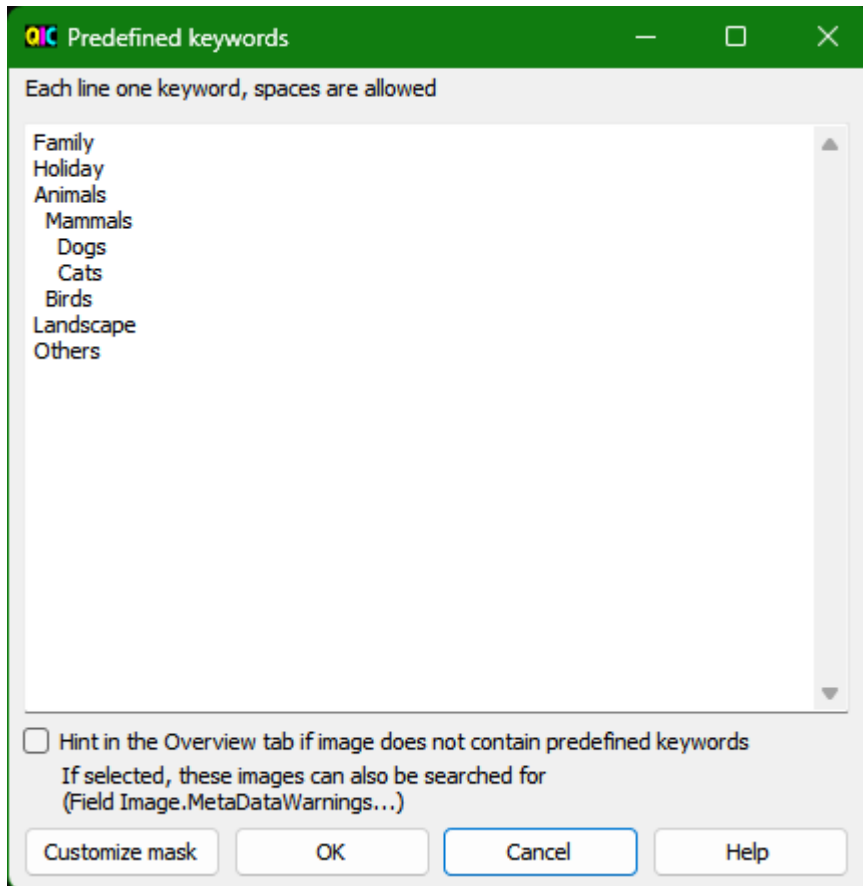
Customize mask	Customize the mask, more details in Mask "Customize mask"
OK	Save changes and close mask
Cancel	Close mask without saving changes
Help	Displays the help for this mask

20 Mask "Predefined keywords"

In this mask you can define keywords that are displayed in the main mask resp. in [Mask "Select and edit data template"](#) in the area "Keywords" as tree with check boxes.

Each row defines an keyword; spaces in the key word will be accepted.

A hierarchy of keywords can be defined by indentation. This allows parts of the tree of the "Keywords" area to be expanded and collapsed, which facilitates the selection of keywords. The indentation depth can be freely selected.



Optionally, a hint can be displayed in the Overview tab if an image contains keywords that are not predefined. If this option is activated, these images/videos can also be searched for using the field "Image.MetadataWarnings" or "Image.MetadataWarningsNotExiv2". This is to facilitate consistent keywording by finding and avoiding misspellings or synonyms.

Hint:

Up to and including version 4.54 the definition with hierarchy was not supported. Leading spaces in a line were removed when saving - which would remove the hierarchy information now. Therefore, as of version 4.55, keywords are stored differently in the configuration file. Entries written with earlier versions are accepted, but entries written with 4.55 or higher are not read with 4.54 or lower. As a result, the display is different between 4.54 and 4.55, but the keywords stored in the images remain unchanged.

Command buttons:

Customize mask	Customize the mask, more details in Mask "Customize mask"
OK	Save changes and close mask
Cancel	Close mask without saving changes

Help	Displays the help for this mask
------	---------------------------------

21 Mask "Select and edit data template"

Data templates can be defined to set several properties in one step. With this mask data templates can be created, modified, selected and deleted.

Layout of the mask

- Drop down list with already created templates
- Combo box for artist (author)
- Combo box for comment
- Configurable input area

In this area the same properties are shown as in the configurable input area of the main mask.

- Input area for keywords

As in the main mask this area contains a text box for free key words and check boxes for predefined keywords.

For artist, comment and configurable properties, which can have only one value, combo boxes are used. They contain lists with the values latest saved in the main mask.

With the F10-key or double-click in input fields for artist (author), comment or in configurable input area, a [Mask for input of data](#) is opened to have a larger and variable input range for long and/or multi-line values. Via this mask also the [Mask "Edit / insert placeholder"](#) can be opened.

With the Shift-F10-key or double-click with Shift-key in input fields for artist (author), comment or in configurable input area, the [Mask "Edit / insert placeholder"](#) is opened.

Placeholders are replaced with the value of the referenced property during saving and thus allow copying values from one property to another.

Usage of data templates

The template selected when closing the mask can be used in the main mask to fill input fields there. This can be done via menu entry "Tools - Load data from template:" (amended with the name of the template) or following button:



If no template was selected, the menu entry and the button are disabled.

During loading data only empty fields are filled, i.e., existing data are not replaced.

In the main mask the fields for artist and comment as well as the configurable input area and input area for keywords can be hidden. Data are not loaded into hidden fields.

Command buttons:

New - empty	Create new data template - input fields are empty
New - with data from main mask	Create new data template - input fields are filled with data from main mask
Save	Saves the template
Save as ...	Saves the template with new name
Delete	Deletes the selected template
Customize mask	Customize the mask, more details in Mask "Customize mask"
Close	Close the mask; the selected data template can be used in the main mask.
Help	Displays the help for this mask

22 Mask "Edit / insert placeholder"

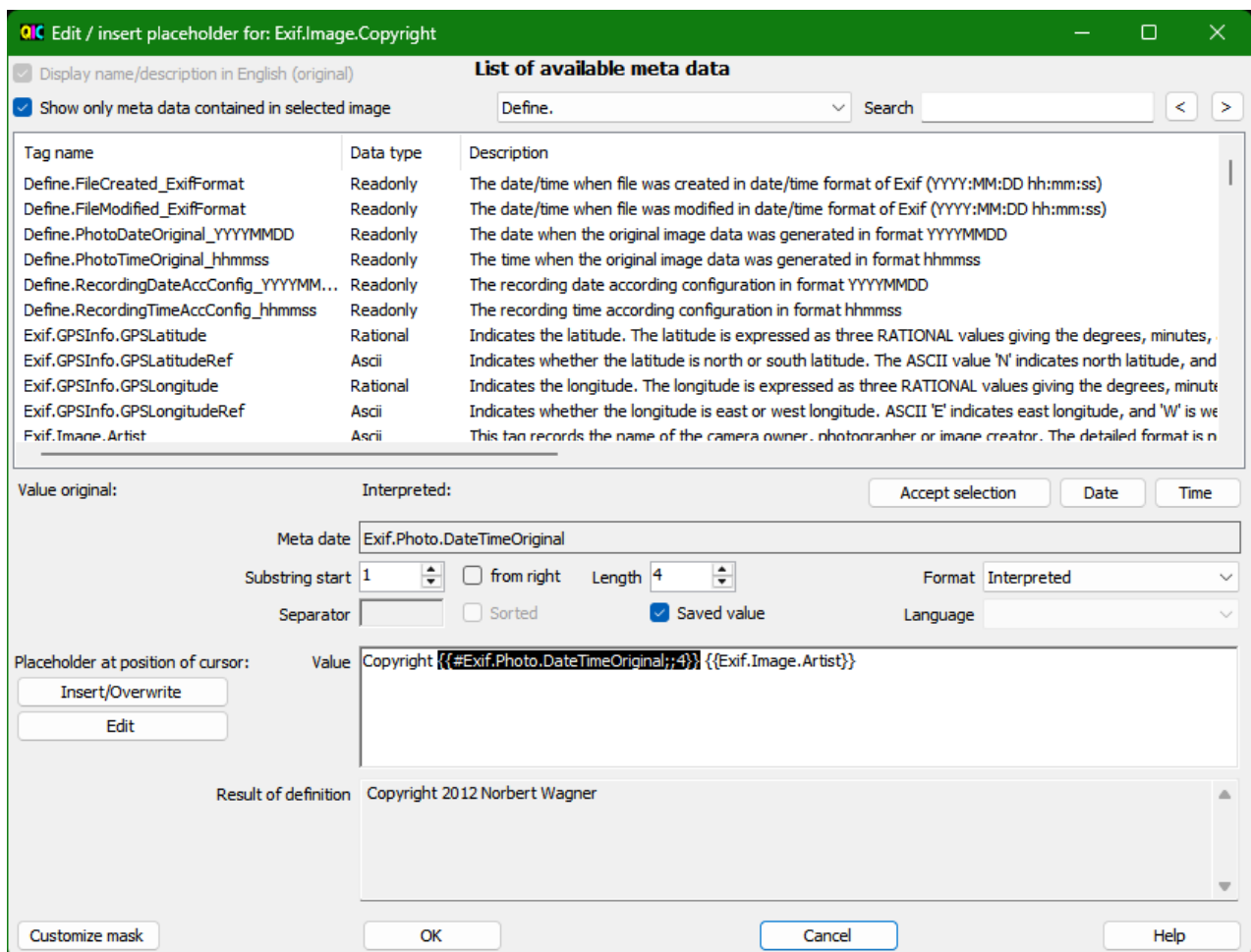
In the input fields you can use placeholders for other properties. Possible use cases are:

1. With Windows Live Photo Gallery people can be recognized in images. The names are stored in an XMP property, which many other programs do not show. You can copy the names using a placeholder into another property (e.g., Exif.Photo.UserComment) so that they are visible in other programs (e.g., when distributing images to people who do not use the Windows Live Photo Gallery).
2. When you enter the artist (author), a copyright notice is generated at the same time.
3. Changes will be logged.
4. If in the past different properties were used to comment the images/videos, the comments can be copied to one property.

The definition of the placeholders for these use cases is explained further below.

It is recommended to first try each new placeholder with a test image. It should also be noted that the placeholders are replaced during saving the changes and because of the dependence on other values this process can become very complex. Therefore, there is no input check, e.g., whether a valid date value is created after replacing the placeholder.

The placeholders can be inserted and edited by this mask. It is opened with the Shift-F10 key or double-click with Shift-key in input fields for artist (author), comment or in configurable input area:



In the upper part is a list of the available meta-data with tag name, data type, and description - as in [Mask "Field definitions"](#).

User controls for definition and check of placeholders

With the following user controls placeholders are defined, marked placeholders are edited and the result is checked. After definition of a placeholder, it has to be inserted into the value field (see next section).

- Button "Accept selection"
The tag name of selected property is copied into the edit area below.
 - Button "Date"
Tag name "Date" for current date is copied into the edit area below.
 - Button "Time"
Tag name "Time" for current time is copied into the edit area below.
 - Definition of substrings:
 - starting position, from which the property value is taken over (allows to cut off characters at the beginning or end)
 - checkbox "from right": if checked, the start position is counted from right, otherwise from left
 - length, maximum number of characters; value 0: all characters
 - Selection list for formatting the value with the following options:
 - Interpreted
 - Original
- For data types "Rational" and "SRational" additionally:
- Decimal - 1 decimal place
 - Decimal - 2 decimal places
 - Decimal - 3 decimal places
 - Decimal - 4 decimal places
 - Decimal - 5 decimal places
 - Decimal - without decimal places
- For date/time values additionally:
- Local date/time format (according system settings)
 - ISO/IPTC date/time format (e.g., 2016-09-20T18:25:00)
 - Exif date/time format (e.g., 2016:09:20 18:25:00)
 - five formats defined via general configuration file, predefined are:
 - <weekday short> DD.MM.YYYY HH:mm:ss
 - <weekday short> YYYY-MM-DD HH:mm:ss
 - <weekday long> DD.MM.YYYY HH:mm:ss
 - DD-<month short>-YYYY HH:mm:ss
 - D. <month long> YYYY HH:mm:ss
- Input field for separator (for properties with several values)
 - Checkbox "Sorted" (for properties with several values, where sequence is arbitrary, e.g., for keywords)
 - Checkbox "Saved value"
When checked, always the saved value is used; otherwise, the current value is used. Meaning of "current" is: If the property was changed in the mask, the changed value is used, otherwise the value already stored in the image.
 - Selection list for language (only for fields of type "LangAlt")
 - Input field for value
In this field the value can be edited directly or placeholders can be inserted, overwritten or edited via the buttons on the left-hand side. Additional to placeholders fixed texts can be inserted here.

- Output field for value

In this field the result after replacing of all defined placeholders is shown. In case of errors in placeholder definition, the error message is shown here.

Insert, overwrite or edit of placeholders

The cursor has to be placed on the position in input field for the value, where a change is intended.

- Button "Insert/Overwrite"

In case no placeholder is inserted yet at selection, a placeholder according to the entries in the fields "Meta date" and following is inserted.

In case a placeholder is inserted there, he is overwritten with entries in the fields "Meta date" and following.

- Button "Edit"

Can be used only, if the selected location is inside a placeholder. The definition of the placeholder is transferred into the fields "Meta date" and following to allow editing the placeholder there.

The placeholder, which can be edited via fields "Meta date" and following, is highlighted by white font on black background. If changes are done in the fields "Meta date" and following, but no placeholder is marked, the hint "No placeholder marked" is shown.

It is possible to define placeholder for properties, in which in turn another placeholder is entered. Up to five levels are supported in this way.

Interpreted and Original for data type "LangAlt"

With data type "LangAlt" values can be specified in different languages. If a language is specified in the placeholder, the value entered for this language is used. In this case Interpreted and Original give the same result. If no language is specified, all values are used, separated with the specified separator. With Formatting "Interpreted" the language identifier (e.g., "en-US") is shown before each value, with Formatting "Original" not.

Notation of placeholders in input field for the value

Placeholders can also be defined by simply entering text. It should be noted that placeholders are not checked if they are Xmp properties as XMP is an open standard.

The spelling of the properties must be exact - in compliance with upper and lower case. When replacing placeholders by values, there is a check – as far as possible - if the property in principle is known. If the referenced property is not contained in the image, the placeholder is replaced by an empty string. Placeholder must use the English name of the property.

Due to that it is recommended to define placeholders via the controls in the mask. If this is not possible, the placeholder should always be tested with an image/video in which the corresponding property is defined.

Here are the rules how a placeholder is constructed:

- The individual entries are separated with ";"
- The placeholder starts with "{{"
- Tag name
in case the saved value shall be used with leading "#"
optional for properties of type "LangAlt": separator "|" and language
- Start position of substring (negative, if counted from the right)
- Length of substring
- Formatting
 - o = original value
 - s = sort values

- only for data types Rational and SRational:
d0 - d5 = decimal value with 0 to 5 decimal places
- only for date/time values:
tl, ti, te, t1 - t5: Date/time formats local, ISO/IPTC, Exif and the five formats defined via the general configuration file
- Separator for properties with several values
- The placeholder ends with "}"

Examples

If Iptc.Application2.Caption has the value "abcdefgh", you get following results for placeholders:

```
{{Iptc.Application2.Caption;3}} = cdefgh  
{{Iptc.Application2.Caption,3,4}} = cdef  
{{Iptc.Application2.Caption;-4}} = efgh  
{{Iptc.Application2.Caption;-4;2}} = ef
```

If Exif.Photo.ExposureTime has the value "1/60", you get following results for placeholders:

```
{{Exif.Photo.ExposureTime}} = 1/60 s  
{{Exif.Photo.ExposureTime;;;o}} = 1/60  
{{Exif.Photo.ExposureTime;;;d3}} = 0.017
```

If Xmp.dc.creator has the value "John Doe" and "Barbara Smith", you get following results for placeholders:

```
{{Xmp.dc.creator}} = John Doe, Barbara Smith  
{{Xmp.dc.creator;;;s}} = Barbara Smith, John Doe  
{{Xmp.dc.creator;;;s; and }} = Barbara Smith and John Doe
```

Placeholder definitions for initially listed use cases

Placeholder definitions for the initially listed use cases can be simply copied into the value field of the mask and - if needed - modified in the mask.

1. Persons recognized by Windows Live Photo Gallery:

Windows Live Photo Gallery writes the names of the persons and other data (position in the image, if applicable Windows Live ID) into Xmp.MP.RegionInfo. In order to obtain the names the following placeholder has to be used:

```
{{Xmp.MP.RegionInfo/MPRI:Regions[]/MPReg:PersonDisplayName}}
```

The order results from the order in which Windows Live Photo Gallery writes the values into Xmp.MP.RegionInfo. This may not necessarily be from left to right. Therefore, it may be useful generally to sort the names in order to have a clear order:

```
{{Xmp.MP.RegionInfo/MPRI:Regions[]/MPReg:PersonDisplayName;;;s}}
```

2. Copyright notice:

If you enter your name in Exif.Image.Author, you can create a following placeholder to create a copyright notice:

```
Copyright {{Date;4}} {{Exif.Image.Artist}}
```

When you want to add a copyright notice for older images, you can take the year from the date of recording:

```
Copyright {{#Exif.Photo.DateTimeOriginal;4}} {{Exif.Image.Artist}}
```

3. Logging of changes:

With the following definition the date, time and name are added to an existing entry in Exif.Image.ImageHistory:

```
{{#Exif.Image.ImageHistory}}; {{Date}} {{Time}} John Doe
```

If this is applied several times, it gives a list showing who has applied changes when.

4. Collecting Comments:

There are some properties that are usable to enter a comment for an image. When various properties such as Exif.Image.ImageDescription, Exif.Photo.UserComment, Iptc.Application2.Caption, Xmp.dc.description and Xmp.dc.title were used in several images, their values can be copied to Exif.Photo.UserComment using following placeholder:

{{Image.CommentCombinedFields}}

The field "Image.CommentCombinedFields" contains the values of the different fields for comment, separated by "|". If the same value is stored in different fields, it will be copied only once.

If several properties are filled and another separator is desired, e.g. comma:

{{Exif.Image.ImageDescription}}, {{#Exif.Photo.UserComment}},
{{Iptc.Application2.Caption}}, {{Xmp.dc.description}}, {{Xmp.dc.title}}

In front of Exif.Photo.UserComment a "#" is added. As the complete placeholder definition is entered in the field for Exif.Photo.UserComment, the placeholder for Exif.Photo.UserComment has to refer to the last saved value for Exif.Photo.UserComment.

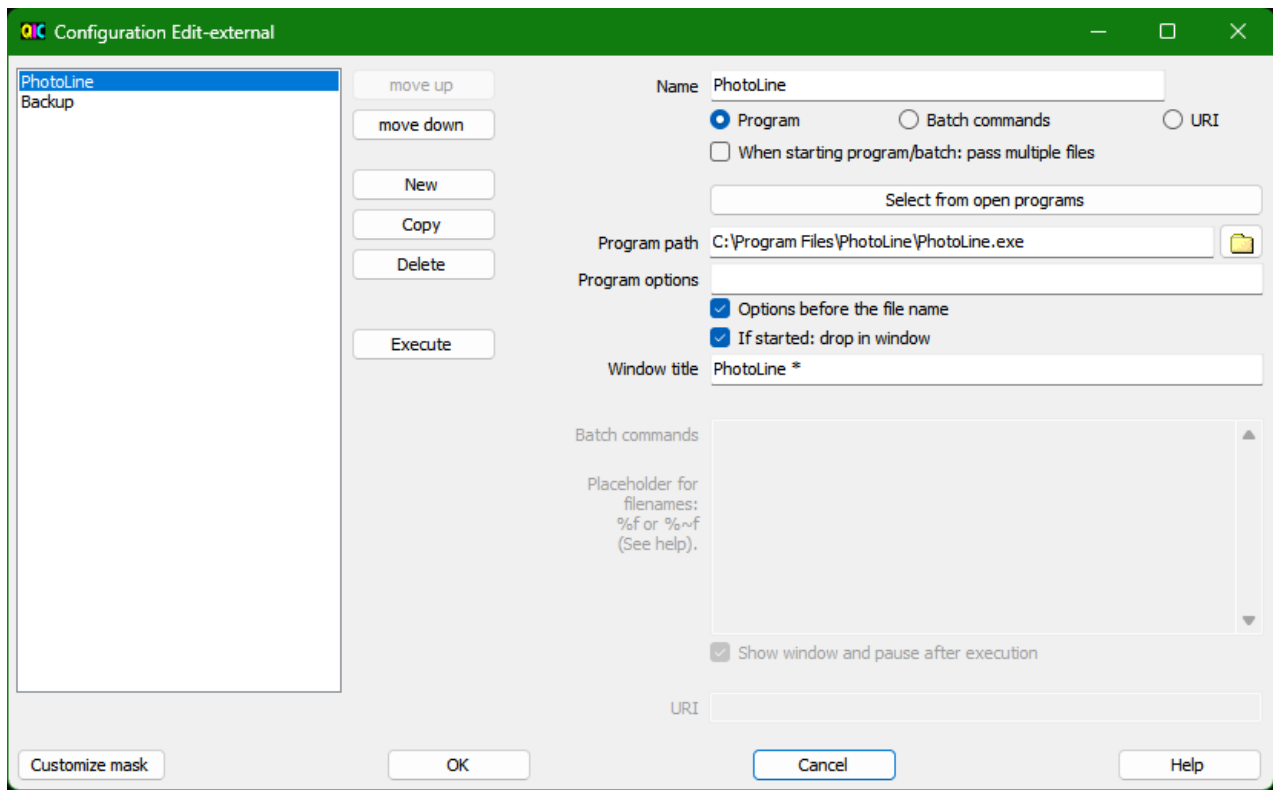
It may happen that nothing is between the delimiters, because the properties are not defined. A manual rework then cannot be avoided.

Command buttons:

Customize mask	Customize the mask, more details in Mask "Customize mask"
OK	Accept input and close mask
Cancel	Close mask without accepting input
Help	Displays the help for this mask

23 Mask "Configuration Edit-external"

Via the menu item "Edit-external" the selected files can be transferred to external programs or Windows batch scripts. With this mask the configurations for the external processing are created or changed.



Create new configuration

- The "New" button is used to create a new configuration.
- In the field "Name" the name is entered, which is also displayed in the menu "Edit-external".
- It must be selected whether the configuration is for a program, for batch commands or for starting via URI.

Edit existing configuration

After selecting a configuration in the list on the left, the details are displayed on the right and can be edited there.

Configuration for "Program"

The program path and window title are required to identify the external program. The easiest way to fill in these two fields is to start the external program and then click on the "Select from open programs" button. A screen opens with a list of open programs. Select the desired program there. Click "OK" to accept the program path and window title.

When "If started: Drop in window" is selected, a check is made during execution whether the program is already running or not:

1. First, it is checked whether there is an open window with the defined window title. If this is the case, the selected files are transferred to the window via drag-and-drop.
2. If no window title is defined or no suitable window is found, a window is searched for via the program path. If successful, the selected files are transferred to the window via drag-and-drop.

3. If no suitable window is found in the second step either, the program is started with the defined program options.
 - Depending on "Options before filename" the options are passed first or the filenames first.
 - If several files were selected and "On start of program/batch: Transfer several files" was selected, all files are transferred on start.
 - If "On startup of program/batch: Transfer multiple files" was not selected, the program is started individually for each file.

When "If started: Drop in window" is not selected, the program always will be started as described under 3.

Placeholders can be used when entering the window title:

?	corresponds to a single character at a given position
*	corresponds to any number of characters

This is required if the window title is dynamic.

Example:

When Paint is started, the window title is "Untitled - Paint". When a file is opened, e.g., Image.jpg, the window title is changed to "Image.jpg - Paint". Therefore, "* - Paint" should be entered as the window title in the configuration.

Configuration for "Batch commands"

During execution, the batch commands are executed. Placeholders for the selected files must be entered in the batch commands. Placeholders can be:

Placeholder	Description	Result (based on the file C:\users\user1\Image 1.jpg)
%f	Full filename; with quotation marks if spaces are included	"C:\users\user1\Image 1.jpg"
%~f	Full file name always without quotation marks	C:\users\user1\Image 1.jpg
%~df	Drive	C:\
%~pf	Path	C:\users\user1
%~nf	Name (without path and extension)	Image 1
%~xf	File extension	.jpg

In most cases the placeholder "%f" should be useful, especially because it adds quotation marks at the beginning and end if there are spaces in the filename. With all other placeholders, no quotation marks are added.

If multiple files were selected and "On start of program/batch: pass multiple files" was selected, the placeholder will be replaced by a list of files separated by spaces.

Example:

If C:\users\user1\Image 1.jpg and C:\users\user1\Image 2.jpg are selected, the placeholder %f results in:

"C:\users1\Image 1.jpg" "C:\users1\Image 2.jpg"

It is recommended to select "Show window and pause after execution". Then the execution of the batch commands with possible messages will be displayed in a window, which will be closed only after confirmation. Only if it is sure that no feedback (e.g., in case of errors) is required, this should be omitted.

Configuration for URI

Some programs are started via URI, e.g. Microsoft Photos. For configuration only the URI has to be entered (e.g. for Microsoft Photos: "ms-photos:viewer?fileName="). When executed, the filename is appended to the URI.

Hint:

Via [Mask "User defined buttons"](#) buttons can be defined also for the configurations defined here. For programs usually the icon from program path can be selected.

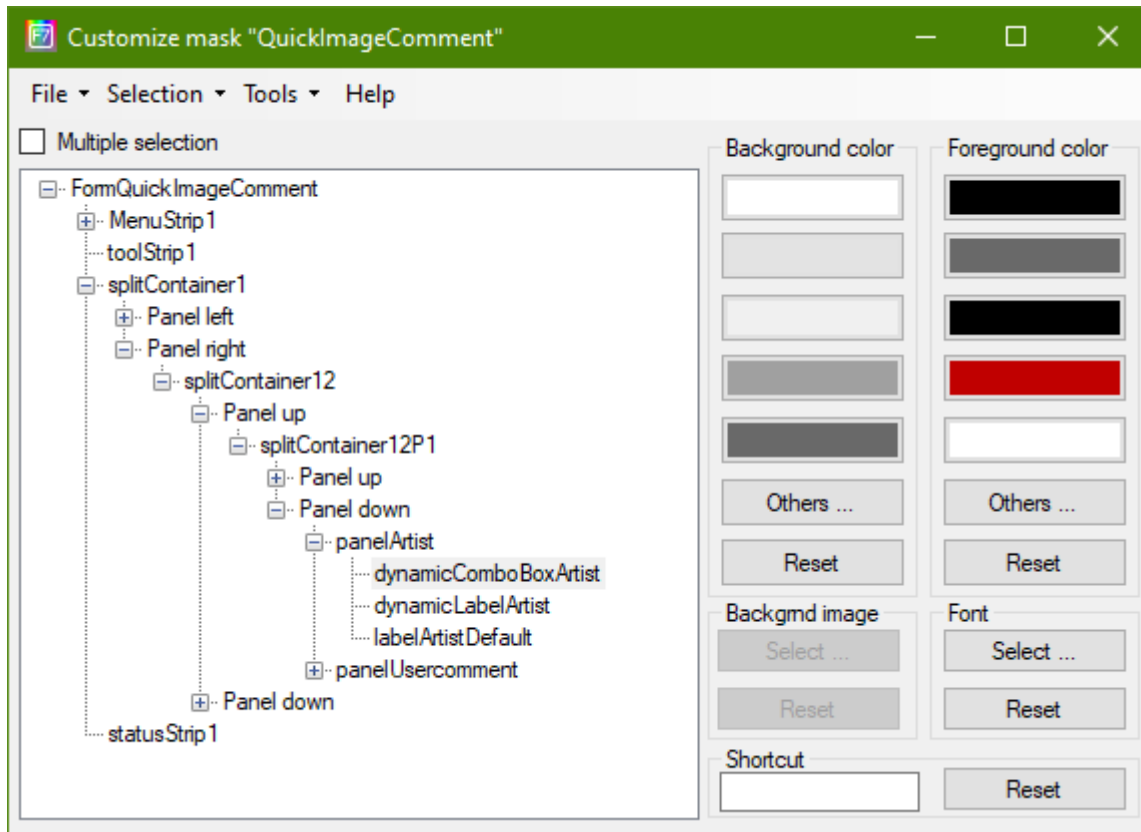
Command buttons:

move up	The selected entry is moved up
move down	The selected entry is moved down
New	A new configuration is created
Copy	The marked entry is copied
Delete	The marked entry is deleted
Execute	The selected entry is executed with the selected file(s). Is primarily included here to test the configuration.
Customize mask	Customize the mask, more details in Mask "Customize mask"
OK	Accept input and close mask
Cancel	Close mask without accepting input
Help	Displays the help for this mask

24 Mask "Customize mask"

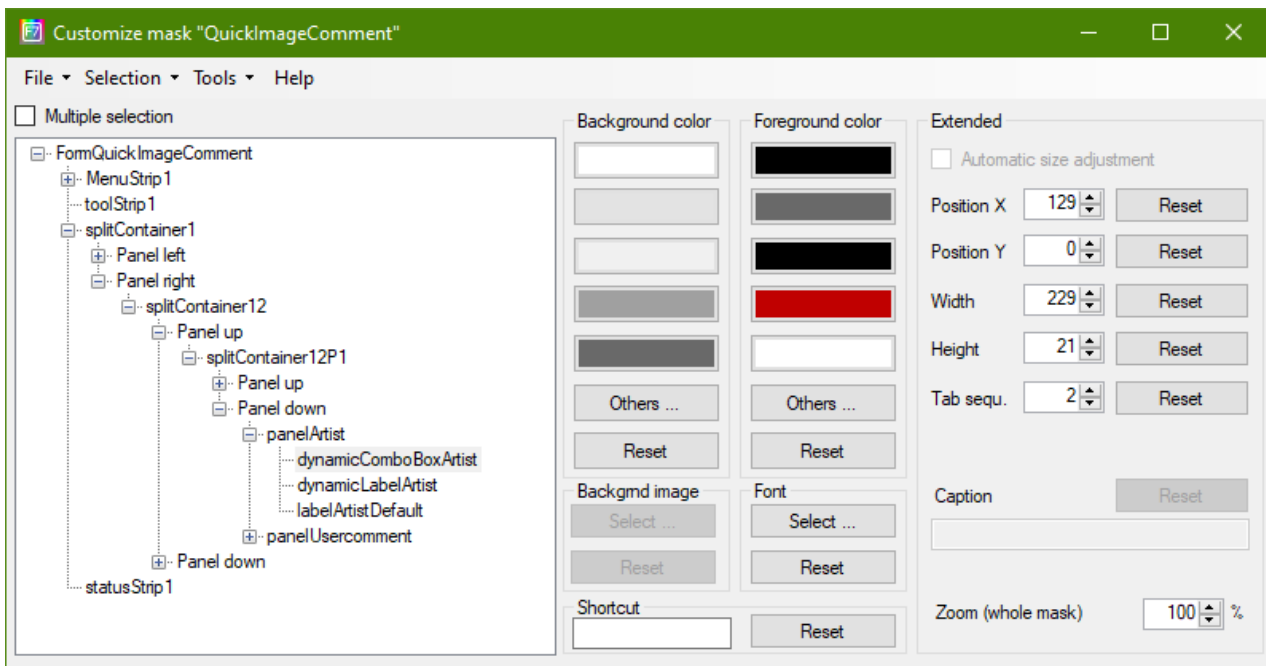
With this mask you can customize following properties of a mask:

- Background color
- Foreground color
- Background image
- Font
- Shortcut



In the advanced settings (show and hide using menu "Tools - Advanced settings") you can customize additionally:

- Position
- Size
- Tab sequence
- Caption
- Zoom



24.1 Select controls and adjust

In the left part of the screen is a tree with all controls of the mask. After opening the mask, the control is selected, which had the focus. Another control can now be selected in the tree or by setting the focus on a control in the mask to be customized (e.g., the main mask).

Some controls (e.g., labels, i.e., fixed text) can be not selected in mask to customize. These are then accessible only via the tree.

With the checkbox "Multiple selection" above the tree you can chose, whether several controls can be selected in the tree at the same time.

Another possibility is using the menu "Selection" to select all controls or all controls of a certain type (e.g., System.Windows.Forms.Label = fixed text).

The selected controls are displayed in the mask to customize with a red frame. The color of the frame can be changed using the menu entry "Tools - Border color for marking".

In the area to the right, you may change settings for the selected controls. With the command buttons "Reset" you restore the original values (i.e., the state of delivery).

Foreground and Background color:

With several command buttons you can directly assign a color. With the command button "Others ..." any other color can be selected. If you want to use this color more often, you can assign them to one of the command buttons using the menu entry "Tools - Customize mask". Another window will open, in order to customize the customization mask itself. There you can change the background color for the command buttons.

Background image and font

With the command buttons "Select ..." a mask to select a picture or font is opened.

Shortcut key

To assign a shortcut key to a control, you have to set the focus into the text box and then press the desired key combination. An editing of the text box is not possible. With the back key, the delete key or the esc key the assignment is deleted.

24.2 Advanced settings and other extras

Advanced Settings

The advanced settings are displayed or hidden using menu "Tools - Advanced settings".

The advanced settings allow users to change the mask layout fundamentally:

- Position and size of controls can be adjusted.
- The tab order (the order in which the focus changes when the tab key is pressed) can be changed.
- Captions (e.g., from labels) can be changed.
- The size of the mask including all controls can be adjusted (zoom). Here, the total size of the mask, the size of all controls and the font are uniformly magnified or reduced. Depending on the zoom factor further individual adjustments are necessary to obtain a coherent overall picture.

Note: While the Zoom setting can have a practical use (enlarge to improve legibility, downsizing to display more information), the other settings are more likely not relevant in practice.

The Zoom setting in this mask is intended to set the magnification for a single mask. With [Mask "Scaling"](#) the general scaling for all masks can be set. In order for the general scaling to be applied to a mask, the value for Zoom must be set to the value selected in [Mask "Scaling"](#). Afterwards, the general factor applies until a different value is entered in [Mask "Customize mask"](#) mask.

Border color for marking

The selected controls are displayed in the mask to customize with a red frame. The color of the frame can be changed using the menu entry "Tools - Border color for marking".

Customize mask

Using the menu entry "Tools - Customize mask" you can also customize the customization mask itself.

Reset all settings

With the menu entry "Tools - Reset all settings" you can reset all settings of that mask back to their original values (factory setting).

List shortcut keys

With the menu entry "Tools - List shortcut keys" all shortcut keys assigned in the mask are listed.

24.3 Saving and loading of settings

The settings that are made using this mask are stored in a separate configuration file. The name of this file is stored in the general configuration file (see [General configuration file](#)).

In the File menu you have the following options:

Load settings - overwrite	Via a separate mask, a configuration file is opened. The existing settings are deleted and the settings in the file are loaded.
------------------------------	---

Load settings - supplement	Via a separate mask, a configuration file is opened. The existing settings are not deleted. The settings from the file are loaded. If there is an existing setting and the file contains a different value, the existing value is overwritten.
Save settings	The changed settings are stored in the configuration file. If there is no associated configuration file, the menu item is not selectable (grey). Otherwise, the file name of the configuration file is also displayed in the menu entry.
Save settings as ...	The settings are stored in a configuration file. Name and location to store are given in a mask.
Close	Close the mask.

If settings have been made, but these are not yet stored, you will be asked when quitting the program, if they should be saved or not.

The configuration file is a simple text file and can be edited with a text editor. But this carries the risk that errors are made that make the file unreadable for the program.

In the sub directory "config" of the program directory some sample files are included (FormCustomization-xxx.ini). Their purpose is just to illustrate, which customizations are possible. Use in practice is not intended.

25 Slideshow

The menu item "View – Slideshow" can be used to start a slideshow of the images/videos displayed in the file list. It starts with the currently selected image/video. For videos just one frame is shown.

A screen for the slideshow settings appears first:

- Time delay between two images/video frames
- Number of images/videos that can be scrolled through using the "Page up" and "Page down" buttons.
- Background color
- Font color for the subtitles
- Font and font size of the subtitles
- Button for selecting the fields for the subtitle; the [Mask "Field definitions"](#) opens.
- Options for displaying subtitles:
 - Do not show subtitles
 - Always show subtitles below the image
 - If image fills height, subtitles transparent in image, otherwise below image
- Opacity of the background if subtitles are displayed transparently above the image

A checkbox can be used to specify that the settings screen is no longer displayed when the slideshow is started. It can be reopened at any time during the slideshow with the right mouse button.

The "Discard changes" button discards the changes made since the screen was opened - with the exception of the changes to the subtitle fields.

The "OK" button accepts the settings and starts the slideshow.

The "Cancel" button discards the changes to the settings and ends the slideshow.

In addition to the time-controlled change of images/video frames, it is also possible to scroll manually:

- One image/video forwards/backwards using the right/left cursor keys.
- Several images/videos forward/backward with the "Page up" and "Page down" buttons.
The number of images/videos can be changed. The default setting is 5 images/videos.

The time-controlled change can be paused and restarted with the space bar or the left mouse button.

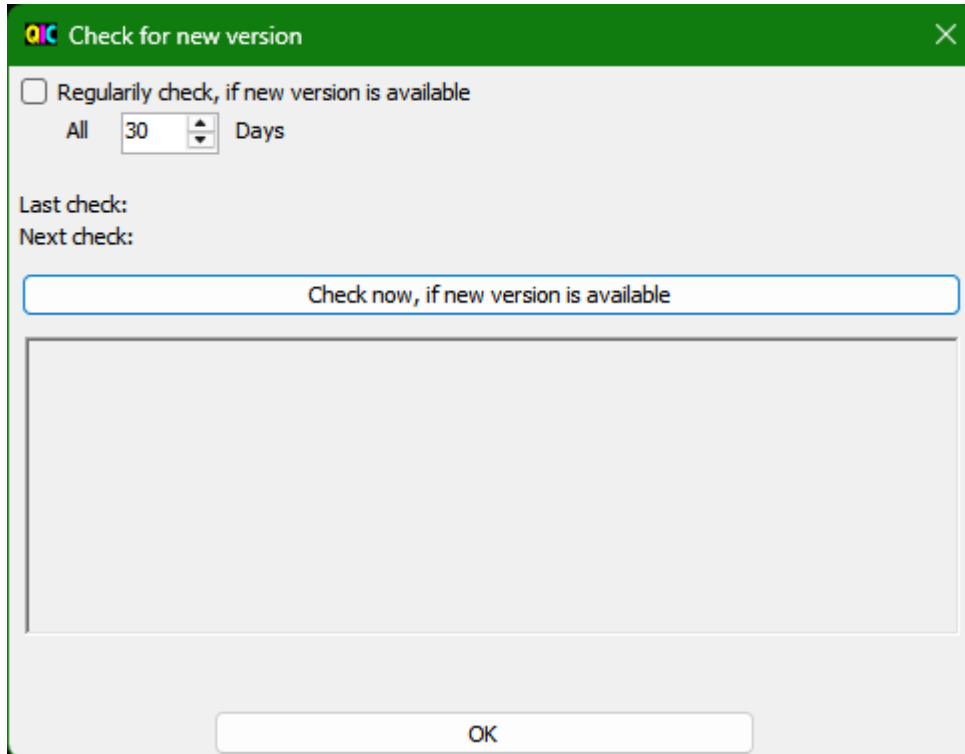
The slideshow is ended with the ESC key.

If the image size is smaller than the screen size, the image is displayed at a scale of 1:1. This prevents images with a small resolution from being displayed pixelated. If the image size is larger than the screen size, the display is adapted to the screen size.

26 Mask "Check for new version"

Note: If the program was obtained from the Microsoft Store, it will be updated automatically. Therefore, this mask is not available then.

The program can check if a new version is available. With this mask you can start this check and can configure if and in which time interval the check is performed automatically at program start.



The mask contains (from top to bottom):

- Checkbox to select if the regular check is done or not
- Input field to select the cycle time for automatic check
- Information, when the last check was performed
- Information, when the next check will be performed
- Command button to start the check directly
- Output area with the result of the check. If a new version is available, the new version as well as a short summary of the changes is displayed.
- If there is a new version available: Command button to open the download area of the website of the program

27 Command line arguments

If QuickImageComment is started via the command line or a corresponding shortcut is created, arguments can be given:

- The folder to display
- One or more files to display
- A user-specific configuration file
- Parameters that override the settings in the general configuration file.

The order of the arguments is arbitrary. Different arguments can be combined. However, if files are passed as arguments, folder arguments are ignored.

Folder to be displayed/files to be displayed

These arguments are certainly the most frequently used because they are used to display files by drag-and-drop. Without these arguments, the last folder used is read from the user-related configuration file and displayed.

If a folder is passed as an argument, this folder is displayed. If several folders are passed as arguments, the last folder is displayed.

If one or more files are passed, they are displayed. In the folder list, the folder in which all files are located is highlighted. If they are in different folders, the first common top folder is marked. If the files are on different drives, Desktop is marked.

Examples for the call with folder:

```
QuickImageCommentX64.exe C:\Users\NN\Pictures\  
QuickImageCommentX64.exe \Users\NN\Pictures\  
QuickImageCommentX64.exe \Users\NN\Pictures  
QuickImageCommentX64.exe Pictures
```

Example for the call with several files:

```
QuickImageCommentX64.exe C:\Users\NN\Pictures\Demo-1.jpg  
C:\Users\N\Pictures\Demo-1.jpg
```

User-related configuration file

To use a specific user-related configuration file, it can be specified after the switch "/cfgUser:".

Example:

```
QuickImageCommentX64.exe /cfgUser:C:\Users\NN\Documents\QIC.ini
```

Parameters general configuration file

Parameters from the general configuration file can be specified as arguments. They then overwrite the values from the general configuration file.

Parameters are specified as in the general configuration file, preceded by a slash. If text parameters contain a space, the value must be enclosed in quotation marks.

Examples:

```
QuickImageCommentX64.exe /ShowHiddenFiles:yes  
QuickImageCommentX64.exe /DateFormat1_Name:"<weekday short> DD.MM.YYYY  
HH:mm:ss" /DateFormat1_Spec: "ddd dd.MM.yyyy HH:mm:ss"
```

Note: If parameters of the general configuration file are specified via the command line, the general configuration file in %APPDATA% is not read.

Additional text in mask title

Users who start the program with different configurations via the command line (or adapted shortcuts), can use the switch "/TitleSuffix:" to define a text that is added to the mask title of the main mask.

Example:

```
QuickImageCommentX64.exe /TitleSuffix: "Configuration with display of hidden files"  
/ShowHiddenFiles:yes
```

28 Adjustment and configuration

There are several ways to customize or configure the program.

How to adjust the main mask is described in [Layout of mask and adjustments](#).

Several masks are available to adjust different settings:

- [Mask "Adjust view"](#)
- [Mask "Settings"](#)
- [Mask "Field definitions"](#)
- [Mask "Predefined comments"](#)
- [Mask "Predefined keywords"](#)
- [Mask "Customize mask"](#)

Further adjustments can be done in the configuration files:

- [User related configuration file](#)
- [General configuration file](#)

This chapter also contains information about configuration files to support different languages:

- [TagLookup-file](#)
- [Language files](#)

28.1 User related configuration file

The settings made in the program (via the various masks for configuration) and further information such as the recently displayed folder, size of masks, etc. are stored in a configuration file. Default setting:

- %APPDATA%\QuickImageComment.ini (32-bit variant)
- %APPDATA%\QuickImageCommentX64.ini (64-bit variant)

Here %APPDATA% is an environment variable and has depending on the operating system normally following value:

Vista, Windows 7, 8, 10, 11	C:\Users\{username}\AppData\Roaming
Windows XP	C:\Documents and Settings\{username}\Application Data

This folder is hidden by default. The easiest way to view the content when the folder is hidden and/or you do not exactly know where it is: Enter %APPDATA% in the field on top of the File Explorer.

If QuickImageComment was installed via the Microsoft Store, a separate roaming folder is created during installation, in which the user-specific configuration file is then stored:

```
C:\Users\<Benutzer>\AppData\Local\Packages\30024NorbertWagner.QuickImageComment_wfhy15hr7q4mj\LocalCache\Roaming\QuickImageComment.ini
```

If QuickImageComment was not installed via the Microsoft Store, the storage location for user settings can be changed via menu entry "Tools - Storage location for user settings":

- %Appdata% (default setting):
 - If several users are created on the computer, each user has his own settings.
 - Settings are kept during upgrade on newer program version.
 - Also, to be chosen, if program folder is write-protected.

- Program directory, subfolder "config":
Recommended for portable usage on USB-stick: the settings are on USB-stick too, no settings will be stored on other computer.
When upgrading to a newer program version, settings need to be copied manually or program files in currently used folder have to be overwritten.
This subfolder in program directory must not be write-protected.

If QuickImageComment was installed via the Microsoft Store, this is not possible because the program directory is then read-only.

When you start the program, the settings are read from the configuration file and are saved when you quit. This configuration file is a simple text file and therefore in principle can be edited with an editor. But this carries the risk that errors are made that make the file unreadable for the program.

In the following cases editing with an editor can be useful:

- If you want to transfer a lot of settings from one configuration file to another.
- If you want to change the list of the last comments, list of artists or values of the other changeable properties - because that is the only information in the file that cannot be changed by other means.

Hint:

In versions up to and including 4.42, the user-related configuration file was stored directly in the program directory when "Program directory" was selected, then in the subfolder "config". With the change to 4.43 this file does not have to be moved; it is read furthermore also from the program directory. When changing from Appdata to program directory, however, it is moved to the config subfolder.

28.2 General configuration file

The program package includes a general configuration file, which is located in the program directory, subfolder config:

QuickImageCommentGeneral.ini

In this file you can make additional settings. However, it must be noted that with a new version of the program also a modified or enhanced configuration file is supplied. So it is better, if you copy the file into the folder %APPDATA% (see instructions in [User related configuration file](#)), there delete all rows that are not to be changed and adjust only the remaining settings and/or add further settings. Settings of the general configuration file in %APPDATA% have priority over the settings of the file in the program directory.

When using an installation from Microsoft Store you have no access to config folder of program path. However, the original content of config folder can be seen here:

<https://github.com/QuickImageComment/QuickImageComment/tree/main/QuickImageComment/config>

It is also possible to override settings of the general configuration file by passing arguments in the command line, see [Command line arguments](#). Then the general configuration file in %APPDATA% is not read.

The following settings can be adjusted or amended by the user:

Define new tags

Based on existing tags you can define new tags by extracting individual strings. This can be used to reformat the values of tags.

Syntax:

```
Define:<name of the new tag>=<name of existing tags>|<prefix>|<Start1>-<Finish1>||<Start2> - <time2>| ...
Descri:<name of the new tag>:<Description of the new tag>
```

Example 1:

```
Define:PhotoDateOriginal_YYYYMMDD=Exif.Photo.DateTimeOriginal||1-4||6-7||9-10|
Descri:PhotoDateOriginal_YYYYMMDD:The date when the original image data was
generated in format YYYYMMDD
```

Here the colons are removed from the Exif-tag Photo.DateTimeOriginal. The value of the tag is e.g., "2012:03:21". The new tag consists of the first four characters (the year), the sixth and seventh (month) and finally the ninth and tenth (day), which results in "20120321".

Example 2:

```
Define:PhotoDateOriginal_YYYYMMDD=Exif.Photo.DateTimeOriginal|a|1-4|-|6-7|-|9-10|
Descri:PhotoDateOriginal_YYYYMMDD:The date when the original image data was
generated in format aYYYY-MM-DD
```

Here in the Exif-tag Photo.DateTimeOriginal colons are replaced by hyphens and "a" is added as prefix. "2013:03:21" is changed to "a2012-03-21".

Date/time formats

For date values five different date formats can be defined. The definition consists of a name, which is displayed in the selection list for display formats in [Mask "Field definitions"](#), and the format specification itself.

Syntax:

```
DateFormat1_Name:<Format-Name>
DateFormat1_Spec:<Format-Specification>
```

In the format specification following placeholders can be used:

d	The day of the month, from 1 through 31.
dd	The day of the month, from 01 through 31.
ddd	The abbreviated name of the day of the week.
dddd	The full name of the day of the week.
h	The hour, using a 12-hour clock from 1 to 12.
hh	The hour, using a 12-hour clock from 01 to 12.
H	The hour, using a 24-hour clock from 0 to 23.
HH	The hour, using a 24-hour clock from 00 to 23.
m	The minute, from 0 through 59.
mm	The minute, from 00 through 59.
M	The month, from 1 through 12.
MM	The month, from 01 through 12.
MMM	The abbreviated name of the month.
MMMM	The full name of the month.
s	The second, from 0 through 59.
ss	The second, from 00 through 59.
t	The first character of the AM/PM designator.
tt	The AM/PM designator.

y	The year, from 0 to 99.
yy	The year, from 00 to 99.
yyy	The year, with a minimum of three digits.
yyyy	The year, with four digits.
yyyyy	The year, with five digits.

Further hints see: [https://msdn.microsoft.com/en-us/library/8kb3ddd4\(v=vs.71\).aspx](https://msdn.microsoft.com/en-us/library/8kb3ddd4(v=vs.71).aspx)

Example:

```
DateFormat1_Name:<weekday short> DD.MM.YYYY HH:mm:ss  
DateFormat1_Spec:ddd dd.MM.yyyy HH:mm:ss
```

Configuration of Leaflet map sources

In addition to the Leaflet map sources defined in the program for displaying and changing the recording location, further sources can be defined. Information needed for this configuration can be copied from <http://leaflet-extras.github.io/leaflet-providers/preview/>.

Syntax:

```
MapLeafletURL:<Name>=<URL>  
MapLeafletMaxZoom:<Name>=<MaxZoom>  
MapLeafletAttribution:<Name>=<Attribution>
```

- <Name> is shown in the selection list for map sources. It must not contain an equal sign.
- <URL> is the URL for the map tiles.
- <MaxZoom> is the maximum zoom level available for this map source.
- <Attribution> contains information about the map source, especially copyright notes.

Example:

Using the following information for one map source in <http://leaflet-extras.github.io/leaflet-providers/preview/>

```
var OpenStreetMap_France =  
  L.tileLayer('https://{s}.tile.openstreetmap.fr/osmfr/{z}/{x}/{y}.png', {  
    maxZoom: 20,  
    attribution: '&copy; OpenStreetMap France | &copy; <a  
      href="https://www.openstreetmap.org/copyright">OpenStreetMap</a>  
      contributors'  
  });
```

we get this entry in configuration file:

```
MapLeafletURL:OpenStreetMap.France=https://{s}.tile.openstreetmap.fr/osmfr/{z}/{x}/{y}.png  
MapLeafletMaxZoom:OpenStreetMap.France=20  
MapLeafletAttribution:OpenStreetMap.France=&copy; OpenStreetMap France | &copy;  
  <a href="https://www.openstreetmap.org/copyright">OpenStreetMap</a>  
  contributors
```

It is possible to configure a map source with two layers. Then three more lines for the second layer have to be added:

```
MapLeafletURL2:<Name>=<URL>  
MapLeafletMaxZoom2:<Name>=<MaxZoom>  
MapLeafletAttribution2:<Name>=<Attribution>
```

The following example uses CartoDB.VoyagerLabelsUnder as base layer and OpenRailwayMap as second layer:

```
MapLeafletURL:CartoDB.VoyagerLabelsUnder+OpenRailwayMap=https://{s}.basemaps.ca  
  rtocdn.com/rastertiles/voyager_labels_under/{z}/{x}/{y}{r}.png
```

```
MapLeafletMaxZoom:CartoDB.VoyagerLabelsUnder+OpenRailwayMap=20
MapLeafletAttribution:CartoDB.VoyagerLabelsUnder+OpenRailwayMap=&copy; <a
  href="https://www.openstreetmap.org/copyright">OpenStreetMap</a>
  contributors &copy; <a href="https://carto.com/attributions">CARTO</a>
MapLeafletURL2:CartoDB.VoyagerLabelsUnder+OpenRailwayMap=https://{s}.tiles.open
  railwaymap.org/standard/{z}/{x}/{y}.png
MapLeafletMaxZoom2:CartoDB.VoyagerLabelsUnder+OpenRailwayMap=19
MapLeafletAttribution2:CartoDB.VoyagerLabelsUnder+OpenRailwayMap=Map data:
  &copy; <a href="https://www.openstreetmap.org/copyright">OpenStreetMap</a>
  contributors | Map style: &copy; <a
  href="https://www.OpenRailwayMap.org">OpenRailwayMap</a> (<a
  href="https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/3.0/">CC-BY-SA</a>)
```

The general configuration file contains several entries for map sources, which are commented. By removing the leading semicolon, the map sources can be activated.

Configuration of URLs for displaying a map

In addition to the maps defined in the program for displaying the recording location, URLs for maps can be configured. In particular, additional entries can be added.

These URLs are used to display a map in the standard browser or (if the requirements for this are met) also in the map view of the program.

Syntax:

MapURL:<Name>=<URL>

- <Name> is shown in sub menu of menu "Tools / Map in Standard Browser". It must not contain an equal sign.
- <URL> is the URL, which is shown in Standard Browser. It must contain the placeholders <LATITUDE> and <LONGITUDE> for the coordinates.

Example:

```
MapURL:Google
Suche=https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=<LATITUDE>,<LONGITUDE>
```

Define alternative values

Some tags have only a code as value which is hard to understand. The vast majority of these are converted to a text by the underlying library exiv2, but you can define your own additionally mapping table.

Syntax:

value:<name of the tag>: <value> = <translation>

Example:

```
Value: Exif.Photo.Saturation: 0 = normal
```

Here for the Exif tag Photo.Saturation "normal" displayed as interpreted value if the original value is 0.

The supplied configuration file contains a mapping table with the most important Exif tags, where the lines are commented. The values are taken from the Exif specification and differ sometimes from the translation in the library exiv2. This table can be activated by removing the semicolon at the beginning of the line (and possibly translate the texts into your preferred language).

The mapping table is not supported for ExifTool properties because ExifTool already converts the values to text for many properties. In addition, the colon is used in the names of ExifTool properties, which poses a problem for the existing syntax.

Language definitions for XMP.Datentyp LangAlt

The XMP data type LangAlt (lang-alt in ExifTool) allows for a tag to store values in different languages. In the [Mask "Settings"](#) you can select, for which languages an input field is always displayed in the configurable input area. Which languages are offered in [Mask "Settings"](#) can be defined.

Syntax:

```
XmpLangAlt#: <Sprach-Definition> <Sprach-Beschreibung>
```

where # is a number from 1 to 5.

Example:

```
XmpLangAlt1:de-DE Deutsch (Deutschland)
```

The valid values for the language definition are included as comments in the general configuration file. The language description can be adapted.

File modification date when saving

In the default configuration, the file modification date is updated when saving. With the entry

```
KeepFileModifiedTime:yes
```

the old file modification date is kept when saving the file. The modification date then shows the last change, which was executed with another program, e.g., a program with which the picture itself was changed and not just the Meta data.

Note: Using this setting is a problem for the search via properties (see [Mask "Search via properties"](#)). When updating the database for the search, the system checks whether the modification date has changed since the last update. Data from files whose modification date has changed are re-read. If KeepFileModifiedTime is set to "yes", changes are therefore no longer recognized.

File name for saving data for the search.

The data that can be used to search for images or videos can be saved to a file so that they are available the next time the program is started. The file name can be changed via the following entry:

```
FindDataTableFileName:QuickImageComment_FindDataTable.xml
```

The file name can be specified with or without an absolute path. If no absolute path is specified, it is assumed that the file is to be saved in the storage location for user settings (see [User related configuration file](#)).

Display of hidden files and folders

With the entry

```
ShowHiddenFiles:yes
```

display of hidden files and folders is activated.

Tag for recording date

The [Metadata Working Group \(MWG\)](#) recommends in the [Guidelines for handling image metadata](#) the following tags for storing the recording date:

- Exif DateTimeOriginal (36867, 0x9003) and SubSecTimeOriginal (37521, 0x9291)
- IPTC DateCreated (IIM 2:55, 0x0237) and TimeCreated (IIM 2:60, 0x023C)
- XMP (photoshop:DateCreated)

According MWG's guidelines a Changer-application should keep all forms of metadata it modifies in sync with one another: whenever the Changer application writes new metadata fields to the file, it should keep different forms existing in the file in sync with one another.

It seems that images usually only contain the above mentioned Exif field and videos usually contain only the above-mentioned XMP field to hold recording date, meaning that only one of the two formats is present in each file. So, it was decided to keep it simple and allow only one tag for writing recording date in [Mask "Change recording date and time"](#) and "Set file date to date image generated".

If another tag than the predefined ones shall be used, following lines have to be adjusted:

```
TagDateImageGenerated:Exif.Photo.DateTimeOriginal
```

```
TagDateVideoGenerated:QuickTime:CreateDate
```

Before trying to change recording date in videos it is recommended to first check if the videos have this tag filled.

As videos can be changed with ExifTool only, an ExifTool-tag has to be provided for TagDateVideoGenerated, although the content may be read with an associated exiv2-tag as well.

Hint: "QuickTime:CreateDate" (notation of ExifTool) is called "Xmp.video.DateUTC" in exiv2.

According to specification, QuickTime:CreateDate is to be filled with UTC, not with local time. However, not all cameras follow this rule, so this program does not trust that the time is specified in UTC and thus does not try to convert to local time or vice versa.

When changing one of the above lines to use another tag, it is recommended to adjust fields in tile view of file list, as with first start of this program an entry for recording date and time is added there. The tag used there should fit to the tag used to change recording date and time. For more detailed information on this, see [Upgrade from 4.xx to 5.00](#).

Tag for keywords

Keywords for images are stored in tag "Iptc.Application2.Keywords", for videos (new with version 5.00) in "XMP-dc:Subject". Because for writing into videos ExifTool has to be used, the tag for video keywords is an ExifTool-Tag. XMP-dc:Subject is chosen in this program as preset, because XMP today is in general preferred over IPTC. XMP-dc:Subject is also a tag, whose content can be shown in Windows Explorer (see <https://quickimagecomment.de/en/meta-data-windows-explorer.html>).

If keywords shall be stored in other tags, following lines have to be adjusted:

```
TagKeyWordsImage:Iptc.Application2.Keywords
```

```
TagKeyWordsVideo:XMP-dc:Subject
```

You can specify multiple tags, separated by semicolons. The keywords will then be read from all specified tags and written to all specified tags.

The [Metadata Working Group \(MWG\)](#) recommends in the [Guidelines for handling image metadata](#) the following tags for storing keywords:

- IPTC Keywords (IIM 2:25, 0x0219)
- XMP (dc:subject[*])

The following configuration may therefore be appropriate for TagKeyWordsImage:

```
TagKeyWordsImage:Iptc.Application2.Keywords; XMP-dc:Subject
```

This follows the recommendation in [Guidelines for handling image metadata](#) to keep all types of metadata (in this case, all tags containing keywords) synchronized with one another.

Keywords can also be displayed e.g. in the "Overview" tab of the main screen if configured accordingly. If you modify any of the aforementioned lines, you should review the other settings related to keyword display. For more detailed information on this, see [Upgrade from 4.xx to 5.00](#).

Definitions for views "Thumbnail" and "Tile"

Display in views Thumbnail and Tile can be adjusted, all values in pixel:

- ThumbnailSize: size of thumbnail
- TileVerticalSpace: vertical space between tiles
- LargeIconHorizontalSpace: horizontal space in view thumbnail
- LargeIconVerticalSpace: vertical space in view thumbnail

Example:

```
ThumbnailSize:100
TileVerticalSpace:5
LargeIconHorizontalSpace:10
LargeIconVerticalSpace:20
```

Note: A scaling factor for the thumbnail images can be defined in [Mask "Scaling"](#) (new with version 4.54). The size of the preview image is then calculated as ThumbnailSize multiplied by the scaling factor. If this value is greater than 256, 256 is used because this is the system's maximum value.

Colors

The following colors can be customized:

- BackColorValueChanged: background color for input fields in the main screen when the value has been changed.
- BackColorMultiEditNonDefault: background color for controls in the "Multiple Image Editing" tab, if the default setting for saving properties for all selected images/videos has been changed.

Colors are to be defined as hexadecimal values in ARGB format. Transparent background colors are not supported for controls. Therefore, the values must start with "FF" for the alpha (transparency) channel.

Example:

```
BackColorValueChanged:FFFFFFFB4
```

To choose a suitable color, you can use Microsoft Paint. There you can see the RGB values for the individual color selection. The "FF" for alpha would then have to be prefixed.

Creating field definitions: Use tag name as definition name

When a new definition is created in the [Mask "Field definitions"](#), the name of the definition is preassigned:

- For exiv2 tags: Tag name without prefix, e.g., "Copyright" for "Exif.Image.Copyright"
- For ExifTool tags: the description, if available, otherwise the tag name

With

```
UseKeyAsNameForMetaDataDefinition:yes
```

the tag name is always used as the default for the definition name.

Options for ExifTool

Only if ExifTool is configured.

Additional options can be defined for reading and writing with ExifTool. To do this, modify the following two lines:

```
ExifToolGeneralOptionsRead:-use mwg -api requestall=3
ExifToolGeneralOptionsWrite:
```

The options predefined in ExifToolGeneralOptionsRead can also be removed.

This program launches ExifTool with the following options for reading:

```
-D -G:6:1 -sep ~$$# -j -l
```

These options must not be overridden, otherwise this program will not be able to read the output from ExifTool.

To test how the options effect runtime and the number of values read, you can use

```
ExifToolLogRead:yes
```

to enable logging. A separate mask displays the options for ExifTool (from the general configuration file and the mask [Settings for ExifTool](#)), the file name, the time taken to read with ExifTool, and the number of values read. This information is formatted with tabs, so the contents of the dialog box can be easily copied into Excel for further analysis.

Example of a specific use case: The "-fast" option (which can be set in mask [Settings for ExifTool](#)) speeds up the extraction of information but carries the risk that tags may be missing. You can enable logging with "ExifToolLogRead:yes" and then compare the results of running the command once with "-fast" and once without it on a folder containing a representative selection of images. By comparing the logs, you can see how much time "-fast" saves and if fewer values are read. If the number of values differs, you can use the menu item "File - Export: all properties of selected images/videos" and compare the exports with and without "-fast" to see exactly which values are missing.

Tag mapping from exiv2 to ExifTool

Only if ExifTool is configured.

Until before version 5.00, metadata where only stored using exiv2 and thus all tag configurations were for exiv2. The following settings define a mapping of tag names in exiv2 notation to tag names in ExifTool notation. In this way metadata can be stored with ExifTool without the need to change user's configuration, e.g. in order to store metadata in .heic-files, which is not supported by exiv2.

Syntax:

```
Exiv2ExifToolMappingWrite:<exiv2-tag-name>=<ExifTool-tag-name>  
Exiv2ExifToolMappingReadWrite:<exiv2-tag-name>=<ExifTool-tag-name>
```

Examples:

```
Exiv2ExifToolMappingWrite:Exif.Image.Artist=IFD0:Artist  
Exiv2ExifToolMappingReadWrite:Exif.GPSInfo.GPSAltitude=GPS:GPSAltitude
```

Exiv2ExifToolMappingWrite is only used during writing metadata.

Exiv2ExifToolMappingReadWrite is used also when reading metadata, which is important when the representation of values in ExifTool is different to its representation in exiv2. E.g. when Exif.GPSInfo.GPSAltitude is added in configurable input area, a height of 37.1 m can be shown as "187633/5055", which is the format expected by exiv2 as input. When "187633/5055", is given to ExifTool, it will be stored as 187633 m. In such cases, Exiv2ExifToolMappingReadWrite must be used so that the value is shown in the format which ExifTool expects as input format. As Exif.Image.Artist/IFD0:Artist contains a string, the representation in exiv2 and ExifTool is the same and mapping is not required for reading.

When using Exiv2ExifToolMappingReadWrite, you are on the safe side. It may result in an unnecessary mapping during read, but it will have no noticeable impact on performance. Separation between Write and ReadWrite has mainly documentation purposes.

Instead of adding new entries for tag mapping, you may as well change the configuration using [Mask "Field definitions"](#). Using the mapping is a kind of fallback strategy to use same configuration without ExifTool. In case you inform the developer of this program about your mappings via mail to <mailto:quickimagecomment@gmail.com> or issue in [GitHub](#), they can be included in future versions to support other users. As it is planned to remove exiv2 and use ExifTool only, such mapping information will support this migration.

All other settings in the general configuration file are used for testing purposes and should not be changed.

28.3 TagLookup-file

The program package includes a lookup file for German, which is located in the program directory, subfolder "config":

QIC_TagLookup_Deutsch.ini

This file is used when the language is set to "Deutsch".

In this file, translations for tag names from exiv2 and descriptions can be entered and changed. However, it must be noted that with a new version of the program also a modified or enhanced lookup file is supplied. So it is better, if you copy the file into the folder %APPDATA% (see instructions in [User related configuration file](#)), there delete all rows that are not to be changed and adjust only the remaining entries and/or add further entries. Settings of the lookup file in %APPDATA% have priority over the settings of the file in the program directory.

When using an installation from Microsoft Store you have no access to config folder of program path. However, the original content of config folder can be seen here:

<https://github.com/QuickImageComment/QuickImageComment/tree/main/QuickImageComment/config>

Syntax for translation of a tag name:

META_KEY:<original tag name>=<translated tag name>

Example:

META_KEY:Define.FileCreated_ExifFormat=Define.Datei erzeugt (Exif-Format)

Note: in translations you may not add additional points (e.g., for abbreviations), because the point is used as a delimiter for the grouping.

For example, the tag "Exif.Fujifilm.MaxApertureAtMaxFocal" is translated as "Exif.Fujifilm.Max Blende bei max Brennweite" and thus is displayed as "Max Blende bei max Brennweite" under the heading "Exif.Fujifilm". If it would be translated as "Exif.Fujifilm.Max. Blende bei max. Brennweite", it would be displayed as "Brennweite" under the heading "Exif.Fujifilm.Max. Blende bei max."

Syntax for a replacement tag description:

META_DESC:<original tag description>=<translated tag description>

Example:

META_DESC:Define.FileCreated_ExifFormat=Datum/Uhrzeit, wann die Datei im Exif-Datum/Uhrzeit-Format Exif erstellt wurde (JJJJ:MM:DD hh:mm:ss)

For ExifTool, the language can be selected separately via the menu item "Tools - Language for ExifTool". Therefore, no entries are provided for the ExifTool properties in the TagLookup file.

28.4 Language files

Quick Image Comment is multilingual. The basic version is German. Exiv2 Tag names and descriptions are in English, because they are provided by the library exiv2 (which is in English). Tag names and descriptions from ExifTool are shown in the language set by menu entry "Tools - Language for ExifTool".

The following language files are supplied with the program:

QIC_TagLookup_Deutsch.cfg	(Incomplete) translation of exiv2 tag names and descriptions to German, see also TagLookup-file
QIC_Language_Deutsch.cfg	List with German texts, which are used by the program dynamically, such as error messages
QIC_Language_English.cfg	List with English texts, which are used by the program dynamically, such as error messages, as well as English translations of static text in the masks (labels)
QIC_Language_Français.cfg	Same for French

These files can be changed (at own risk).

In principle new languages can be supported without program changes if an appropriate QIC_Language_XXX.cfg is created. Program changes are only necessary if it is not possible to keep the translations so short that they fit into the available space. A corresponding QIC_TagLookup_XXX.cfg is not required. If it does not exist (or is incomplete as the German) English names and descriptions are used.

Support for providing additional languages is welcome. For more details:

<https://quickimagecomment.de/en/support-for-additional-languages.html>

If translations for other languages are made available to the developer of this program, they will be included in the ZIP files and, if necessary, made available for download on the website at short notice.

28.5 exiv2.ini

Starting with version 0.26 exiv2 optionally uses an initialization file named exiv2.ini. QuickImageComment looks for this file in the location of the user related configuration file.

Some makers define a lens-ID. For display of ExifEasy.LensName exiv2 translates these lens-IDs to lens names based on a mapping included in the program itself. However, there are IDs, which are not yet included in the built-in mapping, and some IDs are not unique. For these IDs the mapping can be defined in exiv2.ini. Here an example:

```
# comment

[canon]
110=Samyang 35mm F1.4 AS UMC
247=Samyang 14mm f/2.8 AE ED AS IF UMC

[nikon]
146=a nikon lens

[pentax]
3 255 0 0=a pentax lens

[minolta]
255=a sony lens

[olympus]
None=something
```

In case for an ID is an entry in the integrated mapping table as well as in exiv2.ini, the entry from exiv2.ini is used.

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29.3 Leaflet

Source:

<http://leafletjs.com/>

<https://github.com/Leaflet/Leaflet/blob/master/LICENSE>

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29.4 Newtonsoft Json.NET

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30 Data privacy statement

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Responsible for data processing is:

Norbert Wagner
Karl-Geusen-Straße 202
40231 Düsseldorf
Germany
<mailto:quickimagecomment@gmail.com>

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Data when using the QuickImageComment program

No data is transmitted to the developer.

Note for users of older versions: The transmission of elementary anonymous usage data with the help of Microsoft AppCenter was removed with version 4.64 because AppCenter was discontinued by Microsoft on March 31, 2025.

Using Google Maps and Bing Maps

With this program it is possible to display maps from Google Maps or Bing Maps. This is then done as in a usual web browser (e.g., Google Chrome or Microsoft Edge) and the data privacy policies of Google Maps or Bing Maps apply.

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This statement is based on the following German source: [Muster-Datenschutzerklärung von anwalt.de](#)

31 Meta data standards

Exif-Specification:

Version 2.32:

http://www.cipa.jp/std/documents/download_e.html?DC-008-Translation-2019-E

Newer versions can be found here if necessary:

<https://cipa.jp/e/index.html>

IPTC-Specification:

IPTC Photo Metadata Standard:

<https://www.iptc.org/std/photometadata/specification/IPTC-PhotoMetadata>

Namespace Dublin Core:

<https://www.dublincore.org/specifications/dublin-core/dcmi-terms/>

Further information and if necessary newer versions can be found here:

<https://iptc.org/standards/photo-metadata/iptc-standard/>

IPTC Guidelines & Support:

<https://iptc.org/standards/photo-metadata/guidelines-support/>

Reference image with IPTC data according to standard 2019.1:

<https://www.iptc.org/std/photometadata/examples/IPTC-PhotometadataRef-Std2019.1.jpg>

Metadata Schema and Format Specification, version 4.2:

<http://www.iptc.org/std/IIM/4.2/specification/IIMV4.2.pdf>

More information about Information Interchange Model (IIM) and, if applicable, newer version of the specification:

<https://iptc.org/standards/iim/>

Notes on the date format:

According to IIM the date is stored in the format "CCYYMMDD". exiv2 (the library used in this program to read and write metadata) returns the date in the format "CCYY-MM-DD" according to ISO 8601-1. An IPTC date must also be entered in the same format.

XMP-Specification:

Overview:

<https://www.adobe.io/xmp/docs/#!adobe/xmp-docs/master/Specifications.md>

Part 1, Data model, Serialization, and Core Properties:

<https://github.com/adobe/XMP-Toolkit-SDK/blob/main/docs/XMPSpecificationPart1.pdf>

Part 2, Additional Properties:

<https://github.com/adobe/XMP-Toolkit-SDK/blob/main/docs/XMPSpecificationPart2.pdf>

Part 3, Storage in Files:

<https://github.com/adobe/XMP-Toolkit-SDK/blob/main/docs/XMPSpecificationPart3.pdf>

Metadata Working Group (MWG)

Based on a 2006 proposal by Microsoft, the Metadata Working Group (MWG) organization was created in 2007 by 5 founding members: Apple, Adobe, Canon, Microsoft and Nokia. Sony joined this initiative in 2008.

After the group published the "Guidelines for Handling Image Metadata" (Version 2.0) in November 2010, the work was considered largely complete and it seems that there were no further publications. The official domain [metadataworkinggroup.org](http://www.metadataworkinggroup.org) was eventually abandoned and is no longer accessible today, but the content was archived in <https://web.archive.org/web/20181007091321/http://www.metadataworkinggroup.com/>

Although the MWG guidelines are rather old now, they are still considered to be valid. Accordingly, this user manual refers in hints for settings and configuration of this program to MWG:

- [Mask "Settings"](#)
 - [Some thoughts to be considered, when deciding where to store comment and artist:](#)
- [General configuration file](#)
 - [Tag for recording date](#)
 - [Tag for keywords](#)

MWG Guidelines for handling image metadata:

https://web.archive.org/web/20180919181934/http://www.metadataworkinggroup.org/pdf/mwg_guidance.pdf

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